

*Communication and Participation—
The Key to Unity and Self-Support*

**THE FIFTY-EIGHTH ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS**

2008
Final Report

Crowne Plaza Manhattan, New York, NY April 27–May 3, 2008

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Contents

Communication and Participation—

The Key to Unity and Self-Support	3
Greetings	5
Keynote	5
Workshop	7
Conference Advisory Actions	9
Agenda	9
Archives	9
Cooperation With the Professional Community	9
Corrections	9
Finance	10
Grapevine	10
International Conventions/Regional Forums	10
Literature	10
Policy/Admissions	10
Public Information	11
Report and Charter	11
Treatment Facilities	12
Trustees	12
Presentations and Reports	13
Finance Report	13
Unity	15
Our Common Welfare Should Come First	15
Principles Before Personalities	17
Diversity: Reaching Out to All Alcoholics	17
Communication and Participation	18
Sharing the Message of Service	18
Our Key to Keeping A.A. Strong	19
Leadership in A.A.: Building Communication	20
The A.A. Grapevine	21
Unity and Communication	21
Participation: The Privilege of Passing It On	22
Self-Support	23
Self-Supporting Through	
Members' Voluntary Contributions Only	23
Contempt Prior to Investigation	24
Responsibility to Communicate and Participate	25
International	26
A.A. Around the World	26
Reports from the General Service Board and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards	29
General Service Board	29
A.A. World Services, Inc.	30
Literature Distribution	34
The A.A. Grapevine	37
Grapevine Circulation and Geographical Breakdown	40
Trustees' Committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports ...	41
Archives	41
Audit Committee	41
Compensation	42
Conference	43

Cooperation With the Professional Community/

Treatment Facilities	44
Corrections	46
Finance and Budgetary	47
General Sharing Session	49
Estimates of Groups & Members	50
A.A. Grapevine	51
Group Services	52
International	52
International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums	53
Literature	54
Loners, Internationalists, Homers	56
Nominating	56
Public Information	57
Staff Coordinator	58
Area Service Highlights	59
Additional Committee Considerations	65
Floor Actions Not Resulting in an Advisory Action	69
Financial	70
Consolidated Statement of Financial Position	70
Consolidated Statement of Activity	71
Consolidated Statement of Functional Expenses	72
Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows	73
Report of the Independent Auditor	74
2008 Budget Highlights: G.S.O., Grapevine and La Viña	77
2008 G.S.O. Budget	78
2008 Grapevine Budget	79
2007 Contributions from Groups—by Delegate Area ...	80
2008 Conference Committees	82
2009 Chairpersons and alternates	82
2008 Trustees' Committees	83
2008 Conference Members	84
Trustees (General Service Board)	84
A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors	86
G.S.O. and Grapevine staffs	86
Area delegates	86

Confidential—full names used

Since this report is a *confidential* A.A. document, for members only, it contains members' full names and addresses.

This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use respects our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications and with media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



The 134 members who make up this year's General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous in the United States and Canada convened in New York City, April 27-May 3, for the 58th annual meeting of what many consider A.A.'s business meeting.

The theme of this year's Conference was "Communication and Participation — The Key to Unity and Self-Support." Conference members were the delegates from the 93 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, Class A (nonalcoholic) and Class B (alcoholic) trustees, and directors and staff members of the two corporate boards—A.A. World Services, Inc. and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

Registration for the weeklong event took place Sunday morning, when Conference members lined up to eagerly receive their copy of the Conference Manual. The Opening Session began with a welcome from chairman of the General Service Board Leonard Blumenthal. Then the Conference was officially opened with the roll call, by Greg Muth G.S.O.'s general manager.

France Jolicoeur, of Northeast Québec, was the delegate chairperson, and though French-speaking, she delivered her greeting in English: "I stand before you at the mike to welcome you in the language of Shakespeare. I hope my pronunciation is correct...."

Chuck Barta, West Central regional trustee, delivered the keynote address, in which he said, "we must strive to keep our primary purpose first and foremost as we progress through the week and to do what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole."

That evening was the opening dinner, a time of fellowship and seeing old friends. Many past delegates and former trustees attended. Tim Donaldson (Alabama/NW Florida), chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee, chaired the open A.A. meeting that followed the dinner. Bill Fifield (Colorado), alternate chairperson, led the meeting. Speakers were Janet Hollabaugh (Western Pennsylvania), Andy Talbert (Grapevine director), Mike Doheny (Nevada), Mary Dargan (G.S.O. staff), and John Skilton (trustee).

Presentations and sharing sessions at the Conference, which

met at the Crowne Plaza Times Square in New York, addressed such subjects as how to keep A.A. strong, the importance of service, leadership, and contempt prior to investigation. Kiki Roddy, delegate from the District of Columbia, touched on how the message of unity expressed in the First Tradition leaves room for a divergence of opinion in our Fellowship. Bob Conley, Southeastern Michigan, noted in his presentation that in the give and take at the Conference, "we trust that a democratic process engaged in by people acting in good faith will be in the best interest of our Fellowship, even though we may not agree with all the decisions made."

Four observers attended the Conference at the invitation of the General Service Board. They were: Ann Napier, general secretary of G.S.O. in York, England (equivalent to our G.S.O. general manager); Louise Foxcroft, a nonalcoholic trustee on the G.S.B. of Great Britain; and Elvido Quintas and Jose Romero, two regional trustees from Mexico.

Spaced throughout the week, new delegates presented their Area Highlights. There were four "What's On Your Mind?" sharing sessions, in which Conference members come to the mike to ask questions, present concerns of their areas on issues that did not appear on the committee agendas, or simply speak on any A.A. business they choose.

The agendas of the 13 Conference committees consist of items forwarded to them by the corresponding trustees' committees. After deliberation on agenda items each, committee reports its recommendations to the entire Conference for discussion,

approval, or rejection. Beginning Wednesday evening, the delegate chairperson of each Conference committee presented its recommendations. Conference members were then free to go to the floor mikes to ask questions, disagree, make suggestions or changes, and share the concerns of their area on any given issue. This process continued for the next day or more before some items resulted in Conference Advisory Actions.

Among the work at this year's Conference, the Public Information Committee reviewed the results of the A.A. Membership Survey, which is produced every three years. The Treatment Facilities Committee assessed sample footage of the revised video "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous." Another agenda item was a review by the Conference Literature Committee of the revised version of the pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American."

At the first General Service Conference—in April 1951—37 delegates from the U.S. and Canada came to New York and spent three days meeting with the 15 trustees, Bill, staff members from G.S.O. and the Grapevine. Today the Conference is accepted as the medium through which A.A.'s membership makes its voice heard.

The work of the Conference goes on 365 days a year—in the groups, in the districts and areas, at the General Service Office, and in the constant work of committees, from the local areas to the trustees' committees. However, it is during Conference week that it all comes together. Doug Richardson, G.S.O. staff member, was the Conference coordinator. Working behind the scenes, staff and support personnel from the General Service and Grapevine offices made the week run seamlessly.

The work of chairing the Conference was shared by Leonard Blumenthal, (nonalcoholic) chairman of the board, Greg Muth, G.S.O. general manager, and France Jolicoeur, the delegate chairperson.

Each morning at 7:30 the G.S.C. Serenity Group met for an open A.A. meeting, with topics taken from A.A. literature. Sharon Farnsworth, Central Southeast Ohio, was the chairperson. Secretary/Treasurer was Ted Kroll, of Virginia.

New York Intergroup hosted a hospitality suite for early arrivals Saturday afternoon. Throughout the week local A.A. and Al-Anon members planned a variety of activities for the family and friends of delegates.

Tuesday afternoon there was a trip to G.S.O. and Grapevine offices. Conference members and the family and friends who accompanied them to New York had the opportunity to tour the offices and visit G.S.O.'s Archives.

At the Delegates Only Meeting Tuesday evening Joe Barrett, Mid-Southern California, was elected delegate chair for the 59th Conference; John Teupel, South Dakota, will be alternate chair.

Wednesday afternoon the Conference elected three new trustees: Ken Brueggemann, Nebraska, will be the new West Central regional trustee. The new Western Canada trustee will be Vic Phillips, of Olds, Alberta. Terrance Bedient will replace Vince Keefe as Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee.

Friday evening, following closing remarks by Leonard Blumenthal, the Conference officially closed with the Serenity

Prayer in English, French, and Spanish.



On Saturday morning, members of A.A.'s 58th Conference came together for the last time at the closing brunch. Rotating Class B trustees Chuck Barta and Tom Kraemer, and Class A trustee Vince Keefe addressed the gathering.

Then it was off to Stepping Stones, the home of Bill and Lois Wilson. Conference members were especially interested in visiting "Wit's End" a small cement block studio in the woods behind the house where Bill spent hours, "just sitting," thinking and writing.

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

My name is France J. and I am an alcoholic. An alcoholic honored and a bit stressed to welcome you to this 58th General Service Conference. I give a special welcome to the delegates of Panel 58, our newcomers. And a special welcome to our friends of the General Service Boards and the General Service Office of Mexico and of Great Britain.

Mon Dieu, c'est France! Those are the first words I heard last year when my "buddy" drew my name from the hat to represent you as the delegate chairperson. My peers from Québec had a good laugh when they saw the terror on my face! I thought God had a good sense of humor to entrust me with this task—a French-speaking person who came to the Conference with an interpreter. But A.A. does miracles and you have proof this afternoon. I stand before you at the mike to welcome you in the language of Shakespeare. I hope my pronunciation is correct at the risk of having all the people burst out laughing like last year!

This week will be marked with strong emotions. We will go through uncertainty, confusion and stress, wondering what we are doing here so far away from our areas. Don't be afraid; these emotions are normal. Let's never forget that in our periods of uncertainty God watches over us and that the Conference process has worked for a long time and many delegates before us also had doubts. Friday, at the closing of the Conference, I can assure you that you will be proud and happy of your active participation in this 58th Conference.

For more than 70 years now, our Fellowship has had but one primary purpose: to carry its message to the still-suffering alcoholic. All during this week we will reflect on ways to improve communication in order for us to reach more people both in and out of A.A., so our message will be heard more and more within the areas of the Conference and beyond, for, as we know, A.A. exists in more than 180 countries around the world. There are many messengers and only one message—our recovery through Alcoholics Anonymous. No matter what language we speak, here we all speak the same one—the language of the heart.

As a recovering alcoholic, it is my duty to carry the A.A. message, and I have the privilege of doing so by participating actively in Alcoholics Anonymous. How can we communicate more effectively to encourage our members to participate in our many A.A. activities? We know that the participation of our members is deeply linked to the way we carry our message. I do not have a ready answer to suggest, but I know that together, all through this week, we will be able to find answers to our many questions and to find the best solutions so our precious Fellowship can continue its work with the alcoholics both in A.A. and with those who will eventually join our ranks.

My financial contribution is essential to the survival of A.A. As we are reminded in our Seventh Tradition: "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions." Contributions are provided from our members and, unfortunately, as the years go by, individual member contributions have not substantially increased. How can we encourage our members to be more generous? The financial participation of members in their Fellowship is another worthy matter for us to reflect on this week.

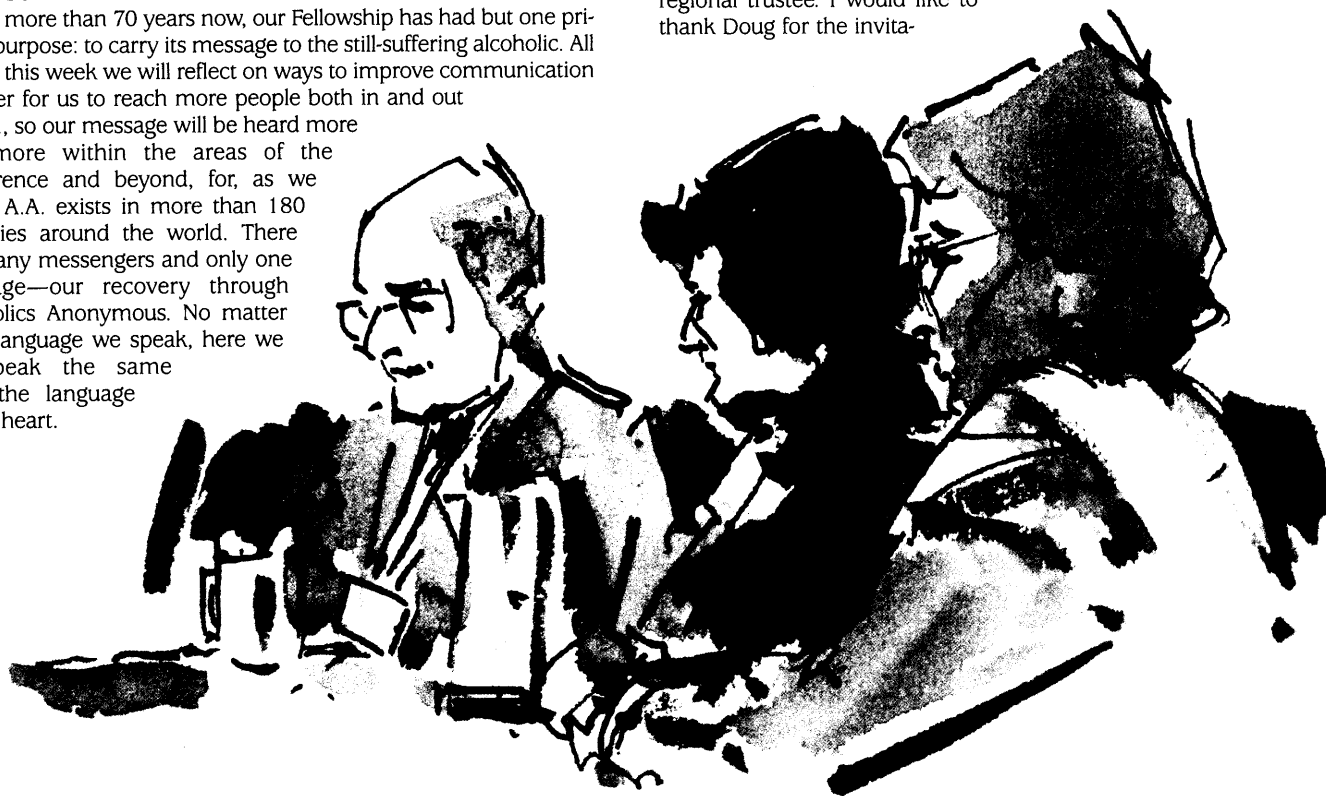
As a trusted servant, I have the duty never to put out the flame of sobriety that gave me life and to keep it shining for future generations, for my kids and my grandchildren, who one day may stumble all the way to a meeting room of Alcoholics Anonymous.

I thank God everyday for the grace he gave me to become a member of Alcoholics Anonymous in the Fall of 1995. I thank "Life" for all the precious gifts it gives me in my sobriety. I wish you a wonderful week at the 58th Conference; a wonderful journey awaits you. I know that God and the spirit of our founders will watch over us so we arrive safe and sound.

France Jolicoeur, NE Québec

Keynote

My name is Chuck Barta, and I am an alcoholic. For the last four years I have had the honor and privilege of serving Alcoholics Anonymous as the West Central regional trustee. I would like to thank Doug for the invita-



tion to present the keynote address at the 58th General Service Conference. At first I thought that I had drawn the short straw, but soon realized what an honor this really is.

The theme for this year's Conference is *Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support*. The annual General Service Conference is "a method by which A.A.'s collective group conscience can speak forcefully and put its desires for Conference-wide services into effect." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S-15)

We, as trusted servants and Conference members,

other controversies concerning A.A. When she asked her sponsor if she should say anything, she was told that whenever she found herself in that type of situation she should ask herself two questions. If not me, who? If not now, when?

Another thing that comes to mind when thinking about the group conscience and communication is a statement in the story *Join the Tribe* from the third edition of the Big Book. "Listen, don't just hear noise." This always reminds me that there are two parts to communicating—speaking and listening. Oftentimes I do real well at speaking, but I can always use a tune up in the listening department.

I believe that the only way we can reach harmony this week is to fully participate and communicate, while remembering why we are here. The Big Book (p. 17) states that "The tremendous fact for every one of us is that we have discovered a common solution. We have a way out on which we can absolutely agree, and upon which we can join in brotherly and harmonious action." I have yet to meet the A.A. member who is consciously striving to destroy the thing that saved their life.

We may not agree with everything

must strive to keep a balance between ultimate authority and responsibility. We must strive to keep our primary purpose first and foremost as we progress through the week and to do what is best for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole.

Concept IV states that "Throughout our Conference structure, we ought to maintain at all responsible levels a traditional 'Right of Participation,' taking care that each classification or group of our world servants shall be allowed a voting representation in reasonable proportion to the responsibility that each must discharge." I believe that we, as voting members of this Conference, not only have a right to participate, we also have a responsibility and duty to participate.

How do we participate? One way to participate in something is to suit up and show up, to be present both physically and mentally. It is clear to me, as I look around the room, that we have done our part in that regard. What a fine looking group of people. I don't know about you, but I can assure you that I did not always clean up this good.

In order to be effective in our participation we need to communicate. According to the Merriam-Webster Dictionary, communication is the exchange of information or opinions. In order to exchange information I need to ask questions and listen to the responses. I also need to listen when others ask questions or offer suggestions.

The Second Tradition states "...there is but one ultimate authority—a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience." Whenever I think about the group conscience I am reminded of something a good friend always says. "In order to get the right answers, we need to ask the right questions." Don't be afraid to ask the hard questions.

I once heard a speaker relate an experience that she had with her sponsor. She was troubled about whether she should say something when hearing about possible Traditions violations and

that others are doing, but we do agree to disagree, and then go out for ice cream. All of us want to do what is best for A.A. and this is the harmony that we seek.

Unity and harmony are synonymous and very important to our beloved Fellowship. Without unity, Alcoholics Anonymous would wither and die. Unity is so important that the next eleven Traditions tell us how to maintain it. As we go through our week I encourage you to get involved. I realize that I am preaching to the choir, but there may be a few who may think that their question is not important. Or that their thoughts on a subject may not be beneficial to the discussion. Don't be afraid to ask your questions or make your comments. The only way a loving God may express himself in our group conscience is to hear full debate on an issue. Without your participation, that may not happen.

Communication and participation are not only the key to harmony and a successful General Service Conference—they are also the key to self-support. Your reports to the groups and members of what happened here this week may, quite possibly, be the incentive for groups that are not contributing to do so. They may wish to assume some ownership in this movement that has, by the grace of God, saved so many lives. This is not a competition. It is not about how much my group is able to contribute. It is about being spiritually connected through the Seventh Tradition. It is about being a small but important part of a great whole.

I hope, as we move through the week, that each of you will have a positive experience. I hope that your batteries will be recharged. I hope that you will come away from this Conference with a fire and enthusiasm that will add depth and weight to

your reportbacks. But most of all I want to thank all of you for your willingness to stand up and be a leader in our efforts to preserve Alcoholics Anonymous for those in need now, and in the future.

Chuck Barta, West Central regional trustee

Workshop: "Love and Tolerance, Now More Than Ever"

Wednesday morning Conference members divided into groups for workshop discussions topics on the theme "Love and Tolerance, Now More Than Ever." Following are questions and a summary of responses from those discussions.

1. What does the face of A.A. look like? Is there diversity in my group, district and/or area at the Conference? If not, what can or should we do about it?

The face of A.A. reflects a more diverse cross section of the population than ever. Groups seem to have younger members, more women and a greater ethnic mix. There are more high-bottom drunks. In many ways, A.A. groups reflect the community in which they reside, and members are aware that alcoholics belong to every type of group.

Others felt that there is not a good cross section of diversity in our groups, areas and the service structure. White males still appear to be the highest percentage. Women in general are underrepresented in A.A. at both the group level and in service. Female sponsorship is a problem and there are not many young people (i.e., less than 30 years of age). Getting younger members and diverse members into service is difficult. There is little diversity among those with special needs. Those who are different often have to struggle as they became more involved.

There are trust issues and if we can gain trust with members of different backgrounds it will help diversity. Let's always be mindful to never compromise the A.A. message in an attempt to be all-inclusive. We are aware of our own prejudices with people who look different. We may need more attraction and sponsorship. Diversity in A.A. becomes less at the area and Conference levels. We didn't see a lot of diversity at the International Convention, and there is not a lot of diversity at the board level. However, the 2008 Conference appeared very diverse.

We need to define what we mean by diversity, because we may all be working toward different goals. We need to understand other cultures. In addition to race and gender we need to think about mental illness, the elderly, young people, dual addiction—diversity means much more.

We are making progress and have to keep trying. We can use group inventories to look at our insensitivity and how to reach out to diverse populations. We can make sponsorship and service fun, and continue to share A.A. history to generate both knowledge and enthusiasm—both to carry the message in our meetings and in general service. It only takes one person from a culture/ethnic group to get meetings started. Love and tolerance allows newcomers to find out if they belong. Diversity at the group level means being open and welcoming, and making new people feel comfortable. When groups strive to reach out to newcomers the diversity of the group opens up. Having even one person to trust can make an inroad into a culture. When the information is presented and made attractive then more different types of alcoholics may come in.

At the area and district service levels the status quo tends to remain constant, unless the district committee members and other leaders reach out. Keep carrying the message of service to the newcomer and to the professional community. Encourage women and people of color to get involved. Talk at the service level about diversity and not just about race and color. Recruit culturally diverse candidates into service, and rotate meetings to various districts.

Regarding the lack of diversity on the board, we can only pick from the pool we have and it starts at the group level. We still have lots to do, and even after making groups more diverse we will still have the challenge of getting them into service. But at the group level it is important to have someone that each person can relate to "who looks like me." Deepen and broaden the pool of candidates for service in A.A. to reflect the face of A.A. At every level, we need to encourage members to make it over whatever hurdles they face.



2. How are Twelfth Step calls being made these days?

Twelfth Step work is taking place in our meetings. Much of what we do is to take folks who get to our meetings and bring them into the program. Taking someone to meetings is also Twelfth Step work, and that is where their first exposure to A.A. occurs.

Face-to-face Twelfth Step calls are rarer than they used to be. They are being made the same way, just not as frequently. A local group recently had two Twelfth Step calls, which were their first in a long time. We should reintroduce some of Bill and Bob's philosophy of seeking out drunks.

Our central offices and intergroups handle calls requesting meeting times, as well as calls seeking help. Most calls come through hot lines and answering services, and most intergroups have Twelfth Step call lists.

Many Twelfth Step calls today come from referrals from courts, treatment centers and liaison programs at work. The responsibility for Twelfth Step work rests with us. Those who are court ordered should be treated the same as any other Twelfth Step.

Groups are invited to take meetings into detox and treatment centers. However, with more treatment centers closing the old-style Twelfth Step calls are truly coming back. Much is also being done to take meetings into correctional facilities, jails and prisons, but there isn't much time for fellowship after these meetings. Twelfth Step calls take place largely when people get out of institutions.

A majority of people in A.A. have not worked with wet drunks. An area or district might hold an afternoon assembly, with roundtables led by members to talk about working with wet drunks and Twelfth Step calls. That information was taken back to their groups and helped inform the members, many of whom had no idea how to make a Twelfth Step call but are now asking. We need to not be fearful of doing Twelfth Step calls and we need to be taught how to do them. We might think more creatively about work through C.P.C., clergy and how/where to distribute our literature.

Twelfth Step work might be done through newspapers. A.A. is not a secret society and is well known. The Internet provides meetings but without personal contact. One area utilizes e-mail where a potential new member can e-mail in and be answered by e-mail and result in a face-to-face meeting with a local contact.

However, face-to-face Twelfth Step work is still the best. It helps to read Chapter 7, "Working With Others," from the Big Book.

Being a delegate,
one person

observed, is the most isolative position in A.A. As we get more involved in A.A. service work do we get too busy for this type of work? Twelfth Step calls, as Bill wrote, take time. No matter how busy we get, we still need to do Twelfth Step work and take Twelfth Step calls! The inconvenience of Twelfth Step calls helps us to remember that it was also inconvenient for the person who helped us. We get incredible spiritual benefits from working with others. Carrying the message is a spiritual awakening.

3. What challenges have you faced while participating in A.A. service with placing principles before personalities? In terms of love and tolerance, how well or badly did you deal with these challenges?

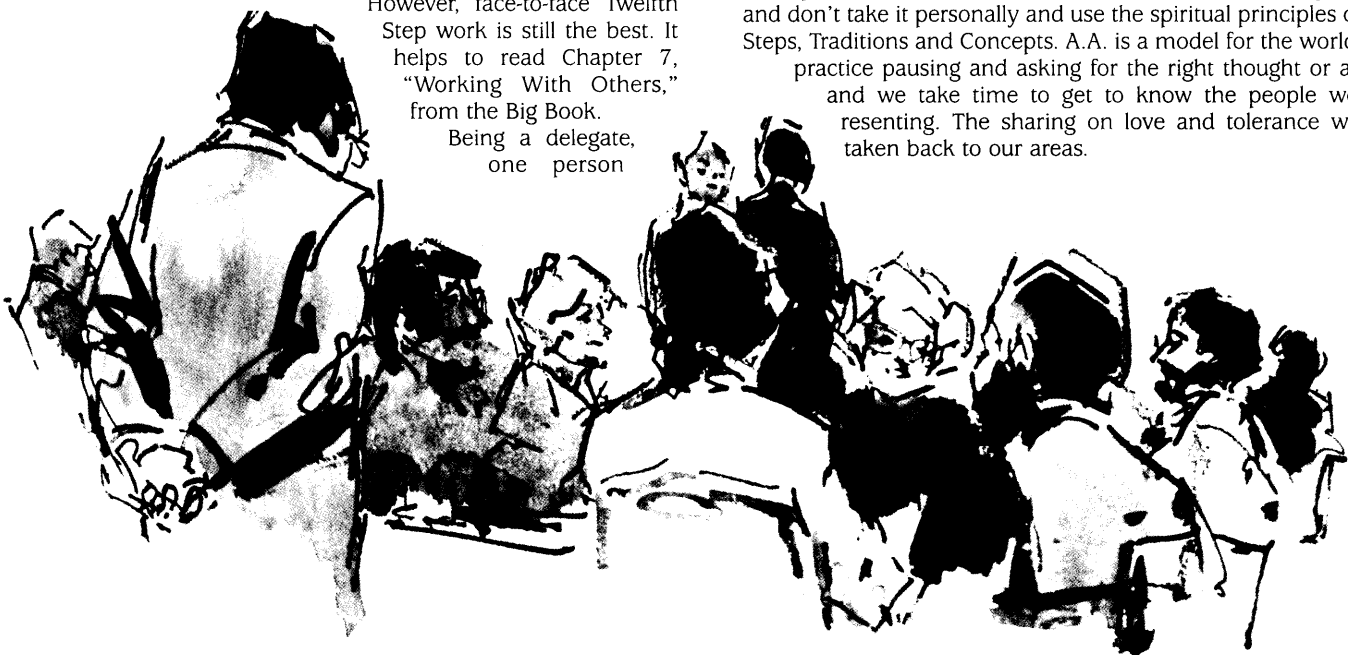
Challenges range from personality conflicts at the area level to learning how to love and tolerate newcomers at the group level. The issue of drug addicts/primary purpose is an ongoing challenge. The dynamics of "dominant" members or an "agenda-driven" member taking control is a challenge.

Placing principles before personalities is always challenging. Patience and tolerance come more easily than love. Even with many years of sobriety and lots of experience there are still difficult situations in which we still have problems with love and tolerance. We need to watch how we conduct ourselves and resist the urge to say, "I told you so." When in the minority we might not do well with acceptance. We need to remember that others love A.A. as much as we do and, although we may not agree with everyone, we need to deal with different people.

Love and tolerance always relates to personalities—not principles. All of us are getting better in terms of love and tolerance, but we are not perfect. Think of all of those with whom you are currently practicing "love and tolerance," and then remember that if A.A. can keep those folks sober it must be a really strong program. We need to listen to the person not the personality. Putting ourselves in other people's shoes helps us understand.

We need to ask ourselves—"what kind of participant am I?" "How do I react?" "Do I try to do things differently?" "How am I treating others today?" Sometimes detractors can become valuable allies and teachers. It takes practice to learn how to love and tolerate the actions of others. We learn that we cannot control others—that the problems often reside within, and if one acknowledges the interior problem, the problems with others disappear.

Experience is the best teacher; handle criticism with patience and don't take it personally and use the spiritual principles of the Steps, Traditions and Concepts. A.A. is a model for the world. We practice pausing and asking for the right thought or action and we take time to get to know the people we are resenting. The sharing on love and tolerance will be taken back to our areas.



Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the 2008 Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

- 1 The Advisory Action of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, Item B2, which recommended that the statement: "This directory is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture" that appears on the cover of A.A. Directories be made significantly more prominent, e.g. use borders, larger type face, etc., be rescinded. (See Advisory Action #23).

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 2 The theme for the 2009 General Service Conference be: "Our Commitment to Carry A.A.'s Message—Enthusiasm and Gratitude in Action."
- 3 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 2009 General Service Conference:
 - a) Humility and Sacrifice:
 - 1) Setting an Example
 - 2) Changing Our Perceptions
 - 3) Anonymity—Sacrificing Our Egos

b) Enthusiasm and Gratitude:

- 1) Hope and Purpose from Defeat and Despair
- 2) Happy, Joyous and Free
- 3) Enthusiasm—A Gift of Inventory

c) Spiritual Program in Action:

- 1) Maximum Service—Our Spiritual Benefit
- 2) Persistence—The Key to Progress
- 3) Living the Traditions

- 4 The following be the workshop topic for the 2009 General Service Conference: "Language of the Heart—Keeping It Simple."

ARCHIVES¹

No recommendations.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 5 The video segments directed to professionals in the legal/criminal justice and healthcare fields to be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site be approved with suggested changes and that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities oversee these changes.

CORRECTIONS

No recommendations.



¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 6 The trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee gather input from the Fellowship on the benefits and liabilities, both spiritual and practical, of fully funding G.S.O. services to the Fellowship (G.S.O. functional expenses) by the voluntary contributions of A.A. members and groups and that this information be forwarded to the 2009 Conference Committee on Finance.

GRAPEVINE

No recommendations.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS'

It was recommended that:

- 7 The undernoted four cities, expressed here in alphabetical order, be considered as possible sites for the International Convention in 2020: Detroit, Michigan; Los Angeles, California; New Orleans, Louisiana; Vancouver, British Columbia.
- 8 Up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to attend the 2010 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

LITERATURE

No recommendations.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

- 9 Scott Ahlgren, alternate delegate, Area 36, Southern Minnesota, be seated as a Conference member at the 58th General Service Conference because Samira Anderson, the Panel 57 delegate for Area 36 is unable to attend.
- 10 José Trinidad Romero Luna and Elfido Quintas Ordaz from the General Service Board of Central Mexicana; Louise Foxcroft from the General Service Board of Great Britain and Ann Napier, general secretary G.S.O. Great Britain, be admitted to the 58th General Service Conference as observers.
- 11 The 61st General Service Conference be held May 1-7, 2011, since these dates do not conflict with any significant holidays, hotel availability and Bylaws' deadlines of the General Service Board, Inc.
- 12 Representatives from other national A.A. service entities be granted admission as observers upon their request to the annual General Service Conference of the United States and Canada; that admission is not to exceed three countries and two representatives per country; that the request for admission be made through the General Service Office in New York;

'Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

and that decisions regarding responsibility for guest observer expenses be at the discretion of the General Service Board.

- 13 The responsibility for General Service Conference site selection be delegated to General Service Office management, subject to approval of the General Service Board; and that a report be forwarded to the 2009 General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

- 14 The 2008 television public service announcement, "I Thought," developed by the trustees' Public Information Committee, be approved and that reference to newspapers be added to the tag line.
- 15 The 2008 television public service announcement, "I Thought," be centrally distributed, tracked and evaluated at a cost not to exceed \$35,000, in addition to the work of local Public Information committees.
- 16 The Conference Committee on Public Information annually review current television public service announcements for relevance and usefulness, retiring a P.S.A. only when it is no longer relevant and/or useful to the Fellowship.
- 17 The Conference Committee on Public Information annually assess the need for a new television public service announcement.
- 18 The script for Combination Radio P.S.A.s on CD (R-10) be revised and updated and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information.

- 19 The Membership Survey pamphlet and one-way Membership Survey display be updated to reflect the findings from the 2007 Membership Survey.

- 20 A wall poster for young people with information about Alcoholics Anonymous be developed and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information.

REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

- 21 The following new section and an illustration of the District Information Change Form (F-43) be added to Chapter Three of *The A.A. Service Manual*, after the section on redistricting:

"District Information

"It is important that the district send information to the area, G.S.O. and to the local intergroup/central office, if applicable. While local, area and national offices communicate regularly, they have different purposes and different mailing lists.

"There may be one person in the area, frequently the area secretary or the area registrar, who is responsible for transmitting district contact information changes to G.S.O. One simple form has been developed to facilitate this, the District Information Change Form (F-43) shown on the following page. The form is used whenever a district elects a new D.C.M., D.C.M.C., or alternate D.C.M., or when any contact information for the D.C.M., D.C.M.C., or alternate D.C.M. changes. When filling out the form, it is important to fill the sections in for the old information and for the new



information, and to note at the top of the form the area and the date when the new information will become effective.”

- 22 The Online Intergroup of A.A. (OIAA) be listed in a new section titled “Online Intergroups” under the section “International Correspondence Meetings” in the A.A. Directories above where “Online Meetings” appear; the listing will include the online intergroup Web site and e-mail addresses.

- 23 The statement “*This Directory is not to be used as a mailing list or for any form of solicitation or commercial venture*” that appears on the cover of A.A. Directories be made significantly more prominent, e.g. use borders, larger type face, etc. **(Rescinded by Floor Action)**

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

- 24 The revised video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be completed with minor changes and brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities for review.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

- 25 The following slates of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. in May 2008:

Class A

Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE	The Honorable
Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.	Rogelio R. Flores
William D. Clark, M.D.	Herbert I. Goodman
Ward B. Ewing, D.D.	Jeanne S. Woodford

Class B

Kenneth P. Brueggemann	Raymond Massey
Conley F. Byrd, Jr	Robert Mayer
Paul Cleary	Madeleine J. Parmley
Dorothy L. Hurley	Victor Phillips
John J. Kane, Jr.	John Skilton
Jo-Anne Lowenberger	Dorothy Wilson
Howard Lowery	

Note: The General Service Board will operate short one Class B regional trustee.

The following slate of officers be elected at the second quarterly meeting of the General Service Board in May 2008.

<i>Chairperson</i>	Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D.
<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	Herbert I. Goodman
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	William D. Clark, M.D.
<i>Treasurer</i>	Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE
<i>Secretary</i>	Robert Mayer

- 26 The February 2008 appointment by the chair of the General Service Board of the following officers be approved at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in May 2008:

<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald W. Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Adrienne Brown

This appointment process is in accordance with the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws.

- 27 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. World Services Corporate Board in May 2008:

Adrienne Brown	Greg Muth
Paul Cleary	John Skilton
John J. Kane, Jr.	Jane Tolar
Roberta Lindeman	Dorothy Wilson
George G. Martin	

- 28 The following slate of directors be elected at the annual meeting of the members of the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board in May 2008:

Ginger Rhoades Bell	Dorothy L. Hurley
James Branscome	Raymond Massey
Robin Bromley	Madeleine J. Parmley
Conley F. Byrd, Jr	Andrew M. Talbert, Jr.

Note: The Grapevine Corporate Board will operate short one Class A trustee director.

- 29 The amendments to the 2007 General Service Board Bylaws, as forwarded from the General Service Board to include options for interim changes to member trustee ratio and composition in response to the 2007 Advisory Action, which instituted consideration of all eligible Class A and Class B trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board be approved.



Presentations and Reports

FINANCE REPORT

Monday afternoon the Finance report, followed by questions and sharing, was given by Vince Keefe, treasurer of the General Service Board and chairman of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee. For more details please see the finance section of this Report, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary report.

Good afternoon. My name is Vince Keefe and I am a grateful Class A trustee and treasurer of the General Service Board. It is my privilege to deliver the Treasurer's report to the 58th General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous.

The complete report of our independent auditor, Owen J. Flanagan and Company, will be included in the finance section of the Final Conference Report. Our audit partner, Kevin Sunkel, is available to answer any questions that may arise from this report. Also available are Don Meurer, chief financial officer of the General Service Office, and Eugene O'Brien, controller of the A.A. Grapevine. Don and Eugene are talented and dedicated managers who work tirelessly in supervising our accounting activities and we are fortunate to have their service.

The format for my report, as in previous years, will be a PowerPoint presentation designed to show the key points of the financial condition of the General Service Board, as well as A.A. World Services, and The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. My primary goal in this presentation is to help you become as familiar as possible with our financial condition, so that you will be able to communicate clearly when you return to your area. I continue to believe that a sure way to improve the service structure is for each of us to develop a clear understanding of the finances of the Fellowship. Clarity in our understanding translates to clarity in our communications, so please do not hesitate to ask any questions. Your area will be listening carefully to what you have to report after this Conference, and I am anxious to help you communicate clearly in any way I can.

This financial presentation is organized into five basic components: (1) our General Service Office, (2) A.A.W.S. publishing activities, (3) La Viña, (4) The A.A. Grapevine, Inc., and (5) the General Service Board Reserve Fund. We will primarily focus on the results for the calendar year 2007; however, prior year results and the 2008 budget are also included to permit a broader perspective.

We will be reviewing 11 slides covering numerous topics, with considerable data for each slide. Time will only allow for a quick review of each slide. Copies of the slides from this presentation have been placed before you, and the entire presentation is available in electronic format, including text. My e-mail address and home phone number are also available and I hope you will feel free to call or e-mail with any questions. And remember that Don Meurer, who understands this information better than anyone of us, is available and willing to help with any questions.

Our first chart summarizes the cost of the service functions performed at your General Service Office on behalf of the General Service Board. I am sure that we are

all familiar with each function listed, with the possible exception of the last line entitled Supporting Services. Supporting Services includes the administrative, accounting, human resources, information technology, rent, and other indirect overhead costs. It would be difficult for the various service functions to operate without this support structure. The total cost of the General Service Office functions for 2007 is \$8,528,079, approximately \$256,000 or (3.1 %) more than the \$8,272,012 spent in 2006.

Health Insurance Benefits for Retirees: For many years we have offered health insurance coverage to our retirees. For each retired employee, we currently pay between 25% and 75% of this cost, depending on the length of service of the individual employee, and the retiree pays the remainder. Until 2006, this practice was done on a "pay as you go" basis—no funds were set aside to pay future benefits. When the insurance bills came in, we paid them, and that was it. Generally Accepted Accounting Principles requires that our financial statements include an expense each year for a portion of the amount that will be paid for or on behalf of current employees during their retired years. As a result, each year a liability has been recorded for a portion of the future medical insurance payments, which will be made for the benefit of our current employees after their retirement. This liability of \$4,122,317 appears in the balance sheet included in your Conference Manual. Given the size of this liability, we decided in 2006 that it would be prudent to create a fund, separate from our Reserve Fund, to accumulate money to help pay these future benefits. Our goal is a modest one—fund half of the balance sheet liability within the next 10 years. Payments have been made into this fund by A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine in the amounts of \$228,092 for 2006, and \$250,992 for 2007. We plan to make comparable payments into the fund each year for the foreseeable future. Premium payments to the insurance companies will continue to be made from the operating accounts of A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, and not from the new fund.

Defined Benefit Pension Plan: We established a defined benefit pension plan in 1965 to provide pension benefits to A.A.W.S.





range of services performed by the General Service Office on behalf of each group. The next few slides explore the question of how we pay for these important service functions. As you know, the General Service

Board has three sources of funds: group contributions, A.A.W.S. literature profits and transfers from the Reserve Fund.

In 2007 the General Service Board received group contributions of \$6,526,000, which is an increase of \$458,000, or 7.6%, over last year. This is the third year in a row when we saw

substantial growth in contributions made to support the activities of your General Service Office. I am sure I speak for everyone through-

out our entire service structure when I say how deeply grateful we are for this outpouring of support from across the Fellowship. We are

grateful for every member who has sent in a contribution to help pay the bills of your General Service Office. A special word of thanks to all the delegates, D.C.M.s, and G.S.R.s who worked to help make this strong result possible. Your hard work is most evident by looking at these gratifying results. The three things I hope you continue to do well are: communicate, communicate, and communicate.

Chart #7 summarizes the financial performance of A.A.W.S. publishing activities. Gross sales of literature in 2007 amounted to \$12,730,000, which is \$723,000, or 6%, greater than 2006. After deducting the cost of goods sold and shipping and warehousing costs there remains a gross profit of \$7,051,000, or 55.3% of sales. We then deduct Program Expenses of \$2,264,910 and Supporting Expenses of \$1,770,987, leaving an Excess of Revenue over Expenses of \$3,015,813. One note of concern in reviewing this chart is the steady decline in the Gross Profit percentage. We can see a steady decline from 57.3% in 2006 to 53.7% in 2008 due to the increases in the Cost of Literature Sold, as well as Direct Shipping and Warehousing costs.

La Viña, our Spanish-language magazine, reported improved financial results for 2007. Gross profit from the sale of magazines and related items equaled \$67,781, an increase of \$26,534 over 2006. After deducting the costs and expenses of \$134,821, the result is a loss for 2007 of \$ (67,040). This compares to a loss in 2006 of \$ (72,110).

The A.A. Grapevine, also had a very encouraging year. We have just heard a very complete report describing in detail the extensive work underway to solve a myriad of issues before the Grapevine Board. The A.A. Grapevine reported total magazine income of \$1,950,000 in 2007. Magazine gross profit was approximately \$1,183,000. Gross profit from related items was approximately \$485,000, giving a total Gross Profit of \$1,667,000. Total Costs and expenses of \$1,765,000, less Interest Income of \$73,000, are then deducted leaving a loss for 2007 of (25,000). The Grapevine budget for 2008 anticipates a profit of slightly more than \$3,200.

As I said last year, it appears that we have put the Grapevine in a no-win situation. What we have done is this: first, we ask very capable individuals to take on the responsibility of being directors of the Grapevine, second we ask them to maintain the

and Grapevine employees. A contribution is made to this plan each year by each of the corporations, and the plan then handles the monthly retirement payments. The amount of the contribution is based on the advice of our actuaries in order to assure that all legal requirements as to the adequacy of the pension fund are continuously being met. The contribution to the pension plan in 2007 amounted to \$1,060,600, which was approximately \$350,000 greater than 2006. A contribution of \$1,060,600 is included in the 2008 budget. The pension fund had a market value of slightly more than \$14 million as of December 31, 2007. Roughly 2/3 of this fund is invested in a diversified portfolio of equity investments, such as common stocks, and the remaining 1/3 in fixed income investments. This provides a balance between the safety and stability of fixed income investments with the potential for long-term growth provided by equity investments. In the short term, of course, common stocks exhibit much more volatility in value, and one effect of the new 2006 pension law will be that changes in the value of the Pension Trust portfolio will have a bigger effect on annual contribution requirements than they did in the past. Our annual obligation to contribute to the pension fund will thus be an increasingly important element in the cash flow planning of our A.A.W.S. and Grapevine directors and management.

You will find in our consolidated balance sheet a net unfunded pension liability of about \$4,548,000 as of December 31, 2007. This is approximately \$300,000 less than the amount you would have seen in our financial statements last year if we had been required to follow the 2007 reporting rules in 2006. These liabilities represent a commitment to future payments over a very long period of time, and with the continued support of our membership, we should be able to meet these requirements in the ordinary course of our business without affecting the level of our services to the Fellowship.

The next chart is very similar to the first, except in this slide Supporting Services have been allocated across the activities to show the fully absorbed cost of each activity. Group and member statistics are shown at the bottom of the slide. We can see that a contribution of \$6.88 per member or \$154.92 per group in 2008 will allow the Fellowship to be fully self-supporting from contributions.

Chart # 5 shows a detailed breakdown of the Group Services activities. This is intended to give a broader understanding of the

independent voice of our Fellowship (a very precious tradition), third we ask them to be sure that the Grapevine remains self-supporting. After doing all of this many of us then hesitate when it comes time to subscribe to the magazine. How can the Grapevine ever meet our expectations without the support of all of us?

Here are a few facts worth remembering about our Grapevine magazine: Last year I spoke to you about the positive impact that 100 new subscribers per delegate area could have on the Grapevine's mission and financial status. Thanks in large part to your efforts, circulation went up a little more than 2,100 in 2007, reversing the downward trend we've seen the last few years.

- This year, I would like to spend some time discussing the biggest challenge that the Grapevine has always faced: its unique business model. In order to be the voice of the varied members of A.A., rather than any group or even the General Service Board, the Grapevine is self-supporting. Unlike A.A.W.S., it does not receive group contributions. And unlike other association magazines, the Grapevine doesn't take ads or membership fees and supports itself entirely through subscriptions and the sale of other items.

- The Grapevine has always kept its prices low in order to make Grapevine material as widely accessible as possible. In 1945, subscribers paid \$2.50 for a subscription to pay for the cost of an 8-page newsletter. If this price were increased each year, just equal to normal inflation, then today's price would be \$26.66. Currently the Grapevine charges \$20 for a subscription to a 64-page magazine.

Last year we spoke about the financial benefit new subscriptions would bring to the Grapevine. In fact, we learned that the Grapevine would be on a sound financial footing if just 9% of the membership would subscribe. I know many of you took this idea to your area and you made progress. So please keep up this effort, as it will likely take several years to reach our target—a subscription rate of 9% of our membership.

Chart # 10 shows a combined financial overview of the General Service Board for the year ended December 31, 2007. The General Service Office shows contributions, interest and literature profits totaling \$9,524,660. We then subtract the cost of services provided of \$8,528,079, leaving a surplus for 2007 of \$1,018,581. Next we subtract the operating losses of the A.A. Grapevine (\$25,047) and La Viña (\$67,040), leaving a net combined surplus of \$926,494 for 2007.

The last part of our analysis will cover the General Service Board Reserve Fund, which ended 2007 with an adjusted balance of \$11,069,850, equal to approximately 9.6 months of operating expenses. This means that we remain in the lower end of the acceptable range in terms of the number of months of expenses covered. The Reserve Fund at the end of 2006 was the equivalent of 8.8 months of operating expenses.

I would like to remind everyone again of the key actions that have been taken in recent years to maintain the Reserve Fund within an acceptable range. As you know we have:

- Reduced the price of the Big Book by \$1 coincident with the publication of the 4th edition.
- Restored the price of the Big Book in July 2004 by raising the price by \$1.
- Announced increases in certain book prices and handling charges effective July 1, 2005.
- Accomplished a major cost reduction program at the General Service Office to lower our annual operating costs.

As a result of these actions the Reserve Fund has fluctuated between 12 equivalent months of operating expenses in calendar

2000 to 9.6 months at the end of 2007. So, what can we say about our financial condition as we end 2007 and move along into 2008? Here are my thoughts:

- Our pension and post retirement health obligations now account for 15% of the annual General Service Office budget. We will need to sustain this annual level of contributions of approximately \$1,350,000 well into the future. In spite of the size of this obligation we are managing our expenses to stay within our revenue stream.

- The management teams and boards of both operating corporations continue to perform extremely well and remain a true asset to the Fellowship.

- Group contributions were 7.6% higher in 2007 as compared to 2006. This is the third year in a row that we have seen significant growth. I believe that each delegate in the room today deserves a "tip of the hat" for a job well done. And, of course, the biggest accolades go to our contributing members. Thank you from everyone involved in the Service Structure of the Fellowship. Your contributions make it possible for our General Service Office to work tirelessly in the background of Twelfth Step work.

- The Grapevine and La Viña have both turned in better financial performance in 2007. Subscriptions to both magazines have grown and hopefully will grow again in 2008.

- A.A.W.S. certainly finished in a strong position and might find it useful to look more closely at the recent decline in the percentage of gross profit on literature.

- And finally, the Reserve Fund grew from covering 8.8 months of expenses at the end of 2006 to 9.6 months at the end of 2007. This performance is undoubtedly influenced to a large degree by the higher level of contributions and literature sales. Yet we shouldn't overlook the good management and attention to detail shown by our general manager, financial staffs, and operating boards. 2007 was another year of very good work.

This year will undoubtedly be marked with surprises, new faces, and plenty of opportunities for the Fellowship to continue to prosper. Let's just "keep on doing what we are doing," always trying to be a little better, and 2008 will be another good year for the Fellowship.

*Vincent E. Keefe, treasurer
General Service Board*

UNITY

Monday evening's presentations on Unity were moderated by Bill Clark, Class A trustee.

Our Common Welfare Should Come First

It will come as no surprise to anyone that there are abnormal things going on here. It is not normal for an alcoholic to be sober. We are people that would not usually mix. That we will likely leave here on Saturday unified will be something of a miracle.

When Bill W. spoke or wrote about unity, he invariably used the word "sacrifice" in close proximity to the word "unity." For my own good, the good of the group and subsequently Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, I must discard (sacrifice) my desire for power, control and prestige—I must acquire humility, that often elusive quality that I knew nothing about until I reached out for help on September 25, 1989 and the welcoming hand of A.A. was there for me. To that point, I had lived on self-will where I

refused any form of assistance. "John will take care of John," was my mantra. Even my wife's actions, which saved my life when I was drunk, went unappreciated until sobriety. I was born with an excessive amount of false pride, irrational fear and anger and lived off that (not very happily, I might add) for 47 years. I finally realized things had to change as I began taking a moral inventory of myself instead of someone else, for the first time in my life. My friends in A.A. and the A.A. literature informed me that I needed to turn to that Higher Power, who I had recently acquired a nascent understanding of, and work in partnership with Him to have all my defects that stem from fear and pride removed; or at least reduced to a level that I could live comfortably with.

SACRIFICE = UNITY = SURVIVAL (*Daily Reflections*, p. 190), not exactly $E = mc^2$ for its popularity, but nonetheless very critical to those of us who strive to have a meaningful, sober life. "The unity of Alcoholics Anonymous is the most cherished quality our Society has," Bill wrote in *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* (p. 129). We must work together or we perish alone. In my first home group of typically six or seven members in my small hometown, we each had individual talents. We would all gather at a member's home and carry out renovations or additions and socialize sober while doing the work. A couple of members were amateur musicians who entertained on many occasions. We had barbecues in summer and Christmas gatherings in winter. If a member was in distress, someone would mobilize the others who would collectively pull that suffering member back on track and support him until he could manage on his own. Service to A.A. as a whole was important. Annual contributions to each A.A. entity were a given. This little group, also, provided two D.C.M.s and a table officer to the area committee over its first 12 years in existence. Needless to say, it was healthy and mature, proving that, if we work and play and serve together, we are likely to be happy, joyous, free and united as a group.

When we gather as a group to share our collective experience, strength and hope where no individuals dominate, either in time or demands, we support the old adage that, when acting in unity, we are stronger than the sum of our individual parts. When members practice the Twelve Steps, and when group members practice individually and together the Traditions, the group is then in a position to offer meaningful assistance to those who still suffer in the darkness that we ourselves once wallowed in. Our experience has shown that an individual member who thinks he has all the answers and flies alone is doomed to failure, loneliness and unhappiness. And giving lip service doesn't cut it—we must practice the talk! I can say as many times as I like that I love A.A. and my group, but if I don't show it, what is its value?

"True brotherhood, harmony, and love, fortified by clear insights and right practices, are the only answers." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Come of Age*, p. 98). This seems a tall order. Putting our common welfare first; allowing a loving God to guide us; being all inclusive; asking ourselves, "Is this in the best interests of A.A. as a whole?"; sticking to what we know best; being unaffiliated;

being self-supporting; being nonprofessional and unorganized; avoiding public controversy and even practicing dignified silence when appropriate; being attractive and having fun; maintaining anonymity at the public level, but being approachable; placing principles above personalities—all will get the job done. Bill was, I believe, inspired by a loving God to write these Traditions based on A.A. experience. When I live the Traditions, I am doing God's will. If I live in harmony with the group by following the Traditions, the group has a better chance of survival and, therefore, so do I. When I remember where I've been and appreciate where I'm at today, it is difficult for me to work against the common good. Gratitude for the gifts that are bestowed on me as a result of my sacrificing in this Fellowship is the key to having a workable attitude. I invariably get much more than I give.

Controversy is averted by insisting on a substantial majority when voting on important matters. Who can argue with a two-thirds agreement or, in the case of going to the hat, God's will?

Well, some might. Bill said that the worst kind of politics that A.A. could get involved with is when a member doesn't accept the majority decision and keeps regurgitating the issue. Is this one of the things he was referring to when he said that the biggest concern we have is destruction from within? Of course, there are occasions when standing up for the Principles can generate hurt feelings, but many times an A.A. entity has become stronger and more mature as a result of this kind of controversy.

As we all know, nothing creates disharmony more than disagreements over money. When I make my

contribution to my group, I expect that the money will be used to carry the A.A. message. I do not want it to gather dust in a vault waiting for some rainy day that likely will not come. My current home group distributes its funds twice a year and keeps only 150 dollars each time. This is our idea of a Prudent Reserve, but our expenses are small and our resources are adequate. The district in which I live has typically operated without a Prudent Reserve, but when the need has been demonstrated, the membership has responded. At the beginning of last year, Area 91, for all intents and purposes, had no Prudent Reserve. The D.C.M.s went back to the G.S.R.s and communicated effectively where the money was being spent and demonstrated that there was a need. The area committee prepared the budget themselves so that the D.C.M.s bought into it and were able to defend it. At the end of 2007, Area 91 had a true six-month Prudent Reserve. Just going out to the membership and saying, "So and so needs money," only raises hackles. Meaningful communication invariably leads to greater participation, one of the demonstrated keys to unity.

Finally, when we look at where we've been and what we have done in our pasts and compare it to the present, we often wonder in awe, "Did I really do that?" when God's will enters our lives.

This truly has been an honor for me to present at this 58th Conference. Thank you for listening.

John Fraser, Saskatchewan



Principles Before Personalities

Tradition One, some say, states the problem—"Unity"—and Tradition Twelve the solution—"Principles before Personalities." My tendency on reading this solution is to think "Okay, got it." After all, once I know the Traditions, I just place those principles before personalities. How easy is that?!

Unfortunately, for this alcoholic at least, it's just not that simple. Having been forced, against my will, to make rigorous self-examination a part of my daily life, I know how easy it is to place personalities first, without really being aware of it. And I've found many different scenarios that can lead me astray.

Often, the problem starts with the personalities of others. There's the "enemy of the state." This is the A.A. member who expresses opinions and beliefs that I know are dangerous to A.A.—wanting to change the wording of the Big Book, or insistence that it's okay to solicit outside contributions. Then there's the "Talker Not Walker"—the thirteenth stepper, or the one who cheats on his/her spouse or steals from his/her employer. And sometimes it's simply a matter of bad chemistry, someone I dislike from the get-go, although I couldn't say why. If I am not careful, I will oppose these people on almost any issue without hesitation, because I know they must be wrong.

I have a less severe reaction to other types. The class clown who has to get a laugh every time he or she speaks. The ones who study Robert's Rules of Order and jump at any opportunity to use them. The ones who always oppose everything, or everything that involves spending money. Although I usually like and sometimes love people who are these types, I can tune out when they speak or discount what they have to say.

I can err in the other direction, agreeing with someone based on who they are, such as the elder statesmen, or because of certain talents or abilities, such as the financial wizards, the great public speakers, or the fonts of A.A. knowledge. In all of these situations, I can make a decision to support or oppose something based at least in part on the person presenting it, without the careful thought or scrutiny that I would like to believe I use.

More insidious are the problems caused by my own personality. Our assembly is filled with great people, dedicated, talented and hard-working. Some of them are longtime friends whom I dearly love. Some are new to general service, eager but still learning. I can easily support their proposals or quietly vote against them. But I do not want to speak in opposition, and will wait and wait, hoping someone else will voice any concern I have. If I dig deeper, I find that I do not want anything I do to be perceived as meaning I don't like or don't respect someone, whether it's proposing an agenda item that can be misconstrued as being against someone, or just speaking in favor of or against someone else's proposal. I don't want to hurt anybody's feelings, and I don't want anyone to think that anything I do is personal. Left unchecked, this can silence me when I ought not be silent.

Okay, now what? How do I avoid, or try to avoid, placing per-

sonalities before principles? Studying our Traditions helps. It's hard to place principles first unless one knows what they are. Developing that habit of rigorous self-examination is another key. Maybe there's not something wrong with me *everytime* I'm disturbed, but if I am disturbed, I need to find out why. And my review at the end of the day, if done honestly, can help me see if I've fallen short without being the least bit disturbed about it.

I also use prayer and faith. Using the Serenity Prayer before business meetings is important to me. The moment of silence is a good time to ask for direction. I also ask to be reminded who the ultimate authority is. If I have faith, if I believe that the ultimate authority really is a Higher Power whose will really is expressed through the group conscience, then all those present become equally important, regardless of their personalities. And lastly, I ask to be reminded what anonymity really means: That we as individuals, as personalities, are not important. The Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous is what's important. The principles embodied in our Traditions, Bill's "Twelve Points to Assure Our Future," are the directions given us to ensure its survival. God willing, we will never allow personalities of any sort to pull us from that path.

Linda Seamon, Louisiana

Diversity: Reaching Out to All Alcoholics

When I was asked to give a presentation on Unity, Diversity, Reaching Out to All Alcoholics, my thoughts went to early sobriety and how I came to A.A. trying to be different. As so many of us have said, "You don't understand, I'm different" the color of my skin is different, my cultural beliefs are different—and all you told me was: "The only requirement for A.A. membership is a desire to stop drinking."

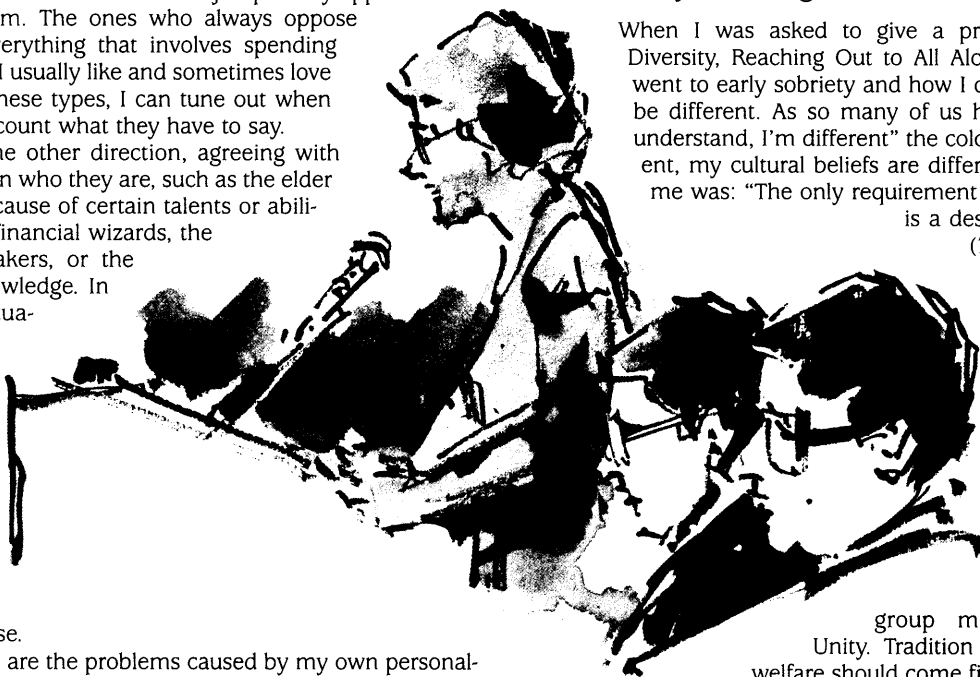
(*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, Tradition Three)

So began a journey that so many of us experience (a day at a time), which not only changes our lives, but relieves the obsession to drink. On this journey we hear a lot of our home

group members talk about Unity. Tradition One: "Our common welfare should come first; personal recovery depends upon A.A. unity." Unity, as described in

Webster's Dictionary: "Oneness, a condition of harmony: accord, continuity without deviation or change (as in purpose or action)." This is why it is so important that all A.A. groups study and adhere to the Twelve Traditions. Without group unity and recovery from alcoholism in A.A., my common welfare and your common welfare wouldn't be possible. Without group unity the new drunk would probably make a statement close to this: "I could find this kind of attitude at the local bar, plus I could drink and get drunk with my brother drunks."

Diversity, as described by Webster's: "The inclusion of diverse people (as people of different races and cultures) in a group or organization." Alcoholics Anonymous members come from all walks of life, different races, social, and religious backgrounds.



Big Book p. 17: "We are people who normally would not mix." But because we suffer from this disease called "alcoholism," this statement gives us drunks and drunkettes a common problem with a common solution—working A.A.'s Twelve Steps. So a question can be asked, is A.A. reaching a diverse section of alcoholics? As Tradition Five (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 140) states: Do we "cater *only* to the pure and respectable alcoholic?" Are we reaching a good cross-section of drunks? Is the hand of A.A. there for all who suffer from this seemingly hopeless disease? *Are we in A.A. reaching out to all alcoholics?* Tradition Five (*ibid.*, p. 150): "Each group has but one primary purpose—to carry its message to the alcoholic who still suffers." The unique ability of each A.A. to identify himself with and bring recovery to the newcomer in no way depends upon learning, eloquence, or any special individual skills. The only thing that matters is that he or she is an alcoholic who has found a key to sobriety. A.A. can't be all things to all people, nor should we try. We have been given a singleness of purpose, to carry A.A.'s message of recovery, nothing more, nothing less.

Communication: "The communication process starts with the A.A. group, which lets its group conscience—for or against change, approval or disapproval of a proposed action—be known to the elected general service representative (G.S.R.)." The communication process continues when the G.S.R. "makes sure the group's wishes are heard and fully considered at the district and area levels, and that they are part of the delegate's thinking at the Conference." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S17)

The Key to Unity will always begin with A.A.'s Twelve Traditions and the foundation that our A.A. groups build upon. "The entire structure of A.A. depends upon the participation and conscience of the individual groups. ...As co-founder Bill W. noted in 1960, 'We obey [the Twelve Traditions] willingly because we ought to and because we want to. Perhaps the secret of their powers lies in the fact that these life-giving communications spring out of living experience and are rooted in love.'" ("The A.A. Group," p. 8)

Self-Support: "While the Fellowship has always faced problems of money, property, and prestige in one form or another, through the wisdom of the Seventh Tradition we have never been diverted from our primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers—wherever he or she may be. This is the fundamental work of Alcoholics Anonymous, and to ensure that the hand of A.A. will always remain outstretched, money and spirituality must continue to mix. And for that, we are all responsible." ("Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix," p. 8)

Thank you for allowing me to be your trusted servant.

Paul Alexander, Oklahoma

COMMUNICATION AND PARTICIPATION

Before the Tuesday afternoon trip to G.S.O., Conference members heard presentations on communication and participation. John Kane, Northeast regional trustee, chaired.

Sharing the Message of Service

I just can't find words to express what I am feeling at this moment. As a French-speaking delegate, I really thought I wouldn't be asked for a presentation at this 58th Conference. On the other hand, I've always extolled the virtue of communication and participation, this year's theme, to the extent of convincing myself that this is the key to our unity and our sense of belonging in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Surely, like many of you, I remember when I arrived 41 years ago. I was then told to sit down, keep it shut, look and listen. Funny communication! Anyway, in the state I was in, it was about all I could do. But today, several persons would willingly pay to shut me up!

In my beginning with A.A., I promptly felt the sense of belonging to my group, of being part of the gang. Of course, I didn't have a penny for the collection. The only contribution I could bring for my group survival, as well as mine, was to take up tasks. This is what the old members had suggested to me; I was at the time 24 years old! I shook hands and welcomed members, did the coffee. (I was told my coffee was unbeatable and I willingly gave my recipe to others!) The experienced members had already started sharing with me the message of service.

Many of them, by their attraction, have become my examples. I remember this beautiful lady wearing hat and gloves who, on the first night helped me drink my coffee. My hands were shaking to the point of spilling it. Only in Alcoholics Anonymous can we see such things! From this experience, which I could never forget, I can assure you that I myself make a duty of welcoming the newcomers, no matter their physical or psychological state.

Another person who quite impressed me at the beginning was the guy who carried cases of soft drinks. He always arrived arms loaded and in the best of moods! Every third step he would take the time to drop cases to the floor and shake hands. I thought to myself: I want to be like this guy! I even offered to help him so I could feel what he was really living. My God, this guy was beaming!

I also remember old Dave, founder of A.A. in Québec. He was telling us how his heart was "full of gratitude" and encouraged us to carry on the message. "Carry the light torch," he kept on saying.



Never has the attraction of active members stopped making an impression on me. Among many others from G.S.O., I'd like to mention my late friend Bill Archer, who left us in 2004. He was an extraordinary link between my area, as well as the whole of Québec and G.S.O. He gave me the feeling and interest to serve more and more, on all levels. He made it seem possible.

I wouldn't like to overlook our present Western Canada trustee, Tom Kraemer, who comes to Québec doing all his coordinations and presentations in French! His courage is an example to me. His kindness, as well as his love for service, are also impressive. Thank you, Tom. You're my inspiration.

All through the years, there have been members like these, who taught me the luminous way to service; leading to joy, love, enthusiasm and humor. The way revealed to me one of the most powerful of spiritual laws: the more we give, the more we receive! And, believe me, I'm one of the richest. It's a real horn of plenty!

I arrived at A.A. shy and weak. After meeting these generous, available, full of life, trusting and loving people, I thought: "Wow! I want to have what they have!" and I followed their example. A very dear and close person confided to me that I had the same effect on her. Today, she is full of life, humor and enthusiasm! She's my girlfriend.

Therefore, we don't have to deprive ourselves to share with others the royal way to happiness through service. I quite often tell members a secret of longevity: "God, like never before, so much needs servants that he will keep you alive for a long, long time!" Nowadays, in some people's mind, the notion of service seems to belong to the past, that it's an out-of-date value. It's too bad, because spiritual values will never be outdated, nor will their positive effect.

According to our Three Legacies, the philosophy of our program teaches us that "True ambition is not what we thought it was. True ambition is the deep desire to live usefully and walk humbly under the grace of God." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, p. 124-125)

Of course, sometimes it's hard! It's very demanding, especially when you have to face controversy. When it happens, because we all have to face it, I always think of great explorers who conquered Everest. One of them, Bernard Voyer, great Québec explorer, talks in a very striking way of the super human effort expended to reach the last metres to the top. Ten more; breathing burning your lungs between each step, and all of this to have the chance of sitting 30 seconds at the top, and climb down again!

We must never let go or abandon a passion, because this might be the precise moment when the miracle is about to happen! Our friends Bill and Bob understood this principle, when at the beginning of their dream, while the problems grew in numbers, they never lowered their arms. Are we going to let them down today?

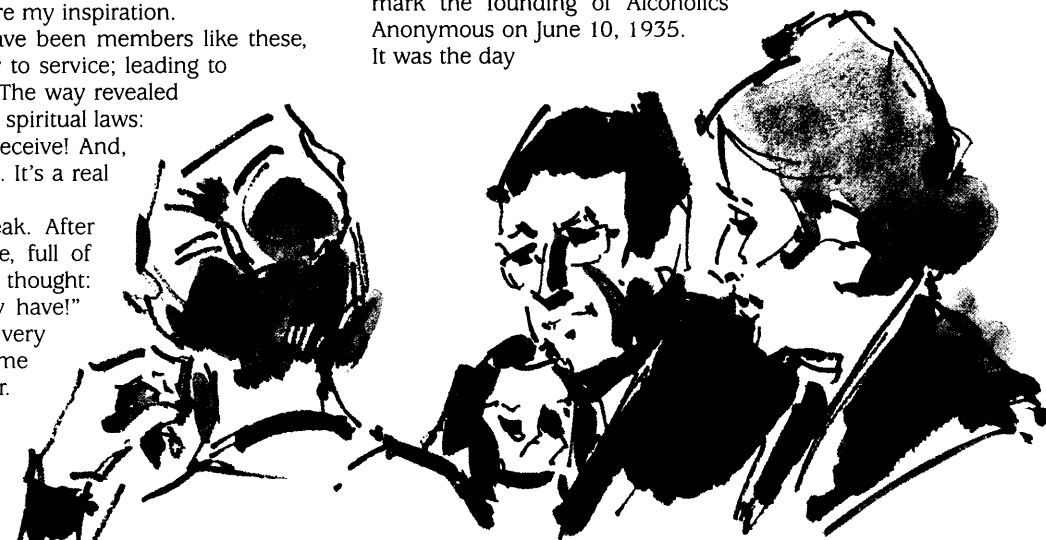
As far as I am concerned, Alcoholics Anonymous and services in A.A. transformed me, and my heart is filled with gratitude! This is why, with the help of my Higher Power, I could climb the highest of peaks to help the still-suffering alcoholic. "I am responsible... when anyone, anywhere, reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that, I am responsible."

Claude Matteau, Southeast Québec

Our Key to Keeping A.A. Strong

Ours is a Fellowship that bases its very existence on an oral tradition: one alcoholic talking to another. Each day, in rooms around the world, countless people—countless A.A. members—are recounting their stories, similar to that story of a bleak November day in 1934 when Bill and Ebby talked for hours on end, about drinking and the possibility of a spiritual solution.

We as a society mark our founding not on the day that Bill got sober; instead we mark the founding of Alcoholics Anonymous on June 10, 1935. It was the day



Dr. Bob had his last drink—one alcoholic talking to another.

In his story, "Dr. Bob's Nightmare," on page 171 of *Alcoholics Anonymous*, Dr. Bob notes that what this stranger, Bill W., said to him was different than anything else anyone had said to him many, many times before. Why? His answer was simple, "This was a man who had experienced many years of frightful drinking. ...Of far more importance was the fact that he was the first living human with whom I had ever talked, who knew what he was talking about in regard to alcoholism from actual experience. In other words, he talked my language." (*ibid.*, p. 180)

Today, with all of our discussions about singleness of purpose, and our primary purpose, and all the issues about how we carry the message, I have to ask, "Are we still speaking one another's language?" As a follow-up, I have to ask myself, especially with regards to our service structure, "What keeps A.A. strong?" I believe that *paying attention* to our Traditions certainly helps to keep our Traditions strong. And how do I, or how do we, treat our fellows—is it with mutual respect and love? Does this mutual respect and love allow us to speak the same language? Yes, I think it does.

The message of Unity, from our First Tradition, allows us to have divergent opinions, yet we finally come together when the best of the group is more important than the better of an individual. We communicate, but in the process, as in this General Service Conference, we sometimes raise our voices, we stomp, we pound, we laugh and we cry—we communicate with each other in search of the highest good.

Our communication—deep thoughts—thoughts from the heart—invigorates what we know is not empty rhetoric from the A.A. Declaration of Unity: "This we own to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; to keep our Fellowship united. For on A.A. Unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come."

As we come together from 93 service areas, from highly pop-



ulated areas, from places of just two or three, we at this annual meeting will discuss those issues that might make our Fellowship more appealing to those with a drinking problem. But let's not forget about those already here. What are we doing to keep the lights on for those now in the rooms who might be having second thoughts?

I believe, in my heart of hearts, that our discussions this week—one alcoholic talking to another—will again set an example of all that is right with our Society. We can, as one alcoholic talking to another, make the case that what we do together is a good thing for those of us with a drinking problem, be it long ago or just a few days ago.

And what of participation? Do we make this service to our Society appealing or appalling? What do we do about the refrains of politics? I think the simple answer is to approach all things with the language of the heart. Because we are a people with a vivid, robust, and yet a simple idea: "Our primary purpose is to stay sober and help other alcoholics to achieve sobriety."

May God continue to bless Alcoholics Anonymous. May God continue to bless each of you.

Kiki Roddy, District of Columbia

Leadership in A.A.: Building Communication

We are living in an age where communication has become very easy and accessible. Cell phones, Internet access, e-mailing and text messaging afford us the near instantaneous ability to be in communication with each other. This fact was demonstrated by the exponential increase in pre-Conference electronic dialogue among Panel 57 and Panel 58 delegates compared with last year.

While most of the early communication addressed area procedures and practices, i.e. roles of past delegates, responsibility of area chairs and treasurers and the functioning of committees, some of the later dialogue clearly demonstrated the potential for abuse in both the nature and content of these mass e-mailings. I think we need be ever mindful of and take care not to violate the Concepts and Warranties as they affect Conference practice and structure; with accessibility comes responsibility.

I have often heard it said that if A.A. is destroyed it will be from within; with this in mind let us be the guardians of the

Steps, Traditions and Concepts. Let us take care not to encroach on the principle of "Right of Participation" of all Conference members implicit in Concept Four and Warranty Three. Let us remember that delegates are only 93 of the 138 Conference members; that the Conference starts with the roll call on Sunday afternoon. Let us be certain that consensus is arrived at on the Conference floor, after debate, and not through e-mail politicking.

From the flyer "On Trust," enclosed in the Communications Kit, "Each of us justifies that faith by participation at the Conference in a spirit of fellowship and trust. We are respectful of the committee system which brings matters to the Conference for consideration. We trust that a democratic process engaged in by people acting in good faith will be in the best interest of our Fellowship, *even though we may not agree with all the decisions made.* We trust that future Conferences will carry on A.A.'s wonderful legacy of service, just as those who came before us have placed that same trust in us." I wonder where that spirit of fellowship, respect and trust was in the correspondence criticizing the trustees' committees handling of agenda items. Long ago I was taught that change comes slowly in Alcoholics Anonymous and for good reason—there is so much at stake. The analogies drawn were those of stopping a train or turning a large ship at sea; neither happens on a dime—the process is slow and methodical. The Fourth Edition Big Book was first proposed in 1989; it was not published until 2001. If a proposed agenda item has merit, it will eventually appear on the Conference floor. We have a beautifully effective committee system in place that has served us well for 57 years. I cannot believe "the train ran off the tracks" over the past twelve months.

I do believe, however, that it is imperative we exercise responsible leadership as we build communication. That the information shared is complete and accurate. That we not state opinion as fact. That when we are unsure about something we get the facts before we issue opinions. That we keep the record straight so that myth does not dominate fact. That we not disparage the character of or question the integrity or competence of a service leader or committee because we disagree with a decision made. Concept Three states (pp. 14-15): "Therefore some traditional and practical principle has to be devised which at all levels *will continuously balance the right relation between ultimate authority and delegated responsibility.* How, then, are we going to accomplish this? ... The right A.A.

solution for this problem is to be found, however, in the latter part of Tradition Two which provides for 'trusted servants.' This really means that we ought to trust our responsible leaders to decide, within the understood framework of their duties, *how they will interpret and apply their own authority and responsibility to each particular problem or situation as it arises.* This sort of leadership discretion should be the essence of 'The Right of Decision,' and I am certain that we need not have the slightest fear of granting this indispensable privilege at nearly every level of world service. There will always be plenty of ultimate authority to correct inefficiency, ineffectiveness, or abuse. ...But for so long as our world services function reasonably well—and there should always be charity for occasional mistakes—then 'trust' must be our watchword, otherwise we shall wind up leaderless."

Concept Three further states (p. 16): "Our entire A.A. program rests squarely upon the principal of mutual trust. We trust God, we trust A.A., and we trust each other. Therefore we cannot do less than trust our leaders in service. The 'Right of Decision' that we offer them is not only the practical means by which they may act and lead effectively, but it is also the symbol of our implicit confidence."

In the pre-Conference delegate dialogue someone alluded to "blind trust" not being their thing. I assure you, neither is it mine. Rather I have a trust born of faith; faith in God, faith in A.A. and faith in all of us doing what is in the best interest of A.A. I have one prayer and one prayer only for the future of Alcoholics Anonymous. I pray that the program, fellowship, and service structure that was present in 1990, when this drunken bum stumbled through the door of a meeting and was catapulted into a life of indescribable joy, still be there in 2090 and 3090 for those yet to come; for the child yet unborn who will surely need what we have to offer.

In closing I quote our co-founders: Bill Wilson, "So it has been with A.A., by faith and by works we have been able to build upon the lessons of an incredible experience. As I look out across this crowd there floats back to me a mighty assurance and this is a mighty assurance for A.A.'s future, that indeed it will go on for so long as God wants us. So I can only say may God bless and keep you and Alcoholics Anonymous forever." And finally, in the immortal words of Dr. Bob, "Let's not louse this thing up!"

Bob Conley, Southeastern Michigan

THE A.A. GRAPEVINE

The Wednesday afternoon presentation/discussion session on the Grapevine was chaired by Andy Talbert, Grapevine director.

Unity and Communication

I have been asked to give a presentation on The A.A. Grapevine: Unity and Communication. We A.A.s are unified in that we care about the Grapevine. Established in 1944 by "six ink-stained wretches," as Bill W. called them, our magazine has grown to an average monthly circulation of 106,099 (2008 Grapevine Office Report), carrying the message within the Fellowship and to our friends. The Grapevine's purpose is creative; it is a source of communication within our program and the Grapevine can be a forum for debate.

Debate itself seems useful. From discussions in the Grapevine about the General Service Conference in the 1950s, to ongoing conflict about the God Stuff, dual-addiction, profanity, and lots more, people have identified concerns about issues and we have come to define those much more clearly.

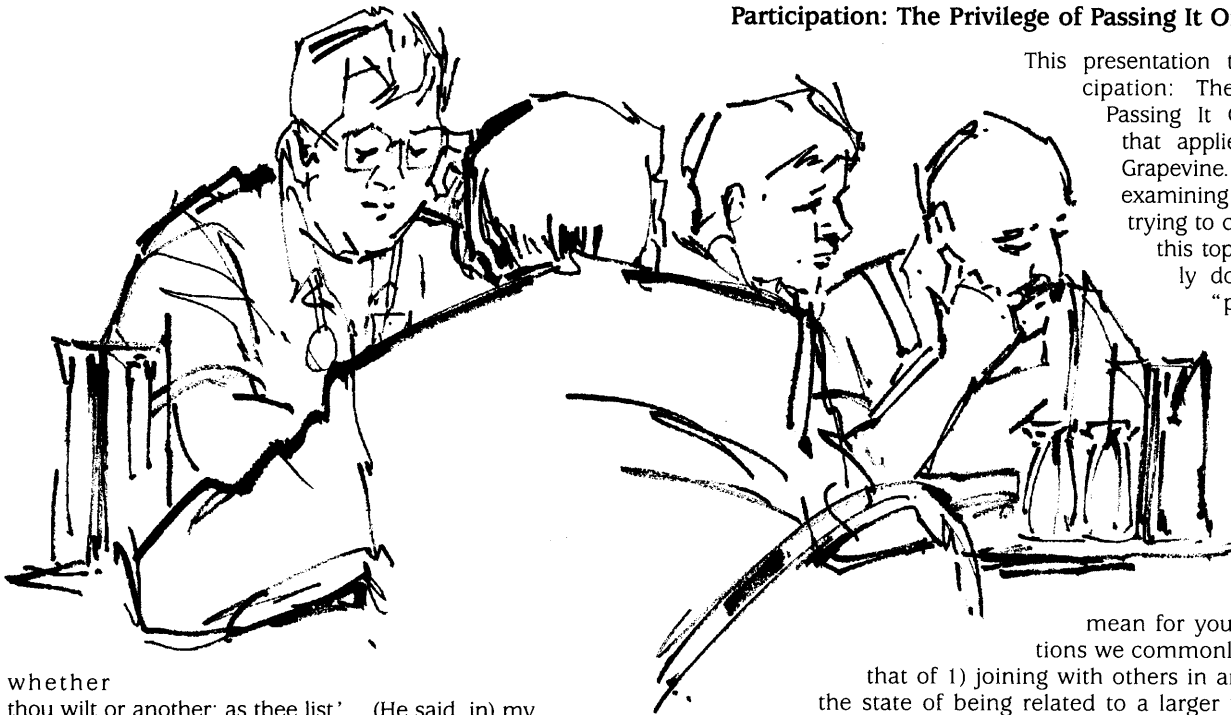
I looked in the Grapevine digital archives and found a piece by a man from Texas who expressed resentment that he had to fund those Yankees in New York City—why couldn't they maintain themselves? About four years later, he was elected to the first panel of the General Service Conference at New York City in 1951, and saw that "the Yankees who had carried our message to millions—(were operating) in the red, because of our negligence and indifference." (June 1951 Grapevine) The man from Texas was presenting awareness of both sides, and it is likely that many would identify with him, and be moved by his story. By contrast, many members expressed enthusiasm and gratitude about the first panel.

On "The God Stuff," in his last major talk, Dr. Bob, who referred to God as "our Heavenly Father," said, "when we take time to find out some of the spiritual laws, and familiarize ourselves with them, and put them into practice, then we do get happiness and peace of mind." (Grapevine, June 1973, from a transcribed Dec. 1948 talk)

An anonymous atheist wrote of his struggles with a Higher Power: "from a small book written in the fourteenth century.... 'And such a word is this word God or this word Love. Choose thee



Participation: The Privilege of Passing It On



This presentation topic is "Participation: The Privilege of Passing It On," and how that applies to the A.A. Grapevine. Let's start with examining what we are trying to communicate in this topic. What exactly do we mean by "participation, privilege and passing it on" and how do these terms relate to the A.A. Grapevine?

What does "participation" mean for you? Some definitions we commonly associate are

that of 1) joining with others in an activity or 2) the state of being related to a larger whole. From a business standpoint, one might view participation as 3) ownership or 4) receiving some benefit from the performance of an asset.

So how do these definitions of participation relate to the A.A. Grapevine? As a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, I join with two million others in this Fellowship in a common bond of recovery from alcoholism. I attend meetings, share my experience, strength and hope and try to carry the A.A. message of recovery to the still-suffering alcoholic. If the A.A. Grapevine is our International Journal of Alcoholics Anonymous and referred to as our "meeting in print," how can I participate in only one part of our program and not in the other? How can I not subscribe to the A.A. Grapevine? Do I have to write a story in order to participate? My own personal experience is that regardless of whether I speak at a meeting, I participate by listening and, most importantly, I benefit by simply being present. In fact, I usually gain more by listening than by sharing. When I subscribe to the A.A. Grapevine, I participate in our "meeting in print" and I benefit when reading the collective sharing of other fellow members and again, I benefit just by being present. Like our definition, I join with others in that shared activity and feel related to a larger whole. I take personal responsibility for its usefulness and continued success and feel "ownership" by being a subscriber. I want to pay whatever it takes to make the A.A. Grapevine the best possible magazine for recovery. How can I place a price tag on its value? How much did I spend on that non-fat, double shot, mocha this morning? Or that ice cream last night? How much did I spend on my last night of drinking?

When I write for the A.A. Grapevine, I also feel related to my fellow members of Alcoholics Anonymous and feel I actively participate in my recovery by sharing my experience, strength and hope in our "meeting in print." There may be some of you who do not like the content of the A.A. Grapevine and therefore excuse yourself from participation. Where I got sober, they have a saying, "If you have a headache and you won't take an aspirin, then just shut the heck up." When deciphered it means I can't complain if I don't want to hear the solution. If you don't like the content, then contribute. And calling your sponsor always helps as well.

whether thou wilt or another; as thee list,'... (He said, in) my present Godless, but hopeful sobriety, when I begin to get tense with debating, I stop. Not God, just love. What is love? Don't know—don't have to...An act of love—that's the ticket." (Grapevine, August, 1968) Although he came from a different point of view about God, he seemed to mirror what Dr. Bob said.

Cross addiction—One person quoted the Preamble and wrote: "That must be the sentence so many people can't seem to catch. It doesn't say one word about drugs." (Feb. 1989) Another said: "We must not stray from our primary purpose of helping the alcoholic who still suffers, but our attitude must change toward those who are cross-addicted." (ibid) David F. asked, "And what about those tens of thousands of dually-addicted alcoholics who now fill the rooms of A.A.? Are they a problem or an opportunity" in "a growing, healing, tolerant, and ever-changing Fellowship." (May 2004). Here are three points of view that all make sense and show how we could work through the problem.

Profanity—A writer questions, "I wonder how many times Bill W. used foul language in an A.A. meeting? In our open meetings we usually have newcomers who are hoping to improve their lives. What incentive are we offering them if, with our language, we are showing them that we really haven't made much of a change for the better? (Jan. 1987) In "Our Way, Not My Way" a man opposed to banning swearing in his group explained, "Instead of just cursing, I had to explain how I felt and why" and that led to "a growing self-awareness," which helped him identify a deeper pain and "let people in through the language of the heart rather than of the street." (Feb. 2008) Due to his group's conscience, this man gained a fuller living experience.

The Grapevine has presented different points of view that (almost) all make sense and deeply reflect our Fellowship. Not only that, the Grapevine has been working for us and through us in a "language of the heart" as Bill W. said, where our "kinship of suffering" combines with the message we must carry or we perish—a language all our own. (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 243)

Debate presents awareness of both sides to all who are willing to consider pros and cons and gives us truth in the end. This is communication and it leads to unity.

Liz Olmstead, Central New York

Now that I know what "participation" means, what does "privilege" mean for me? For me, it is defined as a right not enjoyed by everyone. My sobriety is a free gift; I have done nothing to earn this gift. Otherwise, it isn't technically a gift, is it? For every one of us blessed to be here in this room today, there exist another 80,000 out there dying from alcoholism. I enjoy the right, the gift today of attending meetings of Alcoholics Anonymous, being able to assemble here today as the 58th General Service Conference of the U.S. and Canada. This is a privilege freely given to me by my continued participation in this program of recovery, my gift of a daily reprieve from active alcoholism, granted by my Higher Power. If I am grateful for this privilege then it makes sense I would put that feeling into action, as I have been taught that gratitude is an action word. Evidence of my action is my participation in the A.A. Grapevine as one of the best recovery tools I can have in my arsenal. It can go anywhere, anytime, and reach someone who needs a meeting, a "meeting in print." So by my continued participation in Alcoholics Anonymous I am given a gift not enjoyed by all. By subscribing to the A.A. Grapevine and reading the collective sharing of my fellow A.A. members, I feel a part of the great whole of Alcoholics Anonymous, I participate in its future success and my sobriety is enriched just by being present.

This is all great and wonderful, but what about the third part of our topic, that of "passing it on?" Isn't that our legacy? What good does the gift of sobriety do if all I do is hoard this phenomenal blessing for myself? Don't I have to try to give it away in order to keep it? Did my Higher Power really give me this free gift, this feeling of being a small part of a great whole, this wonderful joining together with my common sufferers from this illness of alcoholism just to have me keep it all to myself? Why would I want to do that with the A.A. Grapevine? I have this wonderful tool that is our "meeting in print," able to reach out to any alcoholic, anytime, anywhere.

I have read the letters from inmates, who shared of being in a lonely, dark place in their disease, who found a copy of the A.A. Grapevine inside the walls and how the stories, your stories, contained within its pages, touched their hearts and changed their lives, so much so they had to pick up pen and paper and write to the A.A. Grapevine to tell what happened. I have a sponsee who shares how she had a very difficult family encounter this Christmas and felt absolutely lost afterwards. She shares how she did not want to bother anyone on Christmas but needed someone to talk to. She picked up the Grapevine and lo and behold, a story spoke to her of family and resentments and recovery. She shares how that one story helped her to make it through that day. She is now my home group's GVR, and you can't shut her up about the power of the stories shared in the A.A. Grapevine. She feels she must share the gift of the A.A. Grapevine with everyone. She doesn't want to keep it to herself; she wants everyone to have this same privilege.

So, today I challenge all of you to embrace this privilege we have all been given, to participate in the ownership of the A.A. Grapevine by subscribing and actively participating in its success, for being present in our monthly "meeting in print" and to pass it on to those in need of your experience, strength and hope. And remember, it can only be the best "meeting in print" if you write for it, so send your stories to your International Journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, the A.A. Grapevine.

Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee

SELF-SUPPORT

Roberta Lindeman, A.A.W.S. director, chaired the Thursday afternoon presentation/discussion on self-support.

Self-Supporting Through Members' Voluntary Contributions Only

My topic is, "Self-Supporting through Members Voluntary Contributions Only." There are two points I would like to make: 1) It is okay that we are currently self-supporting through member contributions and book sales, and 2) we need to educate our groups about the spiritual rewards of the Seventh Tradition, not pressure them with questionable ideas about book sales.

There seems to be the implication that we are not "fully" self-supporting if we use revenue from the sale of our literature to help pay for our general services. I believe that we are fully self-supporting through both group contributions and book sales. Since our Big Book was first published we have used the revenue from book sales to help with the funding of services and to create the Reserve Fund.

In *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age* (pp. 203 and 204) Bill writes, "In 1945 we wrote Mr. John D. Rockefeller, Jr., and the 1940 dinner guests that we would no longer need their financial help. The book royalties could now look after Dr. Bob and me; group contributions could pay the general office expenses. If these were insufficient, the reserve accumulated out of literature sales could meet the deficit. This meant that we had finally declared for full self-support. Since that time A.A.'s Board of Trustees has steadfastly refused outside contributions."

So it seems that Bill felt way back then that A.A. owned the book, so that revenue realized from its sales should be used to "pay our way." This was the beginning of the Seventh Tradition, we pay our own way, "declining outside contributions."

In *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* (pp. 66 and 67) Warranty Two of Concept Twelve states in part: "In about half of the last twenty years, A.A. group contributions have failed to meet our world needs. But the Reserve Fund, constantly renewed by book sales, has been able to meet these deficits—and save money besides." Bill continues, "Some of us have another concern, and this is related to so-called book 'profits.' The fact that A.A. Headquarters and most of the groups sell books for more than they cost is thought to be spiritually bad. But is this sort of noncommercial book income really a profit after all? In my view, it is not. This net income to the groups and to A.A.'s General Services is actually the sum of a great many contributions which the book buyers make to the general welfare of Alcoholics Anonymous. The certain and continuous solvency of our world services rests squarely upon these contributions. Looked at in this way, our Reserve Fund is seen to be actually the aggregate of many small financial sacrifices made by the book buyers. This fund is not the property of private investors; it is wholly owned by A.A. itself."

Some of you here may ask, does this mean that by selling literature to outside organizations we are accepting outside contributions? I don't think so. I believe that the literature sold to outside organizations always finds its way to the real purchasers of our books, who are new and potential A.A. members. This means that even early in recovery these new members are making their small financial sacrifices in supporting our services, possibly before they are contributing in "the hat."

It seems to me that book sales are as good for the Fellowship as group contributions. So is there something wrong with paying for services with the revenue from our book sales? I don't think so.

I believe one of the best things we can communicate to our



groups is about their opportunities to celebrate the Seventh Tradition and the ways they can participate in being fully self-supporting and help pay for our services. Let's tell them that full participation in the Seventh Tradition means paying our service bills at all levels of our structure, without accepting any outside financial help. Let's not mess our message up by making voluntary contributions better than income from the sale of our literature. There are small groups in my area, Western Washington, who are unable to make voluntary contributions to the board after paying their own expenses, but they do purchase A.A. literature to have available for their members. They make every bit as valuable a contribution to our Fellowship's self-support as the group with excess funds that is able to regularly send those funds to our general service offices. Maybe, instead of focusing on being concerned whether or not we are "fully self-supporting" in regard to services paid for by revenues from book sales, we can focus on being fully self-supporting by informing our groups about the spiritual rewards of the Seventh Tradition and raising the number of groups that contribute toward the service bill at all levels of our structure.

What this has meant in the lives of uncounted alcoholics who might never have reached us had our services been weak or non-existent, no one can guess. Financial prudence has paid off in saved lives. Further down the page, still in Warranty Two, Bill explains the services that might be cut if we did not use the "book money" and contributions were low, such as letting go of staff at our G.S.O., shutting down the A.A. Grapevine or reducing it to a second-rate publication and reducing the number of delegates attending the General Service Conference.

Gail Harris, Western Washington

Contempt Prior to Investigation

On page 568 of the Fourth Edition of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, there is a quote that I suggest might be beneficial to some of us. It states: "There is a principle which is a bar against all information, which is proof against all arguments and which cannot fail to keep a man in everlasting ignorance—that principle is contempt prior to investigation."—Herbert Spencer.

This is under Appendix II "Spiritual Experience" in our Big

Book. "Willingness, honesty and open mindedness are the essentials of recovery. But these are indispensable," was also quoted on that page. How open minded are we when we hear the words self-support?

It seems to me that just as many of us in our early sobriety struggled with spirituality, much the same can be said of many members with reference to self-support.

When I asked the alternate delegate of our area for her thoughts on the topic she, being a lady of few words, simply said, "Ignorance equals fear." That statement was absolutely on target when I gave it some more thought. Most people when they hear the words self-support come back with something to the effect that they always give their money when the basket is passed for the Seventh. Why is self-support thought of merely as money? In *As Bill Sees It*, on page 259, "Servant Not Master," reads: "In A.A. we found that it did not matter too much what our material condition was, but it mattered greatly what our spiritual condition was. As we improved our spiritual outlook, money gradually became our servant and not our master. It became a means of exchanging love and service with those about us."

Have we as sponsors and service sponsors really done our job in carrying the message of self-support? Much needs to be done to show that money and spirituality can and do mix! Bill W.'s sponsor, Ebby, when he heard how serious Bill's drinking had become, resolved to visit him in Brooklyn. Ebby's "resolve was not enough; he had to take action and to spend money. He called me on the phone and then got into the subway; total cost, ten cents. At the level of the telephone booth and subway turnstile, spirituality and money began to mix. One without the other would have amounted to nothing at all. Right then and there, Ebby established the principle that A.A. in action calls for the sacrifice of much time and a little money." (*Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*, p. 141)

Tradition Seven tells us "Every A.A. group ought to be fully self-supporting, declining outside contributions." That says that we alcoholics are going to pay our own bills, we are not going to be dependent on anyone else, we will no longer have our hands out but will freely give of ourselves, both financially and with our talents. Now isn't that an interesting word—talents.

The long form of Tradition Seven reads: "The A.A. groups themselves ought to be fully supported by the voluntary contributions of their own members. We think that each group should soon achieve this ideal; that any public solicitation of funds using



the name of Alcoholics Anonymous is highly dangerous, whether by groups, clubs, hospitals, or other outside agencies; that acceptance of large gifts from any source, or of contributions carrying any obligation whatever, is unwise. Then, too, we view with much concern those A.A. treasuries which continue, beyond prudent reserves, to accumulate funds for no stated A.A. purpose. Experience has often warned us that nothing can so surely destroy our spiritual heritage as futile disputes over property, money, and authority." (*Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, pg. 190-191)

In closing it is my humble hope that we always strive to carry the message of self-support, whether to the newcomer or the longtimer. Just as we repeat the Steps, the Traditions, and How it Works at meetings, if we continue to communicate and participate through self-support in time, talents and money, possibly we will have thoroughly investigated and contempt will become obsolete.

Dot Dykstra, Eastern Ontario

Responsibility to Communicate and Participate

I would like to talk about our "Responsibility to Communicate and Participate" as it applies to our most sacred of A.A. services. This is the service upon which our entire Fellowship stands, the service upon which our own individual sobriety is ensured, the service upon which our future rests. I am, of course, referring to our Twelfth Step and our responsibility of carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous, which our program was founded on, including introducing new members to our history, the development of our service structure and of services currently provided by G.S.O.

As members of Alcoholics Anonymous we are responsible to be self-supporting in terms of communicating with, and participating in the lives of the men and women that we sponsor. The Twelfth Step is not optional. I believe that if we who have recovered would communicate more effectively about the importance

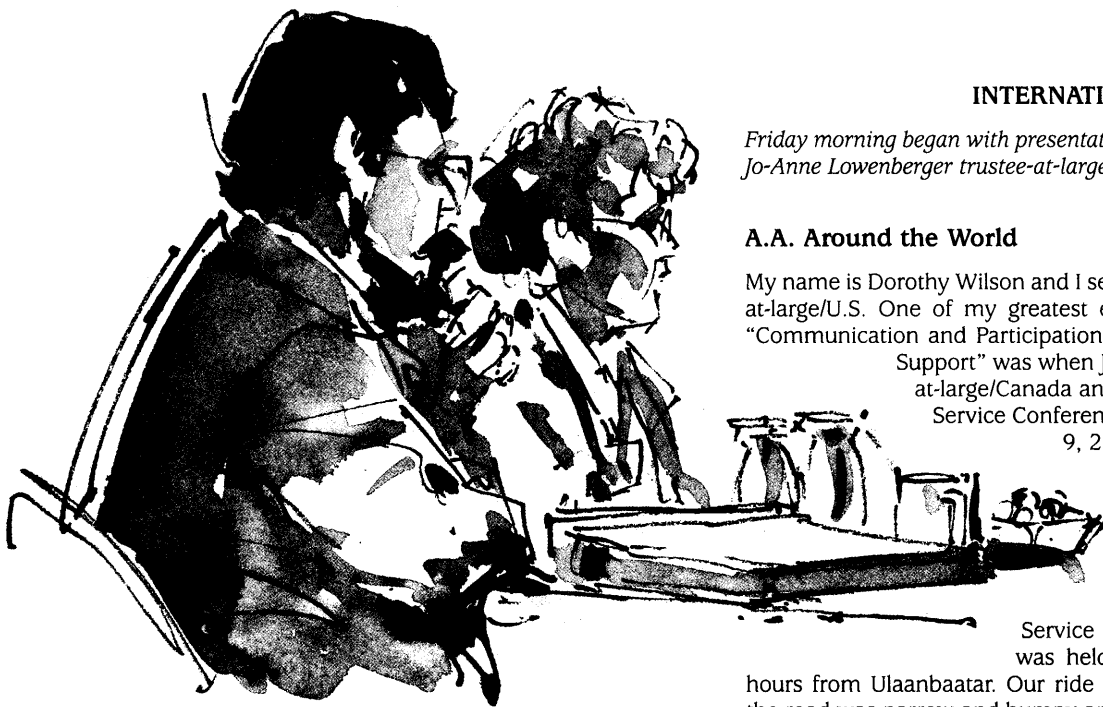
of our A.A. services, and talk about how those services work to reach the still-suffering alcoholic, that more of our Fellowship would participate with contributions of both money and time. Through our individual efforts in sponsoring people we can make a difference, one person at a time.

I know that all of us here have participated in workshops, panel discussions, and cluster meetings, often talking about how to get more people involved or how to increase contributions. We have driven many miles and spent countless hours participating in group, district, area and regional events. This is all to the good, but I believe that our most effective work has been and always will be done one on one with the people that we sponsor. When we sponsor, we genuinely gain their trust and we can talk openly to them about the services that A.A. provides. We can help them to make the connection on how our services, at all levels, work to reach the still-suffering alcoholic, and how important it is for us, individually and collectively, to support those services.

On page S22 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, under the heading "Stimulating Interests in General Service" it says: "Most A.A. members are primarily interested in their groups, in their own sobriety, and in helping other drunks one-on-one. And that is as it should be. While the work of general service has precisely the same objective—carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers—the connection is not always direct or obvious. Some stimulators are usually needed to get the attention of A.A. members—to show them that service can add a rich dimension to their sober lives and Twelfth Step work, and that their participation is vital to the future of A.A."

"Good communication is of vital importance. In personal Twelfth Step work, there is no end to communication. But when it comes to general service work, communication has a tendency to break down. It can take hard work to get the attention of alcoholics, but with a creative approach, they can be encouraged to take time out from the nuts and bolts of recovery to think about another phase of their new lives. Once A.A. members are well informed about service, they often want to become involved and to take on their own service responsibilities."

There are several communication tools available from our



INTERNATIONAL

Friday morning began with presentations on A.A. around the world. Jo-Anne Lowenberger trustee-at-large/Canada, was the moderator.

A.A. Around the World

My name is Dorothy Wilson and I serve this Fellowship as trustee-at-large/U.S. One of my greatest experiences with the theme; "Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support" was when Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada and I attended the First General Service Conference in Mongolia, September 7-9, 2007.

Because of communication via e-mail, personal contact and word of mouth, 54 registrants (24 delegates) were able to participate in their First General

Service Conference. The conference was held at a tour camp about two

hours from Ulaanbaatar. Our ride was very interesting because the road was narrow and bumpy and many times we had to wait for animals to cross the road. Arriving at the camp we were shown to our living quarters (our yurt) for the next few days. It was so heart warming to hear some of the people laugh and talk until the wee hours of the morning. The camaraderie was overwhelming.

The conference started with three gentlemen carrying the Mongolian flag down the hill and everyone else cheering, clapping and wiping eyes. This certainly exemplified a great feeling of unity; it didn't matter where we came from, because we were all there for the same reason and were so grateful to be a part of A.A. history in Mongolia.

The first order of business was the general manager talking about the Seventh Tradition and how they needed to be self-supporting. Discussion ensued about how this was going to be done. After many ideas were presented, they decided to do the Third Legacy voting on three different amounts to see how much each group would have to contribute per year. The amount that came out of the hat was equivalent to \$425.00 per group. One of the delegates commented that if they are required to pay that amount, they have just lost another group because there were only two members in his group and they certainly couldn't afford that. Jo-Anne and I were really squirming about the whole incident, but we were observers and knew we would later need to talk to the general manager.

Later in the evening, the general manager came to our yurt and asked to talk to us. He explained that he had such pain in his heart because of what had transpired earlier in the day with the Seventh Tradition. We again explained that we need to be fully self-supporting through our own voluntary contributions and that there are no dues or fees. If we assess these, we are in violation of the Tradition. It was decided that it was his responsibility to bring this to the attention of the conference members and when this was fully explained, they voted to amend what had happened the day before and they would send in voluntary contributions. Everyone was so elated with this decision. They agreed, through communication and participation, that if they were going to have unity and lay the foundation for A.A. in Mongolia, they would need to follow A.A. Traditions.

Another example I have experienced has been with the National Service Office in Warsaw. The office in Poland began translating *Twelve Concepts for World Service* by Bill W. in 2004.

General Service Office that are designed to show people the kind of help G.S.O. offers to groups everywhere. These tools include videocassettes, audio tapes, CDs and CD ROMs, as well as a variety of literature. As a sponsor I see it as a personal duty to become familiar with these tools and utilize them whenever possible to help the new member become more familiar with A.A. services.

Concept 12, Warranty Two, page 65 of *The A.A. Service Manual* states in part: "Sometimes we hold off when we are asked to meet area or Intergroup service expenses. As to world services, we may remark 'Well, those activities are a long way off, and our group does not really need them. Maybe nobody needs them.' These are very natural and understandable reactions, easy to justify. We can say, 'Let's not spoil A.A. with money and service organization. Let's separate the material from the spiritual. That will really keep things simple. But in recent years these attitudes are everywhere on the decline; they quickly disappear when the real need for a given A.A. service becomes clear. To make such a need clear is simply a matter of right information and education.' "

We have a great responsibility as sponsors to clearly and effectively communicate about the value of our A.A. services. Perhaps the most important and sometimes the most difficult thing that we try to transmit to the new members is the importance of placing the welfare of other people ahead of their own. That their new lives are now going to be about service to God and the people about them. These are themes that run from cover to cover in our Big Book. I am a believer that if the new member really understands this, through the working of the Twelve Steps, they will, by virtue of their spiritual awakening and the example set by a sponsor, become active in and support our services.

Service in A.A., although often overlooked and often picked at, is for many of us the payback. The payback on an account that can never really be paid back, except through our continual efforts to work within A.A. to ensure that A.A. remains A.A. for the generations to come. Let us never underestimate our responsibility to communicate and participate, and let us never forget that our lives as ex-problem drinkers depend upon our constant thought of others and how we may help meet their needs.

Thank you, Alcoholics Anonymous, for my life.

Mike Maynard, Iowa

Subsequently, sample chapters were sent to our G.S.O. for editorial review and needed to be revised. The manuscript was returned to the N.S.O./Warsaw with editorial comments indicating the translation should reflect more closely the original writing. We were informed that they were having difficulty and requested assistance to finish translating the Twelve Concepts essays. After consulting with the Polish translation team, we decided to initiate the translation on their behalf. After sending them the completed translation, we received many questions about variations in word usage. The confusion dealt with words or terminology with similar meaning. After exchanging phone calls and e-mails, it was decided that Greg M. and I would travel to Poland to participate in a Twelve Concepts Workshop. After many questions and more sharing, it was suggested that our Polish friends consider publishing the translation of the Concepts (U.S./Canada) as prepared by G.S.O., New York. Thereafter, they could form a committee to develop a description of the Third Legacy of Service in Poland, incorporating the basic principles of the Steps, Traditions, and Concepts, and also describe the evolution of A.A. in Poland over the past 36 years. Here again was unity because of communication and participation.

The Fifteenth REDELA (Meeting of the Americas) was held in São Paulo, Brazil, October 17-21, 2007. The theme was "Strengthening Unity in our Countries." There were 20 delegates from 16 countries present. We discussed various ways that we could strengthen our ties through communication, participation and country-to-country sponsorship. We had presentations on unity through communication, of the individual member, of the group and of the country. Without sponsorship of country-to-country, many of these countries would not be able to communicate and participate because of lack of funding. The four committees were: Literature, Working With Others, Policy/Admissions and Agenda. Some of the Brazilian A.A. population lives in the Amazon and it takes at least five days for them to get to an assembly. The Internet has provided a new means of communicating for these members. The theme for the Sixteenth REDELA

to be held in Arequipa, Peru, in 2009 is "Communication—Fundamental Base of Good Service."

We held our first on-line meeting of the delegates on March 20, 2007 through "Paltalk." This was set up by the delegate of Brazil and the General Service Office in Brazil.

Dorothy Wilson, Trustee-at-Large/U.S.

My name is Julio, I am an alcoholic and I am grateful to be a member of staff at the General Service Office. I would like to express my gratitude for this opportunity to share with you today, along with my appreciation not only to the organizers but to all who make the Conference process possible, from the groups and G.S.R.s, to all of you who so unselfishly give of your time to serve Alcoholics Anonymous.

At G.S.O. I currently have the privilege of serving on the International desk. The International desk is the contact point at our office for the A.A. Fellowship outside the United States and Canada. We have A.A. activity in over 180 countries. Service structures vary, but we have close to 60 autonomous and independent General Service Offices around the world. I correspond and share our common experience with both developed and developing A.A. structures. It is important to understand that our office is simply the most senior of the General Service Offices and has no authority over the other offices.

As a drunk, my travels were mostly limited to great dreams while trying not to hit the floor too hard, as I often did, being of the fall-down drunk variety. Little could I imagine a new perspective on life and sobriety, and that one day I would be able to celebrate this life with so many other sober drunks around the world. My responsibilities on the International desk have given me this wonderful opportunity to experience a little bit of A.A. around the world. The assignment has taken me as an observer to several Zonal meetings and as a guest to several A.A. service



events and activities in many countries. It has been a wonderful experience to see how A.A. thrives in different languages and cultures, and to experience the universality of A.A. principles. In the same way, this opportunity provides a unique perspective of A.A. Sharing with A.A.s from countries where the Fellowship is 3, 20, 50 or 60 years old, I often feel I am taking a trip through time, but this time with the experience that shows that happy endings are on the horizon.

During the 9 months since I rotated onto this assignment, I have attended many memorable A.A. activities. Of these, Zonal meetings have been particularly poignant for me. These gatherings of the A.A. service structures in different regions or zones of the world are as much like a meeting of your home group as you could imagine. They have the same primary purpose and the activities revolve around sharing experience, strength and hope. You will find the oldtimers, the newcomers and the middletimers. Just like in any meeting, the focus is on sharing our common solution.

The first of these meetings I attended was the Asia-Oceania Zonal Meeting in July of 2007 in Ranzan, Japan. I was immediately struck by how the older and more established A.A. service structures embrace the newer ones. Structures with many years of experience, like Australia, can share their experience with newer ones, like Mongolia. The European Service Meeting also provides the same forum. At these meetings, communication is established and in many cases will continue and develop into country-to-country sponsorship.

A particularly moving and special occasion this past year was the First Meeting of the West-Central Africa Zone (RACO) held in Chevillat-La Rue, France, from November 29 through December 3. At this meeting of countries from the French-speaking regions of Africa, seven delegates representing Burkina-Faso, Mali, Senegal and Tchad came together for the first time. Delegates from Cameroon, The Democratic Republic of Congo, Ivory Coast and Togo were unable to attend due to last-minute visa situations, but forwarded their country reports and, at least in spirit, were part of the meeting. Seeing this meeting come to fruition brought memories of when our unforgettable colleague Bill Archer, and our trustee emeritus Elaine McDowell shared about their mountain top experiences when visiting the African continent in 2002.

At the meeting we heard a report from Cameroon, where in 1990 a prison warden found information about A.A. and reached out for help to the French

General Service Office. He eventually found sobriety, and in 1996 started the first A.A. group in the prison in which he works. Today Cameroon reports having 11 intergroups, a growing fellowship and a developing service structure.

I was touched by one delegate's sharing of how, as a lonely drunk in Mali in 2005, he heard a transmission of a radio program about A.A. on the International French radio. This chance occurrence started an immediate search for more information and soon after the beginning of the first A.A. group in Mali in 2006. While some of these countries do not yet have a board or formal service structure, we can be confident that the path of A.A. in this region of the world has begun.

Another experience where the A.A. spirit felt present was the A.A. Convention of Central America in San Jose, Costa Rica, in March of this year. At this gathering, which is first a celebration of sobriety throughout this region, representatives from the service structures of these countries take the opportunity to meet and discuss matters of mutual interest. As a group the service structures join forces and send delegates to the World Service Meeting and to the Meeting of the Americas. They also discuss how to best carry the message to the suffering alcoholic in their countries. Recent discussions have focused on why the percentage of female alcoholics in the groups of the region is still low. To help in this process a draft pamphlet is in the process of development, sharing experience and suggestions to help groups better reach the female alcoholic and encourage a greater participation of female alcoholics in the groups and in the service structures. By coming together and establishing good lines of communication these service structures have found a way to participate in A.A. worldwide and do so in unity and self-support.

It's hard to express how grateful I am for these opportunities or to come to a single conclusion, but in thinking of all my recent experiences, what continues to be the most exciting part is the realization that A.A. continues to provide a solution to alcoholics in an ever-growing sample of languages and cultures. With this experience in hand we can look forward to reaching many more suffering alcoholics around the world.

Julio Espallat, G.S.O. staff



Reports from the General Service Board and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Corporate Boards

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD REPORT

Trustees' report: Once again we come together to conduct our annual Conference, our 58th. The theme, Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support, is particularly relevant in light of our experiences since our last Conference. We have been continually reminded that "Actions speak louder than words," and communication rings hollow if not implemented. We are also reminded that self-support leads to mutual support, which leads to unity.

On January 1, 2008, Bob Pearson, who served as G.S.O.'s general manager from 1974 to 1984, died peacefully in Bellevue, Idaho. Bob is remembered as "a mentor and a role model, both as a sober alcoholic enjoying life to the fullest and as a devoted and extraordinarily effective trusted servant in his role as director, trustee and general manager. He encouraged all around him to show initiative and to think for themselves." We are grateful for his life and his 46 years of sobriety. Bob's example will not be forgotten.

Since the 57th Conference, the board has hosted Regional Forums in Lancaster, Pennsylvania; Omaha, Nebraska; Denver, Colorado; Arlington, Illinois; and Abbotsford, British Columbia. Special Forums were held in St. Thomas, U.S. Virgin Islands; Yellow Knife, Northwest Territories; and Rimouski, Québec.

Ray Massey, Madeleine Parmley, Valerie O'Neill and I attended a Native American A.A. Gathering in Tulalip, Washington, May 18-21, 2007, as invited guests and representatives of the General Service Board. This was an autonomous event that was organized as a direct result of the Special Native American Forum held in May of 2006 in Banning, California. Of the 140 attendees, approximately 130 of them were Native American. During the weekend there was extensive discussion of passing the A.A. message to young people and encouragement was offered to A.A. members on isolated reservations who continue to have A.A. meetings weekly and sit waiting faithfully for an alcoholic to join them.

This year we welcomed five new Class B trustees to the board: Conley Byrd, Southwest regional trustee; John Kane, Northeast regional trustee; Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada; and two general service trustees, Dorothy Hurley and John Skilton.

Last year I asked Tom Kraemer to serve as acting Eastern Canada regional trustee, concurrent with his duties as Western Canada trustee. Tom will rotate off the General Service Board at the close of this Conference and we are grateful for his service. I have appointed Jo-Anne Lowenberger to serve as acting Eastern Canada regional trustee until the 2009 General Service Conference. Jo-Anne has accepted the interim position in addition to her role and responsibilities as trustee-at-large/Canada. In October, the board approved the revisions to Nominating Procedures Nos. 1, 5, 11 and 12 regarding Class B trustee member vacancies and forwarded recommended amendments to the Bylaws of the General Service Board to the 2008 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The board met in executive session, July 29, 2007, and discussed an additional consideration forwarded by the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees that an "Appeal to the

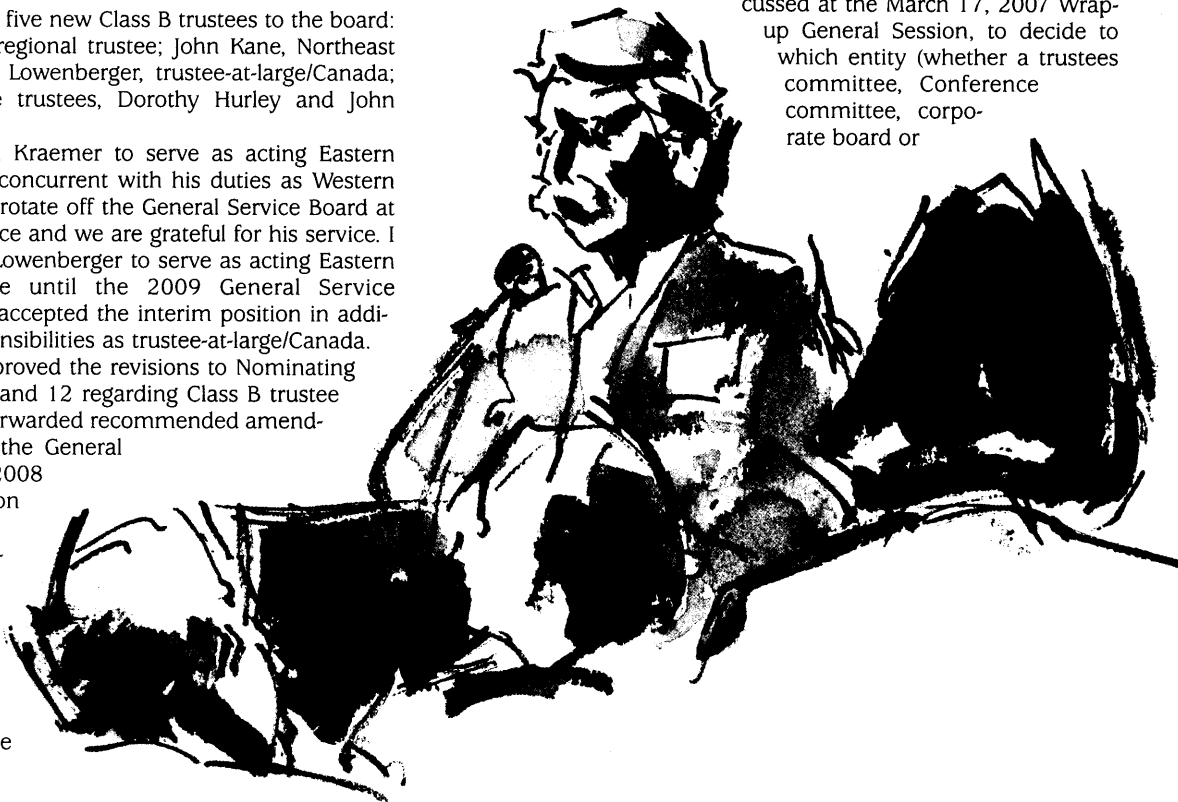
General Service Conference dated April 11, 2007 concerning the decision made in the January 2007 Executive Session of the General Service Board not to begin a search for a new general manager of the General Service Office be given a full hearing at the next scheduled Executive Session of the General Service Board."

The board had a full hearing of the Appeal and matters related to the terms of employment of the general manager of the General Service Office. A subcommittee was appointed (Tom Kraemer, Howard Lowery and Leonard Blumenthal) and met with general manager Greg Muth, Monday, July 30, 2007, and discussed his employment, including his eventual plans for retirement. All agreed that the general manager and the General Service Board would continue to work together on matters vital to the Fellowship.

In February of this year, I was advised by Greg Muth that it was his intent to retire as the general manager of the General Service Office by December 31, 2008. It should be noted that this marks the conclusion of a ten-year period of outstanding service and commitment to Alcoholics Anonymous. The General Service Board, on behalf of all A.A. members in the U.S.A. and Canada, is grateful for the general manager's dedication over this time and for voluntarily assisting in the transition process to his successor.

I appointed Ward Ewing, chair; Paul Cleary, John Kane, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, Madeleine Parmley and John Skilton as members of a search committee for a new general manager. The search committee began its work immediately and announcements regarding the vacancy were included in various publications and correspondence from the General Service Office. The board and the general manager are working closely together to assure a smooth and effective transition.

The General Service Board Ad Hoc Committee on Board Inventory met four times since it was appointed to review the inventory items discussed at the March 17, 2007 Wrap-up General Session, to decide to which entity (whether a trustees committee, Conference committee, corporate board or



other) the inventory items should be assigned. At our February meeting, the board accepted the report made by the G.S.B. Ad Hoc committee and agreed to forward the items to the appropriate entities.

The board, in response to an additional consideration from the 2007 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions that the board prepare a summary of its discussions pertaining to the inventory questions listed in the Final Report of the Ad Hoc Regional Composition and Structure Inventory Committee, initiated a discussion of the inventory questions in February 2008. We will continue the discussion in August and expect to forward a summary of our discussions to the 2009 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

Also in February, we had the pleasure of welcoming the Conference delegate chair and the chairpersons of the Conference Committees at the First Quarterly 2008 meeting of the General Service Board. Delegate chairpersons attended an orientation meeting at G.S.O., met with their committee staff secretaries, and attended sessions of corresponding trustees' committees as guest observers. The practice of inviting Conference committee chairpersons to the First Quarterly Board weekend began in 1991 and continues to benefit the Conference process in helping delegate chairpersons fulfill their trusted service responsibilities to the Conference and A.A. as a whole. We also welcomed two guests from the Central Mexican A.A. Service Structure, Daniel Navarrete Olmos, general manager of the G.S.O. of Mexico; and Elfido Quintas Ordaz, regional trustee of the Southern Territories of Mexico. They were able to observe the various board weekend activities and spend time in the office meeting with management to discuss G.S.O. operations.

We are proud and excited to announce that the Third Edition of the Spanish Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, was published in March of this year. This edition has been in the works for more than three years and includes 32 new recovery stories; three stories translated from the First Edition English Big Book, plus 12 stories carried over from the previous Spanish Edition, which was published in 1990. The purpose of this edition of A.A.'s basic text is to reflect the widest range of A.A. experience from Spanish-speaking members and to attract newcomers to our Fellowship of the Spirit.

Some trustees, G.S.O.'s general manager and various staff members were invited to travel to Brazil, Costa Rica, Cuba, Finland, France, Germany, Great Britain, Japan, Kenya, Malta, Mongolia, Namibia, Oman, Poland, Russia, Sweden and Ukraine to assist others in carrying the A.A. message.

In June of 2007, I was invited to speak at the 50th International Council on Alcoholism and Addictions Conference in Sweden. This Conference brings together professionals from many disciplines—researchers, clinicians, policy makers, educators and academics. There were 340 attendees from 46 countries. I observed that for most present, A.A. is still very much an enigma and I was able to use the opportunity, through presentations and personal contacts, to emphasize how A.A. can be a resource and to confirm our continued willingness to cooperate with the professional community by providing information about Alcoholics Anonymous.

Other highlights of trustee and staff travel: Dorothy Wilson and Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustees-at-large, U.S. and Canada, attended Mongolia's First General Service Conference in September of 2007 and in November, Greg Muth and Julio Espailat attended the First West Central Africa (Zonal) Service Meeting in France, as observers and resources for shared experience. This meeting was supported by the General Service Boards of U.S./Canada and French-speaking Europe. Zonal service meetings are invaluable to emerging countries; held in the Americas, Asia-Oceania, Europe and Sub-Saharan Africa, they provide opportunities to discuss the challenges of creating service structures, literature distribution and practicing A.A. principles in all their affairs.

At the close of this Conference, three trustees will rotate, Chuck Barta, Tom Kraemer and Vince Keefe. We are grateful for their dedication, self-sacrifice and tireless service on behalf of the Fellowship.

In October we will be hosting the 20th World Service Meeting in New York. The theme is "Service: Gratitude in Action." Once again, delegates from around the world will share their experience, strength and hope in carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics everywhere.

This week we will hear much that will enable us to make decisions based on an informed group conscience. The communication among us will allow and encourage us to participate. Putting thought into actions should be our measure of success.

May the God of your understanding be with you during your deliberations this week.

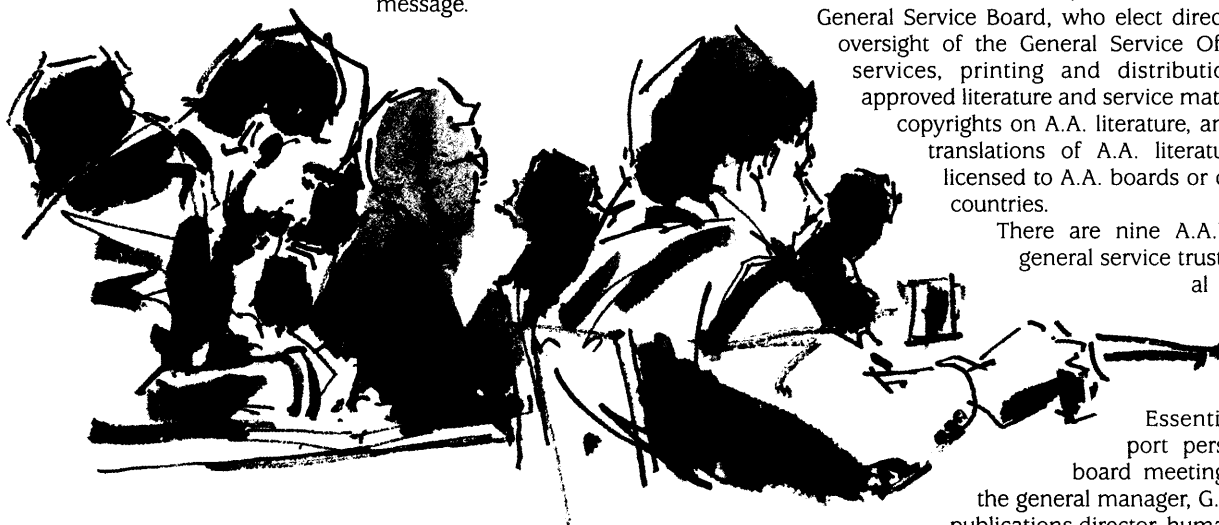
Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D., chairman

ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.

Directors' report: Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. (A.A.W.S.) is a not-for-profit corporation, composed of nine directors. Members of A.A.W.S., Inc. are the 21 trustees of the General Service Board, who elect directors responsible for oversight of the General Service Office (G.S.O.), group services, printing and distribution of Conference-approved literature and service material. A.A.W.S. owns copyrights on A.A. literature, and is responsible for translations of A.A. literature, including titles licensed to A.A. boards or committees in other countries.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors: two general service trustees and two regional trustees; three non-trustee directors; G.S.O.'s general manager and staff coordinator.

Essential nonvoting support personnel attend each board meeting: senior adviser to the general manager, G.S.O. staff, controller, publications director, human resources manag-



er, archivist, board secretary, and one or more representatives of the A.A. Grapevine.

Each year A.A.W.S. directors report to the General Service Conference on A.A. publications, group services provided by the General Service Office, and other activities linked directly to A.A.'s primary purpose. I am privileged to present this report on behalf of my fellow directors. A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. employees agree that our purpose, expressed through requested services and publication of A.A. literature, is to enable members and groups to enlarge their Twelfth Step work, and share A.A.'s solution with each suffering alcoholic. The structure, composition and responsibilities of Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. are described in Chapter 10 of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The A.A.W.S. Board met seven times since the 57th Conference to receive reports from G.S.O. management and staff, review updates on group services activity and track progress on implementation of Conference and board recommendations, review financial reports, price new and revised publications, consider publishing operations and G.S.O. administrative matters, discuss requests from A.A. members and non-A.A.s seeking permission to reprint A.A.-copyrighted literature, and to address other pertinent matters.

Committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Services (considers the needs of all service assignments); Publishing (reviews reprints, foreign literature and publications matters); Finance (oversees budgeting and financial results); and Nominating (suggests candidates for nontrustee director and general service trustee vacancies). Each committee and the board as a whole conduct long-range and strategic planning.

Visitors and Special Guests — In 2007 G.S.O. welcomed 1,477 visitors, including several groups of 15 - 50 members. Some visitors travel great distances to spend a day in the office. We welcome them by acknowledging it takes more than miles to arrive safely at the G.S.O. Two guests from the Central Mexican A.A. Service Structure, Daniel Navarrete Olmos, general manager of the General Service Office of Mexico, and Elfido Quintas Ordaz, regional trustee of the Southern Territories of Mexico, attended the General Service Board weekend February 1-4, 2008 as observers. Our visitors from Mexico also visited G.S.O. after board weekend in order to meet with management about G.S.O. operations.

New Groups — A net total of 941 new A.A. groups listed with G.S.O. last year. Each new group's general service representative (G.S.R.) or contact received A.A. literature and basic information to encourage the group to link with their local structure and support Twelfth Step services. Our current target is for G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s to have new kits in their hands within 21 days of our entering the information into the system. In most instances we have been meeting or exceeding that goal.

Regional and Special Forums — Since the 57th Conference, A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff participated in five Regional Forums. In 2007 there were Forums in the Northeast Region in Lancaster, Pennsylvania, June 1-3; West Central Region in Omaha, Nebraska, September 7-9; Southwest Region in Denver, Colorado, October 12-14; East Central Region in Arlington Heights, Illinois, November 9-11. Also, three Special Forums were held: a Special Remote Forum in St. Thomas, U.S. Virgin Islands, May 5-6; a Special Remote

Forum in Yellowknife, Northwest Territories, July 14-15; and a Special Remote Forum in Rimouski, Québec, Canada, August 11-12. So far in 2008, a Forum for the Western Canada Region was held in Abbotsford, British Columbia, February 22-24.

Annual Intergroup Seminar — Mary Clare Lynch, G.S.O. liaison to Central/Intergroup Offices, attended the 22nd Annual Intergroup/Central Office Seminar, Oklahoma City, Oklahoma, October 4-7. Other participants were nontrustee director Roberta Lindeman, publications director Chris Cavanaugh, and order entry manager Andrea Brennan, as well as four members of the Grapevine staff.

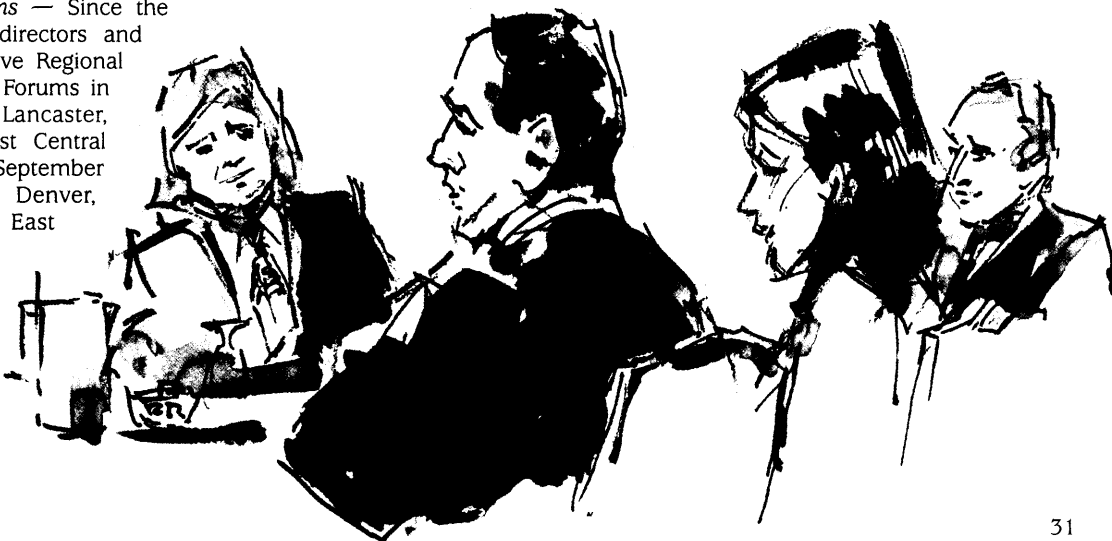
Annual Native American Gatherings — Trustees Leonard Blumenthal, Ray Massey and Madeleine Parmley and staff member Valerie O'Neill attended a Native American Gathering in Tulalip, Washington, May 18-20. Staff member Mary Clare Lynch participated in the 17th Annual National/International Native American Convention in Billings, Montana, October 25-28.

International Conference of Young People in A.A. (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) Convention — The convention was held August 31-September 3 in Los Angeles. Trustees Leonard Blumenthal, Paul Cleary, Rogelio Flores and Madeleine Parmley represented the General Service Board and general manager Greg Muth also participated.

Other Activities — Rick Walker attended the World Convention of Narcotics Anonymous in San Antonio, Texas, August 30-September 2. This trip was helpful in preplanning for the 2010 International Convention, which will be held in San Antonio. Irene Kontje attended the Advisory Council meeting of the National Institute on Alcohol Abuse & Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) in Bethesda, Maryland, May 24. Also G.S.O. staff members were invited to attend and participate in many area service events, conferences and conventions. These trips are helpful in gathering local experience and adding to the experience available from G.S.O.

G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site — The board approved the Quarterly and Annual Web site Activity Reports, and forwarded them to the trustees' Committee on Public Information. We also approved the A.A.W.S. Services Committee's recommendation that G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web Site Committee (IOWC) be authorized to add any Conference-approved pamphlet designated as a "service" pamphlet or as a "unity" pamphlet to G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site without the need for further approval by the Services Committee or the board.

Activities of the A.A.W.S. Board — Added a link to the Online Intergroup of Alcoholics Anonymous; approved the addition of a link for information and uploading suggestions for the Video for Young People project on www.aa.org; reaffirmed approval of A.A.W.S., Inc.'s Policy on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site; held a sharing session on the effectiveness of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.



We took no action on a request to create an "Area Information Exchange Bulletin Board" on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, as this would entail an expansion of the scope of the Web site and would require the assignment of significant resources that are not currently available.

International — Trustees and G.S.O. staff accepted invitations from A.A. in other countries to share experience with A.A. groups and trusted servants in local service structures: May 25–27, Doug Richardson and Greg Muth attended the 3rd Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting, in Windhoek, Namibia. Twenty-two delegates representing 11 countries participated in the zonal meeting. Doug and Greg also visited Nairobi, Kenya, where they met with volunteers in the intergroup office, professionals in the Ministry of Health, and A.A. groups in prison.

July 5–8, Julio Espallat and Greg Muth participated in the 7th Asia Oceania Service Meeting (AOSM) in Ranzan, Japan. Eighteen delegates representing 11 countries attended the zonal meeting. Prior to the AOSM, Julio and Greg visited with staff of the Japan Service Office (JSO) in Tokyo to share experience regarding translations/copyrights, Public Information, and cooperation with drug courts and the professional community.

August 23–27, trustee-at-large/U.S. Dorothy Wilson and Julio Espallat visited Moscow to attend the 20th Anniversary celebration of A.A. in Russia, a gathering that drew over 2,000 celebrants. En route to Russia, Dorothy and Julio stopped in Helsinki, Finland, to meet with members of both service structures in that country.

September 6–11, trustees-at-large Dorothy Wilson and Jo-Anne Lowenberger traveled to Gorkhi-Terelj, Mongolia, for the First General Service Conference of the Mongolian A.A. service structure. October 17–21, Dorothy and Jo-Anne also participated in the Fifteenth Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in São Paulo, Brazil. Delegates from the A.A. service structures in North, Central and South America shared experience, strength and hope on carrying the A.A. message in their countries.

Julio Espallat, G.S.O. staff member, fall trips: October 19–21, Julio participated in the 14th European Service Meeting (ESM) in Frankfurt, Germany; November 1–4, he attended the 2nd International Convention in Malta; and November 8–11, Julio participated in the 7th Annual Gulf Convention in Muscat, Oman.

November 29–December 3, Julio and Greg Muth attended the 1st Central Africa Service Meeting in Paris, an historic event that brought together delegates from ten French-speaking African countries. The French General Service Board in partnership with the U.S./Canada Board hosted the meeting.

November 30–December 3, trustee-at-large/U.S. Dorothy Wilson traveled to Warsaw to participate in a Concepts Workshop with members of the Polish General Service Board and Service Structure. Greg Muth joined Dorothy in Warsaw after partic-

ipating in the Central Africa Service Meeting in Paris. Dorothy and Greg shared A.A. experience in the development and application of the Twelve Concepts and answered many questions arising for the fast-growing A.A. Fellowship in Poland.

January 18–20, 2008, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, participated in the 2nd National Convention of A.A. in Cuba in LaHavana, a weekend event that drew over 1,000 A.A.s from throughout Cuba, plus guests from several other countries.

February 20–27, Julio Espallat visited Kiev, Ukraine, to participate in the 19th Convention of A.A. in Ukraine and to meet with staff of the General Service Center for discussions on licensing and translation of A.A. literature into Ukrainian. Julio also visited the city of Lviv, where the 20th Anniversary celebration of A.A. in Ukraine will be held in 2009. Julio also participated in the 33rd A.A. Convention of Central America, held in San Jose, Costa Rica, March 20–23.

March 28–30, Greg Muth responded to an invitation to address the 28th General Service Conference for German-speaking Europe held in Rosrath, Germany. Greg spoke on "Unity: A Cherished Gift Essential to A.A.'s Common Welfare."

Financial — (See details in Report of the Trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.) An unaudited summary of 2007 year-end financial results reflected: Net sales of \$12,394,000 for the year, approximately \$744,000 (6%) more than budgeted. Gross profit from literature was \$7,046,700, approximately \$487,900 (7.4%) over budget and \$171,400 greater than at December 31, 2006; contributions received of \$6,526,000 were \$326,000 (5.3%) more than budgeted and \$457,800 (7.5%) greater than the total for 2006.

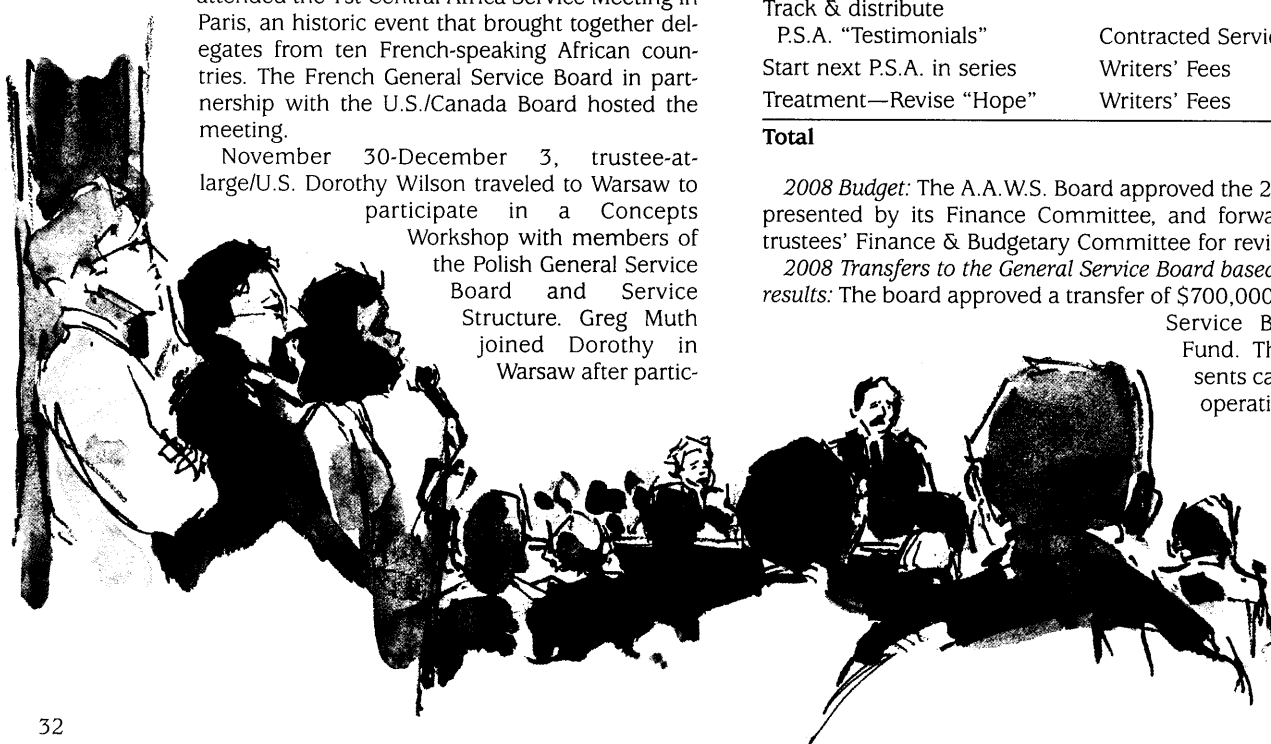
Total revenue (gross profit from literature sales, contributions, and interest earned on cash flow) was \$13,582,000. Total revenue was approximately \$820,000 more than budgeted and \$630,000 greater than in 2006. Net profit for the year 2007 of \$1,018,600 compared with \$89,450 budgeted and \$360,000 more than the \$657,900 profit reported for the year 2006.

Mid-Year Budget Considerations (2007) — A.A.W.S. approved and forwarded to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee these projects that resulted from Conference Advisory Actions.

Item	Line Item	Amount
P.I.—Video/digital submissions	Writers' Fees	\$ 28,000
Track & distribute		
P.S.A. "Testimonials"	Contracted Services	30,000
Start next P.S.A. in series	Writers' Fees	40,000
Treatment—Revise "Hope"	Writers' Fees	50,000
Total		\$148,000

2008 Budget: The A.A.W.S. Board approved the 2008 budget, as presented by its Finance Committee, and forwarded it to the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee for review.

2008 Transfers to the General Service Board based on 12/31/2007 results: The board approved a transfer of \$700,000 to the General Service Board Reserve Fund. This sum represents cash in excess of operations needs.



Transfer of Fund Balance: The board also, approved a transfer of A.A.W.S. Fund Balance to the General Service Board (G.S.B.) General Fund in the amount of \$1,929,426. This action will restore the General Fund balance to \$57,012 and cover the General Service Board's loss of \$1,997,231; La Viña loss of \$67,040; Capital Projects Fund expenditure of \$81,655.53; and funds received from the Reserve Fund of \$216,500, related to 2006-2007 intraoffice construction.

Publications — The Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, was published February 2008. Based on the precedent of complimentary distribution of the 4th Edition of the English Big Book, each Spanish-language central or inter-group office was sent a notice by Eva Sanchez, G.S.O. literature coordinator, sharing that the office would soon receive a complimentary case of 20 books. The February/March 2008 issue of *Box 4-5-9* featured an article on the history of the Spanish Big Book and the process of development of the Third Edition, which was similar to the processes followed with the Fourth Edition Big Book in English and French.

Books, Unit Distribution: Total distribution of all books for the year 2007 was 2,105,628, up 8% from the 2006 total of 1,951,938. In 2007, total A.A. purchases amounted to 1,697,035 units, while non-A.A.s accounted for 408,593 units, which was 19% of the total.

Big Book Sales (all formats): For the year 2007, we distributed 1,127,310 Big Book units, compared to 1,067,191 in 2006.

Schedule on Digital Formats: Publications director Chris Cavanaugh presented a schedule on the conversion of existing audio/or video A.A. publications to CD/or DVD format. He anticipates the remaining conversion will be completed by April 2008. At the time this report was written, the following conversions had been completed: Books on CD Format: *Alcoholics Anonymous; Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions; Living Sober*. Films on DVD Format: "Markings on the Journey"; "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions"; "Bill's Own Story"; "Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous."

All audio and video products, with the exception of the American Sign Language Big Book and Twelve and Twelve, have been successfully converted to digital format and are available in the appropriate CD or DVD format.

Request to Reproduce Final Conference Reports: The A.A.W.S. Publishing Committee reviewed a request to require areas to secure written permission to reproduce and/or alter the *Final Reports* of the General Service Conference for anonymity purposes before posting on Web sites. The committee noted that the *Conference Final Report* is a confidential report, per the 1975 Advisory Action. The committee agreed that at its June 2008 meeting it would discuss the possibility of publishing a condensed, anonymity-protected version of the General Service Conference Final Report in the future. This *Final Report* version could be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The committee further noted that *Final Conference Reports* are both copyrighted and Conference-approved items and would therefore require the necessary permissions before they are either reproduced or altered.

Translations and Licensing Projects: The Publications Department recommends the following basic publications as a starting point for literature distribution in new countries: "A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous," "A Newcomer Asks," "Is A.A. for Me?," "This is A.A.," "44 Questions," "Information on Alcoholics Anonymous" (service piece) and "A.A.'s Legacy of Service."

Translation Projects Completed: *Alcoholics Anonymous* in Hebrew, Amharic (for Ethiopia), and Greek. Revised Conference Charter (U.S./Canada) in Mongolian and Polish.

Pamphlets translated in Tahitian (French Polynesia): "44 Questions," "This is A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," "Information on A.A.," "A Brief Guide to A.A.," and "Is A.A. for You?"; in Kazakh:

"44 Questions," "This is A.A.," "A Newcomer Asks," "Information on A.A.," "A Brief Guide to A.A.," and "Is A.A. for You?"; in Inuit: "What Happened to Joe"; in Khmer: "What Happened to Joe"; in Croatian "This is A.A."

G.S.O. Archives: Amy Filiatreau, G.S.O. archivist, reported that the Archives Department accomplished a great deal in 2007. The archives staff has made great progress on preserving our material and in processing planned archival work. The A.A.W.S. Board's decision to authorize the purchase and implementation of Laserfiche software has proven invaluable in efforts to preserve and utilize the many thousands of documents stored in G.S.O.'s Archives. Test software, which will initially have viewing rights only, was installed for use by five G.S.O. staff members, who will participate in a 90-day trial in order for us to evaluate whether direct access will prove beneficial and ease processing time for the growing number of requests for archival research from internal and external sources. If this trial is successful, it may delay the immediate necessity to hire more archives' staff.

Archives staff has completed or is currently working on the following projects: Scanning all General Service Board minutes from 1938 to the present, indexing information for the earliest minutes and performing quality control on the scans.

Creating a full inventory of the many recordings and written transcripts of oral histories recorded by Bill in 1954 as he was preparing to write *Alcoholics Anonymous Comes of Age*. These are very rich and frank discussions of the early history of A.A. and shed light on our history in a way few items do.

The staff also finished sending material for off-site storage; processing and scanning A.A.W.S. Board minutes; cataloging the audio collection; adding digital documents to Laserfiche.

The staff completed processing and inventorying many collections, including the Nell Wing collection, the Bob V. collection (early A.A. member and friend of Bill W. in New Jersey) and the Marty M. collection, as well as several smaller collections. We are continuing to process our international files (we've completed records through Costa Rica); process the George S. files (George was an early A.A. who worked with Marty M.) and the Milton Maxwell collection.

G.S.O. and Staff Operations — At year-end 2007, G.S.O. had 81 full-time employees, and one part-time student.

Fellowship New Vision (FNV) System: The FNV is fully integrated and is proving to be a great asset and benefit to area registrars who are able to share A.A. group information and updates with G.S.O.'s Records Department.

February 29, 2008, G.S.O. hosted a Day of Sharing with a format similar to the annual sharing meeting among Al-Anon (AFG), National Council on Alcoholism and Drug Dependence (NCADD) and A.A. that has been so helpful. The February gathering included representatives of Debtors Anonymous (D.A.), Narcotics Anonymous (N.A.) and Overeaters Anonymous (O.A.). The purpose of this Day of Sharing, as with previous Days of Sharing, was to share experience, strength and hope in a spirit of cooperation so that participants may discover ways in which shared experience can be beneficial, keeping in mind our tradition of cooperation without affiliation.

At the beginning of 2008, we paused to remember past G.S.O. general manager Bob Pearson, who passed away on January 1, 2008, just a few days short of his 91st birthday. Greg Muth joined Bob's family and friends for services on January 11 and 12 to honor Bob's life and work. Bob was G.S.O. general manager 1974-1984, after which he continued as president of A.A.W.S., Inc. and as senior advisor until 1987.

Howard Lowery, chairperson

Literature Distributed — 2007

ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	526,606
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	408,980
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	45,776
Alcoholics Anonymous (pocket abridged)	142,675
Daily Reflections	158,534
Daily Reflections (large print)	11,644
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. ed.)	175,676
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift ed.)	10,240
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	179,899
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	22,234
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (pocket ed.)	57,582
A.A. Comes of Age	11,143
As Bill Sees It	36,116
As Bill Sees It (soft cover)	33,265
As Bill Sees It (large print)	6,355
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	10,003
"Pass It On"	9,529
Experience, Strength & Hope	9,568
Total	1,855,825

Booklets

The A.A. Service Manual/ Twelve Concepts for World Service	27,896
Living Sober	150,967
Came to Believe	60,555
Came to Believe (large print)	3,835
A.A. in Prisons: Inmate to Inmate	23,907
Total	267,160

Pamphlets

A.A. and the Armed Services	10,743
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	27,021
A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional	32,522
A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic	27,238
A.A. for the Native North American	12,497
A.A. for the Woman	115,508
The A.A. Group	98,832
A.A. in Your Community	49,447
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	23,696
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	24,391
The A.A. Membership Survey	28,080
The A.A. Member – Medications and Other Drugs	112,768
A.A. Tradition – How It Developed	29,976
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	13,708
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	133,467
Circles of Love and Service	45,084
Bridging the Gap	27,337
Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.	19,654
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	15,760
Do You Think You're Different?	122,336
44 Questions	251,835
44 Questions (large print)	3,254
G.S.R.	40,691
Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print	18,571
How A.A. Members Cooperate	18,410
How It Works	72,439
If You Are a Professional	36,050
Inside A.A.	51,660
Is A.A. for You?	386,634

Is A.A. for Me?	101,241
Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?	17,019
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	88,823
It Happened to Alice	48,065
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	50,820
The Jack Alexander Article	27,974
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	12,447
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	55,608
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	38,360
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	11,516
A Newcomer Asks	348,305
Problems Other Than Alcohol	127,659
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	299,366
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	19,369
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	32,034
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	73,904
Twelve Traditions Flyer	6,410
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	52,270
This Is A.A.	301,169
This Is A.A. (large print)	3,257
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	21,429
A.A. for the Older Alcoholic (large print)	59,967
Too Young?	84,151
Understanding Anonymity	59,836
What Happened to Joe	50,377
Young People and A.A.	117,442
Total	3,958,427

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards-two-fold	288,571
Wallet cards-I Am Responsible	50,373
Wallet cards-Anonymity	41,413
Anonymity Display Card	2,337
Parchment-scrolls	2,765
Placards	399
C.P.C. Workbook	1,189
Archives Workbook	768
Correctional Facilities Workbook	1033
P.I. Workbook	2,092
Treatment Facilities Workbook	1,731
Treatment Facility Kit	440
Big Book on computer disk	81
Twelve and Twelve on Computer Disk	55
A.A. Guidelines	70,130
Group Handbook	2,455
Wire Racks	2,140
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	745
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	1,257
Alcoholics Anonymous (4th Ed. cassette album)	76
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	79
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	575
TV Public Service Announcement	241
Radio Public Service Announcements	157
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,180
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,068
Fact File	1,787
Table Top Display 12 & 12	473
Pioneers of AA (Cassette Album)	64
Living Sober (Cassette Album)	118
Big Book Audio CD	1,984
12 & 12 Audio CD	1,470
Total	481,246
Grand Total	6,562,658

SPANISH

Libros y Librillos (Books & Booklets)

Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous soft cover)	22,905
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous hardcover)	8,785
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous abridged pocket size)	7,010
Alcohólicos Anónimos (Alcoholics Anonymous large print)	4,191
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	6,333
A.A. Llega a su Mayoría de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,875
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	2,982
Transmitelo (Pass It On)	3,056
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections)	9,819
Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	15,028
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	4,198
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	22,574
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	6,474
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	6,250
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (pocket ed.)	5,987
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (large print)	4,180
De las tinieblas hacia la luz	5,130
Total	137,777

Folletos (Pamphlets)

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	6,656
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	27,148
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	23,344
¿Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	56,529
¿Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	8,124
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	3,914
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	2,991
Alcohólicos Anónimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	2,314
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,390
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	11,993
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	6,511
Lo que le Sucedió a José (What Happened to Joe)	8,096
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	3,912
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	10,009
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	10,843
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otras Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	4,394
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	5,066
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	1,400
Los Jóvenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	13,666
La Tradición de A.A. - ¿Cómo se Desarrolló? (A.A. Tradition - How It Developed)	2,627
Una Breve Guía a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	11,450
A.A. en las Instituciones Correccionales	

(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	2,506
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	6,890
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	7,297
¿Cómo Cooperan los Miembros de A.A.? (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	2,138
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,273
A.A. como Recurso para los Profesionales de la Salud (A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	1,688
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	1,494
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	3,234
¿Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think You're Different?)	7,478
Le Sucedió a Alicia (It Happened to Alice)	5,070
Hablando en Reuniones no-A.A. (Speaking at non-A.A. Meetings)	2,018
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	8,401
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,517
¿Hay un alcohólico en el lugar de trabajo? (Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?)	2,196
¿Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	12,532
A.A. para el alcohólico de edad avanzada (A.A. for the Older Alcoholic)	3,925
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated)	7,197
Círculos de Amor y Servicio (Circles of Love and Service)	2,266
Uniendo las Orillas (Bridging the Gap)	1,372
Los Doce Conceptos Ilustrados (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	2,772
A.A. para los alcohólicos gays/lesbianas (A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	1,779
El Legado de Servicio de A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	964
Si Usted es un Profesional (If You Are a Professional)	1,876
El Grapevine y La Viña de A.A. (Grapevine — Our Meeting in Print)	1,187
Total	315,447

Diversos (Miscellaneous)

Guías (Guidelines)	8,763
Parchments, Spanish	370
Tarjetas Tamaño Billetera (wallet cards)	12,576
Alcohólicos Anónimos (cassette album) (Big Book on cassette)	325
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on cassette)	208
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (audio CD)	1,768
Total	24,010
Grand Total	477,234

FRENCH

Livres (Books)

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format relie)	5,279
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format souple)	1,478
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous — format poche)	750
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions	

(Twelve and Twelve – format relie)	1,767	(A Brief Guide to A.A.)	2,383
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions		Les membres du clerge se renseignent	
(Twelve and Twelve – format souple)	952	(Members of the Clergy Ask About A.A.)	666
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions		Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-founders of A.A.)	643
(Twelve and Twelve – format poche)	628	Message a l'intention d'un detenu	
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte		(Memo to an Inmate)	593
(A.A. Comes of Age)	553	Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels	
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	2,465	(Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	481
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	4,774	Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	2,890
Dr Bob et les pionniers		Les Douze Concepts illustres	
(Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers)	559	(Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	1,832
(Expérience, Force, & Espoir)		Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,575
(Experience, Strength and Hope)	623	Trois causeries a des societes medicales	
Transmets-Le (Pass It On)	1,530	(Three Talks to Medical Societies)	1,621
Total	21,358	Y a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie?	
		(Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,124
Plaquettes (Booklets)		Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	1,768
Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	1,957	Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A.	
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	3,241	(Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	671
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts		Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,235
(The A.A. Service Manual/		La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	1,691
Twelve Concepts for World Service)	1,453	L'Heritage des Services des A.A.	
Total	6,651	(A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	788
		Cercles d'amour et de service	
Brochures (Pamphlets)		(Circles of Love and Service)	1,682
Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	8,506	Vous croyez-vous different?	
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	3,253	(Do You Think You're Different?)	925
Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	13,841	Sondage sur les membres des A.A.	
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,677	(The A.A. Membership Survey)	1,209
Collaboration des membres des A.A.		Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	1,807
(How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,131	Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	1,601
Y a-t-il un Alcoolique dans Votre Milieu de travail?		AA pour l'alcoolique plus âgé	
(Is There an Alcoholic in the Workplace?)	1,585	(AA for the Older Alcoholic)	1,494
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue		Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	3,520
(The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	2,227	Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,566
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post		Favoriser de rapprochement (Bridging the Gap)	559
(The Jack Alexander Article)	874	Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	1,440
Collaborons avec nos amis		Les A.A. et les gais et lesbiennes alcooliques	
(Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	442	(A.A. for the Gay and Lesbian Alcoholic)	616
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage		Les A.A. et les Autochtones d'Amerique du Nord	
(Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	3,361	(A.A. and the Native North American)	319
Les A.A.: Une Ressource pour les medecins		Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	2,418
(A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional)	2,130	Total	92,371
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement			
(A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	535	Divers (Miscellaneous)	
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement		12 and 12 (cassette album)	16
(A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	795	Le Gros Livre (cassettes album)	36
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme?		12 and 12 (audio CD)	564
(If You Are a Professional)	2,175	Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions	
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	766	(Wallet card 12 Steps and 12 Traditions)	2,346
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool		Carte anonymat (French, English)	
(What Happened to Joe)	1,366	(Anonymity wallet card)	924
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	2,202	Video Cassettes	75
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme		Notre Methode (How It Works)	14,598
(Problems Other Than Alcohol)	2,119	Manuel de Groupe	65
Point de vue d'un membre sur les A.A.		Pochette de l'Information Publique	54
(A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	1,114	Pochette des Centres de Detention	22
Les Douze Traditions illustrees		Pochette de la CMP	9
(The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,588	Prière de la Sérénité (12x16)	
Les A.A. dans les etablissements correctionnels		(Parchment Serenity Prayer)	83
(A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	493	Pochette des Centres de Traitement	11
Ca vaut mieux que de languir en prison		Dossier d'Information sur les A.A. (Fact File)	354
(It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	1,074	Total	19,157
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A.		Grand Total	139,537

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Directors' report: One of the operating arms of the General Service Board, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., publishes the international journal of Alcoholics Anonymous in print and in audio, along with collections of Grapevine magazine articles in books, CDs, and on its Web site. With the financial support of the General Service Board, A.A. Grapevine, Inc., also publishes La Viña, the Spanish-language journal of Alcoholics Anonymous, and collections of La Viña stories in CDs and other formats.

The directors of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., have met eight times since the 57th General Service Conference—three times as a Corporate Board during General Service Board weekends; four times as a Planning Committee in June, September, December, and March; and once in October at a joint dinner meeting with the Editorial Advisory Board, a group of A.A. members from the publishing industry who share their professional experience with the Grapevine. They will hold their fourth quarterly board meeting during the Conference. The directors review the corporation's finances and operations and take formal actions during quarterly board meetings; they discuss matters of broad policy and develop plans for the corporation's future at Planning Committee meetings.

Board Structure — There are nine directors on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board: two general service trustees, two regional trustees, and one Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee; three nontrustee directors; and the executive editor. Two trustees will rotate off the board after this Conference: East Central regional trustee, Bob Mayer, and Class A trustee Herb Goodman. Southwest regional trustee Conley Byrd has been nominated to replace Bob Mayer, and the Class A position will remain open for a year, subject to the Conference's disapproval, if any. The board also announced that it is seeking candidates for the position of nontrustee director to fill the vacancy that will be left when nontrustee director Jim Branscome rotates in May 2009.

The chair of the A.A. Grapevine Board appointed six committees this year. The nominating committee, chaired by Madeleine Parmley, facilitated the recommendations concerning the openings on the board described above. The finance and budget committee, chaired by board treasurer, Dorothy Hurley, reviewed the corporation's financial standing each quarter, developed its 2008 budgets, discussed integrating La Viña and Grapevine financial statements, and concluded that it was in the best interest of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to continue to operate in concert with the 2001 Advisory Action at this time. The La Viña committee, chaired by nontrustee director Ginger Rhoades Bell, discussed self-support and affirmed the long-term goal of reintegrating La Viña into the corporation because La Viña is an A.A. Grapevine publication. The committee also confirmed the need for a La Viña Editorial Advisory Board. The risk management committee, chaired by Class A trustee Herb Goodman, monitored the development of the Grapevine's disaster plan; compensation policy program; and long-term replacement and leadership plan. It also reviewed the status of the Grapevine personnel handbook; the status of Grapevine's copyrights; and La Viña operations and personnel. Chaired by nontrustee director Jim Branscome, the Board Development Committee updated the directors' manual, including answers to frequently asked questions for new directors; revised the A.A. Grapevine's mission statement; oversaw the writing of the strategic plan; and encouraged the board to hold an off-site visioning statement session. The Publishing Operations committee, chaired by regional trustee Bob Mayer, monitored the timely publication of books and CDs in 2007; previewed the redesign of www.aagrapevine.org's home page; and approved the Grapevine's publication plan for 2008. This includes publication of two audiobooks (*Spiritual Awakenings, Vols. I & II*, in both English and Spanish, and *Emotional Sobriety, Vols. I & II*); a trilingual Grapevine wall calendar and pocket planner; and a book of Grapevine stories for beginners, considered at the 2003 GSC. This October, the Grapevine also celebrates the 20th anniversary of *The Language of the Heart*.



Grapevine Financial Report — Circulation of the print magazine averaged 106,099 a month in FY2007, which was 3,099 higher than budget and 2,221 higher than last year. Subscriptions to the AudioGrapevine brought average monthly circulation of the magazine up to 107,242. For the twelve-month period ended December 31, 2007, the A.A. Grapevine Corporation realized a loss of \$25,047 in comparison to a budgeted loss of \$81,332. This was ahead of budget by \$56,286.

Total A.A. Grapevine income, including cash flow interest and interest from the Reserve Fund, was \$1,740,174 or \$33,986 ahead of budget. Total magazine income was \$1,950,233 and direct costs of the Grapevine magazine were \$767,463, resulting in a gross profit on the magazine of \$1,182,770. This was \$31,405 more than last year. Other Grapevine publishing income of \$770,242 was \$45,564 ahead of budget and \$153,259 ahead of last year. Cost of goods and delivery was \$285,617. Gross profit on related items was \$484,625. This is \$46,143 over budget and \$116,985 ahead of last year. Editorial costs of \$543,904 were over budget by \$9,455. Circulation and business expenses of \$1,041,095 were less than budget by \$38,266. General and administrative expenses of \$180,222 were \$6,511 over budget. Total gross profit was \$1,667,395. This was \$148,390 ahead of 2006.

Financial Management — Last year, the A.A. Grapevine saw significant increases in the circulation of both the Grapevine and La Viña magazines and in the distribution of its stories in books and CDs. Average monthly circulation of the Grapevine print magazine alone rose 2.14%; with the addition of the audio version, average monthly circulation rose 3.24%. La Viña circulation increased 7.4%. In 2006, the Grapevine distributed 68,108 books; this year, it distributed 86,350. The corporation distributed 9,511 Grapevine CDs in 2007, versus 6,771 in 2006. In 2007, 4,945 La Viña CDs were distributed, versus 2,371 in 2006.

The board is aware, however, that one year's growth cannot resolve the challenges posed by changes in communications technology or those inherent in the Grapevine's business model.

Unlike other association presses, the Grapevine does not receive revenue from ads or contributions from groups or individual members. It supports its operation solely through the sale of subscriptions, books, and other items. Nor does it promote or sell its publications in stores, other magazines, or non-A.A. outlets, or raise its prices to keep up with inflation. (In 1946, the cost of a Grapevine subscription was \$2.50. If the Grapevine had kept pace with that rate, the current subscription

would cost \$26.66.) Therefore, much of the board's work this year was devoted to strategic planning—looking at ways the Grapevine might meet these challenges and cover costs over the next few years. The March 2007 planning committee meeting was dedicated to a "S.W.O.T. analysis" of the Grapevine, which challenged board and staff to identify the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities, and threats that the corporation faces. The June 2007 Planning Committee meeting focused on goals for the Grapevine and suggested strategies for reaching them.

Strategic Planning Highlights — Strengths cited included the Grapevine's deep well of stories (60,000+ stories in the Digital Archive, Bill's writings, and about 100 new Grapevine and La Viña manuscripts a month) and high-quality products. Weaknesses included a small, over-extended staff with limited resources, a single revenue stream, and the financial constraints of its business model. Opportunities noted were a large, potential readership (young A.A.s, newcomers, inmates, and 18+ million active alcoholics in North America); a talented pool of A.A.s for the Corporate and Editorial Advisory Boards and staff; technology that might lead to reduced production costs; and the chance to build the Fellowship's sense of ownership. Among the threats cited were the Grapevine's thin financial cushion; an aging readership; readers' information overload; changes in publishing driven by new technologies; and potential challenges to A.A. growth, such as resistance to change or a decline in Twelfth Step work. Out of this work, board and staff developed a strategic plan and set the following goals for the years ahead:

- Reflect the current membership of A.A. and the power of the program.
- Expand and broaden the audience across all platforms.
- Foster the Fellowship's sense of ownership of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.
- Maintain prudent financial management.
- Optimize the organization's resources and operations.
- Maintain the financial and editorial independence of A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The board also adopted an implementation plan, outlining actions the Grapevine can take toward obtaining them. Here is a sample, some of which are already in motion:

- Highlight the Grapevine and La Viña's need for stories.
- Make more stories available on the Web.
- Update the design of the Grapevine and other publications.
- Maintain an effective circulation program.
- Encourage the use of the magazines at all levels of service.
- Adhere to a pricing policy that keeps pace with increasing costs.
- Review office policies and procedures.
- Recruit the best possible people for staff and boards.





The Grapevine Board is taking into account the results of the General Service Board's inventory of the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., as well. That inventory began with a report at the March 2005 meeting of the General Service Board on the history of the Grapevine corporation and its finances, staff, publications, and relationship with A.A.W.S. On the basis of that report and discussion about it, the General Service Board developed an "A.A. Grapevine Priority List" consisting of sixteen items for the corporate board and staff to consider. These included exploring opportunities for sharing a catalog and other resources with A.A.W.S.; including the Grapevine in more General Service Board discussions; encouraging more communication between the Grapevine and A.A.W.S. Boards; and discussing ways to attract young readers and to motivate and support Grapevine and La Viña representatives. The Grapevine Board began considering these items at its March 2008 Planning Committee meeting and plans to continue its review of the inventory in the year ahead. Any actions resulting from this review will be reported at the General Service Board's quarterly meetings.

Office Operations — As the chief executive of the corporation, the executive editor defines the operational and editorial goals of the corporation and oversees their administration. The controller supervises accounting, customer service, and fulfillment and plays a role in the financial management of the Grapevine. The circulation manager develops, implements, and tracks efforts to raise awareness of the magazines and other items. The office manager oversees communication with the GvRs and RLVs and office procedure. The editors, internet director, and production manager are responsible for producing the magazines, books, CDs and special projects such as the e-newsletter and Digital Archive.

La Viña Financial Report — Bimonthly circulation for La Viña averaged 10,979 for 6 issues in FY 2007. This was 7.4% more than last year. Magazine income was \$102,152, which was over budget by \$6,880. Direct costs were \$66,917, which were \$3,098 under budget. Gross profit on the magazine was \$35,234. This was \$9,977 ahead of budget and \$14,774 ahead of the same period in 2006. Income from the sale of La Viña CDs and the first La Viña book totaled \$44,520, which was \$6,580 ahead of budget. Gross profit on related items was \$32,547. Costs and expenses were \$134,821. This is \$8,642 over budget. Net loss for La Viña for FY 2007 was \$67,040. The net loss for 2006 was \$72,004.

We have seen extraordinary growth in La Viña — 11% in 2006 and 7.4% in 2007, and the momentum is still building. This growth attests to the importance of the magazine to so many alcoholics, and the hard work being done to pass it on. Like the Grapevine, La Viña is a lifeline to alcoholics—especially in areas where there are few or no meetings. With sharing from A.A.s around the globe, it helps readers understand they are part of a world-wide community of alcoholics, a community with a rich history and many opportunities to help alcoholics.

The A.A. Grapevine has served the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous for 64 years. It is up to us, working together, to make sure our magazines are there to convey the hope and help that our program offers today and in the days to come. A.A. has transformed our lives in ways we once didn't know were possible; we are fortunate to be able to share how that happened in the pages of the Grapevine and La Viña.

Ray Massey, chairperson

ENGLISH

Book Units

Best of Bill (hardcover)	3,642
Best of Bill (softcover)	8,925
Best of Bill/large print (softcover)	2,000
Best of the Grapevine I (softcover)	1,348
Best of the Grapevine II (softcover)	877
The Language of the Heart (hardcover)	5,514
The Home Group	36
Best of the Grapevine III (softcover)	1,058
A.A. Around The World	1,456
The Language of the Heart (softcover)	3,049
The Language of the Heart (large print)	829
Thank You for Sharing	1,561
Spiritual Awakening	6,875
The Home Group (revised/softcover)	3,113
I am Responsible: The Hand of AA (softcover)	2,277
Emotional Sobriety (softcover)	18,974
In Our Own Words	7,349
Total:	68,883

Cassette Tapes

Classic Tapes #1	34
Classic Tapes #2	30
Classic Tapes #3	34
Youth Enjoying Sobriety	43
Old-Timers Corner	88
Back to Basics, Vol.1	36
Back to Basics, Vol.2	26
Sponsorship, Vol.1	47
Sponsorship, Vol.2	53
History Lights the Way	49
What We Were Like	51
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol.1	23
Not for Newcomers Only, Vol. 2	17
Attitudes	77
Character Defects	79
Pathways to Spirituality	66
Maintaining Spirituality	48
Our Experience Has Taught Us	29
Practice These Principles	58
Total:	888

CDs

Pathways to Spirituality	1,006
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 1	440
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 2	350
Classic Grapevine, Vol. 3	341
Not for Newcomers Only	669
Partners on the Journey	558
Story of A.A.	813
What It Was Like	638
The Twelve Traditions	938
It Works If We Work It	1,199
Best of Bill	1,377
A Lifetime of A.A.	805
Attitude Adjustment	360
Power of Example	17
Total:	9,511

Miscellaneous

Facsimile of First Grapevine	388
AA Preamble	1,419
Grapevine Binder	423
Man on the Bed	1,616
Slogans	1,368
Serenity Prayer	2,286
Victor E. Poster	169
Wall Calendar	8,388
Pocket Planner	12,766
Grapevine Workbook	143
Co-Founder's Memorial Issue	1,679
Traditions Checklist	558
Total:	31,203

SPANISH

El Lenguaje del Corazón (Language of the Heart)	3,233
Lo Mejor de Bill (The Best of Bill)	3,431
Lo Mejor de La Viña (The Best of La Viña)	2,572
El Grupo Base (The Home Group)	5,100
Sonidos de Sobriedad (Sounds of Sobriety)	18
Historia de La Viña/CD	584
Historia de La Viña Vol. II/CD	921
Historia de La Viña Vol. III/CD	991
Victor E. Poster - Spanish	55
Preámbulo (Preamble)	392
Lemas (Slogans)	256
La Oración de la Serenidad (Serenity Prayer)	829
Tradiciones (Traditions Checklist)	1,152
Lo Mejor de Bill CD	1,300
La Historia de A.A.	1,149
Total:	21,983

FRENCH

Best of Bill - French (Softcover)	2,051
Le langage du cœur (The Language of the Heart)	607
The Home Group - French	473
Les Sons de la Sobriété (Sounds of Sobriety)	65
Slogans - French	157
Victor E. Poster - (French)	7
Total:	3,360
Grand Total:	135,828

GRAPEVINE SUBSCRIPTIONS* — GEOGRAPHICAL BREAKDOWN

	APRIL 2008	APRIL 2007	INCREASE/ DECREASE
UNITED STATES*			
Alabama	927	992	-65
Alaska	513	545	-32
Arizona	1,744	1,837	-93
Arkansas	577	616	-39
California	9,297	9,066	231
Colorado	1,840	1,703	137
Connecticut	1,518	1,526	-8
Delaware	441	428	13
District of Columbia	190	186	4
Florida	5,378	5,420	-42
Georgia	2,330	2,422	-92
Hawaii	518	503	15
Idaho	618	609	9
Illinois	3,690	3,747	-57
Indiana	1,471	1,439	32
Iowa	1,065	1,117	-52
Kansas	1,105	1,113	-8
Kentucky	936	880	56
Louisiana	813	737	76
Maine	624	664	-40
Maryland	1,467	1,450	17
Massachusetts	2,494	2,625	-131
Michigan	3,291	3,380	-89
Minnesota	2,555	2,611	-56
Mississippi	501	510	-9
Missouri	1,566	1,573	-7
Montana	659	595	64
Nebraska	868	915	-47
Nevada	730	694	36
New Hampshire	743	802	-59
New Jersey	2,932	2,740	192
New Mexico	682	679	3
New York	5,714	5,798	-84
North Carolina	2,365	2,245	120
North Dakota	364	364	-
Ohio	2,692	2,766	-74
Oklahoma	868	892	-24
Oregon	1,531	1,499	32
Pennsylvania	5,131	4,959	172
Rhode Island	361	378	-17
South Carolina	1,006	1,013	-7
South Dakota	391	387	4
Tennessee	1,317	1,282	35
Texas	4,281	4,250	31
Utah	559	577	-18
Vermont	350	374	-24
Virginia	2,172	2,170	2
Washington	3,061	2,866	195
West Virginia	508	526	-18
Wisconsin	2,591	2,529	62
Wyoming	315	329	-14
Puerto Rico	34	31	3
U.S. Possessions/APO	105	119	-14
Virgin Islands	43	52	-9
Subtotal U.S.	89,842	89,530	312
CANADA			
Alberta/NWT	798	851	-53
British Columbia/Ykn	1,062	984	78
Manitoba	424	414	10
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	263	248	15
Nova Scotia/ New Foundland/Labrador	431	378	53
Ontario	3,141	2,976	165
Quebec	249	256	-7
Saskatchewan	380	367	13
Subtotal Canada	6,748	6,474	274
FOREIGN	1,253	1,223	30
Grand Total*	97,843	97,227	616
LA VIÑA SUBSCRIPTIONS*			
	Mar./Apr. 08	Mar./Apr. 07	
	7,495	7,791	-296

(*does not include monthly orders)

Trustees' Committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine Reports

ARCHIVES

Trustees' report: In 2007 the G.S.O. Archives continued its active and exciting service for the Fellowship, implementing a number of new policies and initiatives. The new Sound and Video Access Policies have been implemented, allowing individuals to receive copies of our recordings on a limited basis. These policies permit us to share some of our thousands of wonderful audio recordings with the Fellowship, while abiding by copyright laws. Visitors to the General Service Office can also listen to excerpts of some of these recordings at the new digital listening station in the lobby. Work continues on cataloging the Archives' 4,000+ newly digitized audio collections.

The committee also approved new language designed to help foster awareness of copyright issues relevant to A.A.'s archival collections, for inclusion in the Archives Workbook. We hope this will promote a wider understanding of how copyright laws affect the way A.A. members collect and use archives.

We continue to be inspired by the dedication of local A.A. archivists out there in the areas, districts, and central/intergroup offices who are collecting and building the history of A.A. in their communities. We hope to assist them to preserve and make available their fantastic archival collections. To further this aim, the committee approved extensive revisions to the Archives Workbook, the Archives Guidelines, and the pamphlet "The A.A. Archives." These are all available online, as is the Oral Histories Kit, to assist those who wish to record the experience of local longtimers. We continue to consider ways to make the Archives Workbook more flexible and more user-friendly.

In order to continue our efforts to increase security in the Archives, we have implemented digital video surveillance of our Archives exhibit areas. We are always seeking ways to protect our collections through enhanced security procedures and preservation techniques.

The Archives continues digitizing its paper-based collections, which provides an extra layer of security and greatly facilitates searching. At the G.S.O. Archives, staff can now search all of our literature, most of A.A.'s pamphlets, all of the Conference *Final Reports* and *Box 4-5-9* articles, Bill's correspondence, and the minutes of the A.A.W.S. Board and General Service Board, with a few clicks. Moreover, some 60,000 group records have been converted to searchable digital files, enhancing the Archives staff's ability to respond to questions about the history of A.A. groups.

Chuck Barta, chairperson

Archivist's report: The G.S.O. Archives has had a productive year, serving and sharing in the Fellowship's growing excitement about A.A.'s history. In 2007 we responded to nearly 2,000 individual requests for research and information, an increase of almost 30% over last year. We are always gratified by the opportunity to help an

A.A. member or researcher to learn more about A.A.'s Three Legacies through our primary sources here in our archives collection.

We enhanced our exhibit area in several ways: we installed a digital listening station, allowing visitors to listen to excerpts of A.A.'s founders and pioneers sharing their stories; we installed two new exhibit cases so that we can display more of our treasures; and we created a self-guided tour here in the Archives, so our visitors now pick up a tour script when they enter and walk through A.A.'s history, learning about the significance of the objects and images on display.

Several new rotating exhibits were mounted; we highlighted A.A.'s connections to Hollywood, and A.A.'s associations with the military. Our traveling exhibit was on the move, traveling from Florida to Canada, Illinois to Texas, bringing A.A.'s history with it.

We published four issues of the Archives newsletter *Markings* in 2007—the first time this newsletter has been published quarterly. Stories in the newsletter this year tended to focus on the crucial fundamentals of archival practice, such as tips for preserving photographs and how to prepare for the worst-case scenario in archives, such as a fire or flood. We encourage members to send us your own stories about your archives and history so that the newsletter will remain "Your Archives Interchange." We plan to continue quarterly distribution in the future.

We also continued the ceaseless work of preserving the history of the Fellowship. We preserved, processed, and arranged several collections, including the papers of Nell Wing, Bill W.'s longtime secretary and A.A.'s first archivist, and Marty M., one of the first women in A.A.

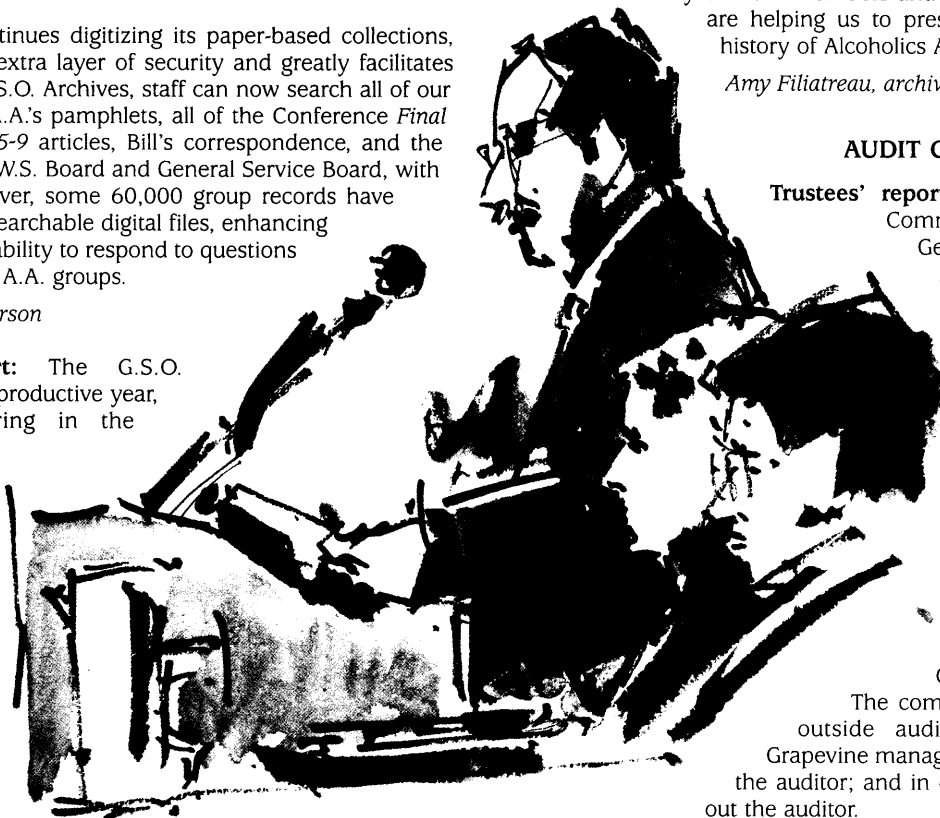
As always, we send our gratitude and thanks to those who have donated archival materials to G.S.O.'s Archives this year. We received more than 90 items and collections this year from members and their descendants who are helping us to preserve the irreplaceable history of Alcoholics Anonymous.

Amy Filiatreau, archivist

AUDIT COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Audit Committee, formed by the General Service Board in 2003, is composed of a minimum of three and a maximum of five trustees who are appointed by the chairman of the General Service Board. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance.

The committee meets with the outside auditor and G.S.O. and Grapevine management; separately with the auditor; and in executive session without the auditor.



The Audit Committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews such items as audit process, audit results, internal controls, best accounting practices, and management integrity. The Audit Committee also recommends appointment of the auditor to the board.

Herb Goodman, chairperson

COMPENSATION COMMITTEE

Trustees' report: The trustees' Compensation Committee, formed in 2006 by the General Service Board, consists of six trustees. The committee was created as a proactive measure to assist the General Service Board in fulfilling its fiduciary obligation of Prudent Corporate Governance. The committee reports to the General Service Board and reviews and advises A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. on such items as overall compensation philosophies and policies, annual salary increase process, best compensation practices, and executive compensation.

In July 2007, the committee determined that the following procedures should be conducted annually:

- The chairman of the G.S.B. Compensation Committee would request that each corporation submits a formal report from corporations' compensation consultants, to include a review and documentation of the executive compensation, the organization's policy and philosophy and reflect on the overall compensation structure.
- The committee would then discuss the submitted reports and prepare a summary report for the General Service Board.
- Any additional costs incurred by either corporation during this process would be an expense of the General Fund.

In October the Compensation Committee met with Harvey Benenson, compensation consultant for A.A.W.S., and James E. Rocco, compensation consultant for the A.A. Grapevine, to discuss the reports prepared by the consultants for the Compensation Committee.

Harvey Benenson presented his report, which contained analysis of the total compensation for the A.A.W.S. executives and highest-paid employees. The A.A.W.S. salary data was compared to the similar data from other not-for-profit corporations in the New York metropolitan area. On the basis of the presented analysis, Harvey Benenson concluded that "the compensation of the top executives and managers of A.A.W.S. and the General Service Office is reasonable and well within the range of competitive practice and levels. No incumbent is paid excessively, and if we have any concern, it is that some incumbents appear to be paid at the lower end of competitive practice. Some of this, however, may be attributed to differences in position content that are not easily verifiable or discernable."

Mr. Benenson also commented that "historically and currently, the cornerstone of the

G.S.O. compensation philosophy has been to offer a compensation program to all employees that is competitive with the compensation programs applicable to comparable employees in other nonprofits. In addition, for incumbents of positions that are not unique to A.A. and the nonprofit world, a goal has been to ensure that the compensation program is competitive with the organizations with which the G.S.O. competes for people." Mr. Benenson believes that A.A.W.S.'s philosophical approach to compensation and compensation administration is reasonable and appropriate.

The A.A. Grapevine consultant, James E. Rocco, presented his report that compared A.A. Grapevine executives' salaries with salary levels that currently exist in the competitive not-for-profit environment. The A.A. Grapevine study concluded that that A.A. Grapevine executives are paid within the acceptable compensation levels with no positions paid below the market median and only one position that is paid slightly above the market median.

As in the 2006 study, compensation consultants recommended Risk Committee of the A.A. Grapevine to establish a formal compensation philosophy. They also recommend that the A.A. Grapevine create and implement salary ranges based on the market data from both the 2006 and 2007 studies. This will help to ensure staff is appropriately compensated based on the external market and internal equity. Once the compensation philosophy and salary ranges have been established, A.A. Grapevine should develop salary administration guidelines for managing the compensation plan in an equitable manner. A complete staff compensation study should be conducted every two to three years to ensure that compensation remains competitive, particularly if there are significant changes in revenue growth or changes in staff roles and responsibilities. The A.A. Grapevine has now contracted James E. Rocco & Associates, Inc. to produce such a program, and work is now underway.

As the result of Benenson's and Rocco's reports the committee concluded that the current compensation situations of A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine are at the appropriate levels. The two corporations themselves have gained invaluable insights as the result of this exercise.

Herb Goodman, chairperson



CONFERENCE

Trustees' report: The committee met three times since the 2007 General Service Conference. During that period, we reviewed the Advisory Actions pertaining to the Conference, including the theme chosen for the 58th General Service Conference, "Communication and Participation—The Key to Unity and Self-Support." We also discussed summaries of the Evaluation Questionnaires and of a Post-Conference Sharing Session.

The committee developed and approved the schedule for the updated 2008 Conference week, and also approved the workshop questions for distribution in the Communications Kit which was mailed in December. In addition, we reviewed the list of suggestions for the theme and presentations for the 2009 Conference.

The committee reviewed a list of topics submitted to the Conference assignment at G.S.O. for consideration as agenda items in 2008. Forty-seven items were forwarded to trustees' and Conference Committees, or to the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Corporate Boards. This does not include any items that may have been submitted directly to committee secretaries or to the two corporate boards.

We recommended to the General Service Board that Conference committee agendas and background material be made available for all Conference members on an Online Dashboard on an experimental basis for two years, beginning with the 2008 Conference in addition to the hard copies and CDs currently available.

Based on a number of concerns expressed in the 2007 Summary of Conference Evaluations and those of a few members of this committee regarding the process by which a Minority Appeal to the 2007 General Service Conference occurred, a subcommittee was appointed to inventory that process and take a look at mechanisms for bringing forward Minority Appeals to the Conference in the future. The committee will discuss the subcommittee's report at its August 2008 meeting.

The committee considered a proposal regarding the process for review and approval of Conference literature. The proposal deals with the dissemination of background material, the editing and production procedure, and the voting process for approval of a Conference committee's recommendation that would result in Conference-approved literature. The committee had requested sharing from other trustees' committees about the practicality and usefulness of the proposal, and its potential impact upon

the ir

work. At their 2008 February meeting, the committee reviewed this sharing from other trustees' committees and, based on this review and the committee's previous discussions, took no action on this matter. In response to the possibility of significant increases in costs at the current site of the Conference, the committee has requested that the Conference Policy and Admissions Committee discuss a policy of delegating the authority to select and negotiate for the site of General Service Conferences to the General Service Office.

The committee discussed a request that the chairing of the General Service Conference, in all its sessions be performed by the chairman of the General Service Board, the first vice-chair, second vice-chair or the delegate chair. Although it took no action, there will be further discussion at their August 2008 meeting as to who should chair sessions of the General Service Conference.

Three areas proposed similar items related to the oversight of *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* and took no action. The committee requested that the chair of the trustees' Committee on the Conference consult with the chair of the General Service Board on how best to develop trustees' oversight of revisions to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service*.

The committee reviewed a district's request to display flags of countries that are part of an area's service structure at the Conference and took no action at this time. Since there seemed to be concerns by some members of the committee about the display of any flags at the Conference, the committee agreed to further discuss the use of flags at the Conference at a future trustees' Committee on the Conference meeting.

A.A. Central Mexicana and G.S.O. Great Britain requested that trusted servants of their respective service structures attend the 2008 General Service Conference as observers. The committee approved the requests and forwarded them to the 2008 Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

John Skilton, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the G.S.O. contact for General Service Conference members. The Conference process continues throughout the year and the coordinator corresponds regularly with delegates and alternate delegates, who cooperate to make the annual Conference responsive to the needs of the Fellowship. The coordinator of the Conference is also the contact

for area and district committee members, as well as past delegates, in the 93 areas throughout the United States and Canada.

The annual meeting of the General Service Conference, which first met in July 1955, is the closest thing A.A. has to a group conscience in the U.S. and Canada. A.A. members are encouraged to submit topics through their area structures for consideration by the Conference.

Suggested topics may be forwarded to a trustees' committee for consideration





and, where appropriate, referred directly to a Conference committee. Occasionally topics are submitted that are more appropriately under the purview of either the A.A.W.S. or Grapevine Boards. These items are accordingly forwarded to those boards for their attention. The Conference coordinator is responsible for:

- Serving as secretary to the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/discussion and workshop topics that are reviewed by the Conference Agenda Committee, which makes selections that are recommended to the Conference for approval.
- Working with the G.S.O. staff and general manager on planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and other information for the Conference Manual; and, with the guidance of the Publications Department, the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.

Doug Richardson

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY/TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community and Treatment Facilities were combined by action of the General Service Board in April 1998. Since the 2007 Conference, this committee has met three times.

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — A primary committee focus is assisting local C.P.C. committees to provide A.A. information to professionals who, through their work, may come in contact with the still-suffering alcoholic.

The committee reviewed the final report on Exhibit correspondence; revised letters; guidelines and Exhibit Evaluations and contacted the secretary with suggestions for National Level Exhibits. We also created a sample draft C.P.C. PowerPoint presentation for inclusion in the C.P.C. Kit. An electronic version can be requested from the C.P.C. staff.

We reviewed the sharing, received by the C.P.C. staff, on local C.P.C. committee guidelines on dress, punctuality, etc. for A.A. members to follow when staffing a booth at a national level conference. The committee also reviewed "For the Volunteers Staffing an A.A. Exhibit," the current letter that is mailed to Area C.P.C. chairs upon their acceptance to staff National Level exhibit events. The committee agreed that the current guidelines included within the "For the Volunteers Staffing an A.A. Exhibit"

letter are sufficient. The committee secretary will include this letter, a few times each year, in correspondence to C.P.C. chairs and will remind them to pass these guidelines along to all exhibit volunteers.

Throughout the year, the committee worked with the Publications Department on the video segments directed to professionals. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the draft video segments to professionals in the employment/human relations, legal/criminal justice, and medical fields, with minor suggested changes, be forwarded *only* to the members of the 2008 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community, prior to the Conference, for their consideration. (The total cost is not to exceed \$60,000).

Treatment Facilities — The committee's interest in treatment facilities, rehabilitation centers and similar centers is reflected through local A.A. committees on Treatment Facilities, Hospitals & Institutions (H&I) and Bridging the Gap (BTG). Shared experience about this facet of Twelfth Step work is conveyed in literature, by written communications, and by articles in *Box 4-5-9*. The committee considers the need for changes in related literature and service material, such as the Treatment Facilities Workbook and Kit.

Responding to a 2007 Conference Advisory Action that, "The video *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be revised, retaining only the script, and that sample footage or a progress report be brought back to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities," the committee began its work of overseeing the development of the new video. A progress report, including suggestions for minor script changes along with sample footage of the proposed new video, was forwarded to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities. The committee agreed that the current version of *Hope: Alcoholics Anonymous* be inserted, in DVD format, into the complimentary Treatment Facilities Kit sent to each new Treatment Facilities area committee chair.

In response to a request from the 2007 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, a memo was sent to area and district TF committees requesting sharing on local service information, as well as on locally developed service material. After a minimal response, a second request for sharing was mailed in early January 2008. Local sharing gathered prior to the mailing of this year's Conference background material has been forwarded to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities.

The committee discussed a request to "include in TF literature (A.A. in *Treatment Facilities*, *Bridging the Gap*, and the *Treatment Facilities Workbook*) information that would assist area/district Treatment Facilities Committees with their effort to carry the A.A. message to treatment professionals and patients in out-patient treatment programs" and requested that staff gather sharing on the topic from the Fellowship. The committee further requested that the sharing be summarized and presented at its August 2008 meeting.

We discussed and forwarded to the 2008 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities an area request "that the pamphlet, "Bridging the Gap" (P-49), be rewritten to reflect that we also use this program in Corrections service work."

The committee forwarded a suggestion from the 2007 Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board that it (GV) consider producing a special section on TF in the A.A. Grapevine and La Viña, once a year.

Bob Mayer, chairperson

Staff reports:

Cooperation With the Professional Community (C.P.C.) — Experience indicates that many professionals are aware of A.A., yet relatively few know what A.A. is or what we do, and even fewer have been to an “open” A.A. meeting. The staff member on the C.P.C. assignment, along with an assistant, provides information about A.A. and facilitates communication with those outside A.A. who may have direct contact with the still-suffering alcoholic through their professional work.

The C.P.C. desk responds daily to numerous inquiries from professionals. In 2007, 535 professional requests for information on A.A. were associated with visits to G.S.O.’s A.A. Web site. Other requests arrived by letter, e-mail, fax and phone. Many of these professionals were put in touch with local C.P.C. committees who responded with offers for direct contact, information about how to send clients to meetings, offers of literature, or other means to assure that A.A. is a resource for professionals.

Another way that we endeavor to see that professionals are aware of the long-range help offered by A.A. include the newsletter for professionals, *About A.A.*; two issues were published in 2007. The Spring issue shared about “Bringing up the Touchy Subject of a Patient’s Drinking” and the Fall issue focused on “Alcoholism Training Program for Doctors Pairs First-Year Residents with A.A. Members.” Currently, more than 22,333 professionals receive *About A.A.*

Professional exhibits continue to result in requests for additional A.A. information, as well as personal contacts with local committee members. The C.P.C. assignment arranged for displays at 45 national or international conferences of professionals in 2007. At these exhibits, G.S.O. provides the booth space and literature; local C.P.C. committees coordinate A.A. volunteers who staff the booth to answer questions and provide literature and contacts. In addition, 52 local exhibits were referred to area C.P.C. committees.

The C.P.C. desk is a resource for C.P.C. chairs throughout the U.S. and Canada. New chairpersons at the area and district levels are sent welcome letters and applicable C.P.C. background material. Upon request, we assist C.P.C. committees by sharing C.P.C. experience. C.P.C. committees are encouraged to send minutes and to share their experiences for possible inclusion in future *Box 4-5-9* articles. Articles were published in *Box 4-5-9* about local C.P.C. activities throughout the year, which created interest in C.P.C. service work with courts, clergy, doctors, medical students, educators and other professionals.

The C.P.C. staff member greets students from Cornell University Medical Center who visit G.S.O. throughout the year. These future physicians are helped to see that A.A. can be a valuable resource when they encounter the still-suffering alcoholic. The students are provided with literature, given a brief introduction to the A.A. program, a tour of G.S.O. and encouraged to attend “open” A.A. meetings.

The staff member on C.P.C. also serves informally as a liaison representative to several national meetings, such as the National Institute for Alcohol Abuse and Alcoholism (N.I.A.A.A.) and Recovery Month planning meetings.

Mary Dargan

Treatment Facilities — The primary purpose of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to share experience and information with committees that carry the A.A. message into a variety of treatment settings. The General Service Office currently lists 93 Area Treatment Facilities (T.F.) committee chairpersons, plus 393 district and other T.F. chairper-

sons, as well as 29 Area Bridging the Gap (BTG) and 18 Area Hospitals and Institutions (H&I) committee chairpersons; 136 BTG and H&I district and other chairpersons are also listed. The total list comprises 640 T.F. related trusted servants. Each is involved in one or more facets of providing A.A. meetings and/or information in treatment settings.

Highlights of quarterly meetings of the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities are sent to members of the Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Periodically, we share highlights from the trustees’ meetings and activities from the T.F. staff assignment with area, district and other T.F. chairs, for the benefit of the committees they chair. In addition, we are always grateful for local T.F. experience that may be included in an activity report or in a *Box 4-5-9* article.

Each committee chair is sent a welcome letter along with the Treatment Facilities Kit and/or Workbook, A.A. Guidelines and related material. These trusted servants receive *Box 4-5-9* and *About A.A.* to share with their committee. Area T.F. chairs also receive an up-to-date, confidential list of all Area T.F. committee chairs so that they can share experiences and activities. Correspondence, including requests for sharing and for G.S.O.’s collected experience, is always welcomed from local committees. Requests from professionals, clients and/or patients in treatment centers are given careful attention. Each professional is sent literature, and in most cases a contact with members of the local Treatment Facilities or C.P.C. Committee is arranged. Requests from clients receive a response from staff along with A.A. literature.

Additionally, this assignment provides a central point for shared experience about Remote Communities work in A.A., and the staff member serves as the G.S.O. liaison to A.A. members involved in this service, and works with the elected chairs of the pre-Conference Remote Communities Meeting. Remote Communities resource material housed at G.S.O. include pieces of A.A. literature (Serenity Prayer, Steps, and Traditions) that have been translated locally in a variety of Native North American/Aboriginal languages. Some of these translations—such as Mohawk, Navajo and Oji-Cree—were recently checked for accuracy and reformatted as service pieces for those who request them. The staff member on this assignment has also been working with Archives on assembling a history of Native North American A.A. meetings.

The T.F. staff member also serves as secretary to the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities, and as co-secretary to the trustees’ Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities.

Warren Stafford



CORRECTIONS

Trustees' report: The purpose of the trustees' Committee on Corrections is to recommend to the General Service Board actions that support carrying the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Since the 2007 General Service Conference, the trustees' Committee on Corrections has met three times.

At the recommendation of the 2007 Conference: We reviewed the final changes to the DVD "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" (formerly known as the "Informational Media Presentation Featuring Someone Highly Credible Introducing A.A. to Training Academies and In-service Training for Correctional Facilities") that had been requested by the 2007 Conference, and approved the DVD for production, translation and distribution. Committee members also discussed several avenues of possible distribution of the DVD to get it in the hands of relevant professionals.

We also viewed recommended changes in the service piece A.A. Corrections Prerelease Contact Information for A.A.s on the Inside (F-163) as it will look printed with a color, to make it more easily distinguishable from the companion service piece for A.A.s on the outside (F-162). Committee members also suggested that the companion piece (F-162) be printed using a complementary color, and the words designating whether the piece is for "A.A.s on the Outside" or "A.A.s on the Inside" be printed in such a way as to make the pieces more easily distinguishable when reprinted in black and white. The committee requested that the publications director have the changes made on the next scheduled reprint of both pieces.

A final draft of additions and changes to the Workbook, that were forwarded from the 2007 Conference Committee on Corrections and amended by the trustees' Committee on Corrections, was reviewed and accepted for inclusion in the Corrections Workbook as written with suggested layout.

In addition to considerations from the 2007 Conference Committee on Corrections, we reviewed a suggestion to consider the inclusion of a locally produced document known as the "4 Step Process" in the Corrections Workbook. The suggested "4 Step Process" is designed for starting or restarting A.A. meetings in correctional facilities. A piece similar to the one proposed was accepted for inclusion in the Corrections Workbook as written with suggested layout. We also requested and viewed a sampling of the booklet *A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate*, revised to make it more readable in keeping with previous decisions by the trustees' Committee on Corrections and asked that the next printing of the book be done using the easy-to-read format.

Madeleine Parmley, chairperson

Staff report: The Corrections assignment is responsible for helping A.A. members and local committees carry the A.A. message to alcoholics confined in a variety of correctional settings. Around 600 pieces of mail a month arrive from inmates, many requesting free literature, others asking to participate in our Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) or for help in making contact with A.A., either by asking for a meeting in their facility or for a prerelease contact. We try to facilitate these requests, primarily through our network of area, district and local Corrections committees. The newsletter, *Sharing From Behind the Walls*, containing excerpts of sharing from inmate letters sent to G.S.O., is also a responsibility of this assignment.

When inmates request free literature, they can be sent a Big Book and a selection of pamphlets, with an explanation that the enclosed literature is made possible through the voluntary contributions of A.A. members throughout the United States and Canada. Any additional literature needs are referred to those A.A. members doing this type of Twelfth Step service. This assignment

tries to avoid being viewed as the primary source of A.A. literature, since "carrying the A.A. message" in this way is an A.A. service opportunity.

The Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.), coordinated by this assignment, continues as one of our most valuable efforts. Many inmates are looking to turn their lives around and crave outside support from A.A.s with whom they can share their experience, strength and hope. In 2007 1,184 male inmates were linked to an outside A.A. C.C.S. volunteer and 423 female inmates were linked. Thus there is an ongoing need for "outside" A.A. members, particularly men, to participate in this service. An article appearing in the Holiday 2007 issue of *Box 4-5-9*, featuring several male A.A. members' experience with this service, brought about an up tick in the number of new volunteers at the beginning of the New Year. Yet we still depend on some of the "stalwarts" who write to as many as 10 or more inmates at a time.

The staff member sends an alternate year informational letter to wardens and corrections professionals throughout the United States and Canada enclosing a return postcard for those professionals requesting additional information or contact with a local A.A. Corrections committee. The mailing contains information that A.A. pamphlets and books are available in languages other than English, and language about A.A. that is particularly pertinent to selective correctional settings. This year it will also contain information about the new DVD "A.A. in Correctional Facilities."

One of the most gratifying aspects of the assignment is communicating with area and district Corrections, Hospitals and Institutions and Bridging the Gap Committees. Three or four times a year, an activity report goes to each of these committee chairs with updated information about new tools or shared experience on how to use those tools. In October 2007 each of the area chairs received a complimentary copy of the new DVD "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" with some suggestions about pairing up with local C.P.C. committees to contact corrections professionals and show the DVD, which features professionals in the corrections field telling of their own experiences of using A.A. as a resource.

Following the three trustees' Corrections Committee meetings, a report of the meeting highlights is mailed to delegates on the Corrections, Treatment Facilities, Cooperation With the Professional Community and Public Information committees. New Corrections chairs are welcomed with a Corrections Kit and Workbook to help them in their service.

A frequent question asked by A.A. members involved in corrections service is how to get their fellow members on the "outside" to commit to speaking or sponsoring a meeting in a correctional facility. The fear of not having the inmate identify with an A.A. member who has not been to prison, and the amount of time institutions require for orientation seminars to qualify to go into correctional facilities, are commonly pointed out as impediments to Fellowship participation. *Carrying the Message Behind These Walls*, a video created to encourage A.A. members to participate in corrections service, addresses many of the concerns that may hold members back from this rewarding Twelfth Step work.

Gayle Solheim Riese

Statistics on Delegates:

Average age 54; Oldest 74; Youngest 40; Average Length of Sobriety 19; Longest Sobriety 41; Shortest Sobriety 8; Longest Service 38; Shortest Service 4.

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' report: At last year's Conference we reviewed the proposed budget for 2007 and reported that the G.S.O. expected a profit from operations of approximately \$237,450, which after Conference actions resulting in mid-year budget adjustments, was reduced to \$89,450. Actual results for 2007 were significantly higher than both the original and adjusted budget; in fact, a net profit of \$1,018,600 was realized. While expenses for the year were approximately \$110,000 (less than 1%) under budget, total revenue was approximately \$820,000 better than expected thanks to strong sales and contributions. At the end of 2007, the Reserve Fund balance represented approximately 9 months of operating expenses.

General Service Office — As you know, our revenue essentially comes from two sources: profit from literature sales and contributions. We should all be encouraged that contributions in 2007 were again higher than the previous year, in this case by about \$457,800 (7.5%). This represents the tenth year in a row that contributions have increased over the previous year and continues to reflect a positive trend. Contributions of \$6,381,600 received from groups and members were \$330,700, or 5.5%, greater than budgeted, and \$459,200 (7.8%) more than in 2006. The \$6,381,600 in contributions came from 26,389 groups, individuals, and service entities. That, for comparison, represents 45.2% of the 58,340 groups registered with G.S.O., just slightly lower than the 45.5% reported last year.

Beginning in 2002, we were obliged to record funds received on behalf of the World Service Meeting International Literature Fund as Contributions to G.S.O. Total contributions of \$6,526,000, reflected in our 2007 financial statements, include approximately \$144,400 received to help carry the message around the world from those participating countries. The comparable comparisons for prior years were: 2006, \$145,000; 2005, \$135,000; 2004, \$128,357; 2003, \$102,900; and 2002, \$108,000. While total contribution dollars were higher again this year, the number of groups listed at G.S.O. was slightly less (199 groups fewer), and as noted above the percent of groups contributing declined ever so slightly (three tenths of one percent). It is important to remember that the statistics we discuss concerning number of groups, membership and averages are only a reflection of the information we capture on "our systems." We report to you what you report to us.

Turning to the other major component of our income, net sales of literature were \$12,393,800, which was \$743,800 (6%) greater than budgeted, and \$713,000 higher than 2006 as well. During 2007, with minor exceptions all books sold more units than in 2006. (During 2007, the total number of Big Books sold

was approximately 56,000 or 5.3% greater than in 2006.) In total, printing and other manufacturing costs, shipping expenses and royalty payments were more than budgeted by a considerable margin. This increase is a direct result of greater than expected sales, as well as the effect of inflation and pass along of fuel surcharges by the trucking industry due to the high cost of fuel. Gross profit of \$7,046,700 was \$487,000 greater than budgeted.

The combination of contributions and net literature sales resulted in total G.S.O. revenue of \$13,582,600, some \$820,000 greater than originally budgeted. Total operating expenses for G.S.O. during 2007 were \$12,564,000, approximately \$110,000 less than budgeted. When compared with budget, the increased revenues combined with expenses under budget resulted in a 2007 operating profit of \$1,018,600. This profit was significantly greater than both the budget for 2007 and the 2006 results.

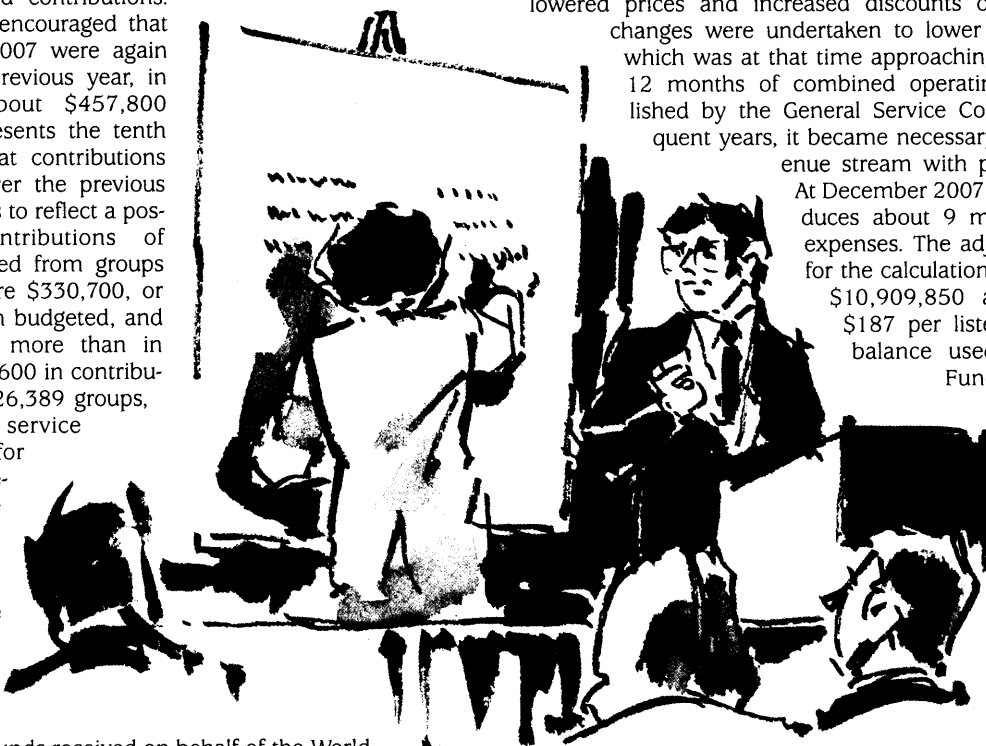
Historical Reference for Price Adjustments — In 1994, G.S.O. lowered prices and increased discounts on literature. These changes were undertaken to lower the Reserve Fund, which was at that time approaching the upper limit of 12 months of combined operating expenses established by the General Service Conference. In subsequent years, it became necessary to restore the revenue stream with pricing adjustments.

At December 2007, the calculation produces about 9 months of operating expenses. The adjusted balance used for the calculation at December 31 of \$10,909,850 amounts to about \$187 per listed A.A. group. The balance used for the Reserve Fund calculation has increased approximately \$900,000 from last year and is prior to any transfers in 2008. Dividing total Contributions received (\$6,526,000) by the 58,340 groups registered gives us

an average of about \$112,

while expenses to support services to those groups amounted to approximately \$146. Turning to 2008, the G.S.O. budget anticipates approximately level sales when compared with the prior year.

Recent pricing history — In 2005, after reviewing financial matters, your responsible trusted servants recommended an increase in prices of books and booklets (except the Big Book), as well as an imposition of a small shipping charge effective July 1, 2005. This followed by one year the restoration of the price of the Big Book on July 1, 2004. You may remember that the price of the Fourth Edition was set at \$5.00 (a \$1.00 per book reduction from \$6.00), specifically reducing the expected Gross Profit with a goal of reducing the Reserve Fund. Projections at that time anticipated that, depending on contributions, the price would be restored in a few years. Prudence dictated that even though Contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement during the last several years, restoration of the overall revenue stream was appropriate. Trusted servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations, as well as assess the services supplied. You should also be aware that as we continue to strive to



have literature available—for our Service Conference, in Spanish and French as well as English—lower print runs in those languages result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower overall gross profits are an expected result, making price increases required from time to time.

In keeping with our Seventh Tradition of self-support, this year's budget anticipates about a 2.3% increase in contributions. The budget envisions approximately a 5.6% increase in costs when compared with 2007 actual results, and a 4.7% increase when compared with the 2007 budget. It should be remembered that 2008 is a World Service Meeting year and the costs of that meeting not covered by participating countries falls to the General Service Board of U.S./Canada. Without those costs the 2008 budget would increase over the 2007 budget by only approximately 3.7%. Based on these preliminary assumptions—approximately even dollar sales; a 2.3% increase in contributions; and a slight increase in total operating expenses—the projection for 2008 is for an excess of revenue over expenses of \$240,800, approximately even with the 2007 budgeted profit before adjustments for Conference actions.

Expanding a bit on the use of the Fellowship's money in providing services back to the Fellowship—in 2007, we spent \$8,528,100 on services to the Fellowship, approximately \$256,000 more than spent in 2006. This compares with \$8,272,000 in 2006, \$7,443,300 in 2005, and \$7,622,288 in 2004. Contributions provided 76.5% and 23.5% came from the profit from literature sales. (This compares with 73% and 27% in 2006 and 2005; 68% and 32% in 2004; 72% and 28% in 2003; 71% and 29% in 2002; 70% and 30% in 2001; and 73% and 27% for 2000.)

The 2007 service dollar was spent on the following activities: Group Services, 33%, (which includes the Group Services assignment; *Box 4-5-9*; A.A. Directories; records and files; contributions processing; and French services); the General Service Conference, 12.3%; Loners, Internationalists, and Overseas Services, 9.8%; trustees' and directors' activities, 6.8%; Regional Forums, 7.1%; Archives, 9.6%; C.P.C., 5.6%; Public Information, 5.4%; Correctional Facilities, 4.5%; and Treatment Facilities, 2.2%; Special Needs; 1.4%; Nominating 1.8%; other various 0.5%.

The Grapevine — At the Grapevine, magazine income was approximately \$55,000 greater than the prior year, with average circulation approximately 2,200 copies higher as well. Average print circulation during 2007 was 106,099. This compared with 103,878 for 2006, 104,356 for 2005, 108,426 for 2004, 112,614 for 2003, 115,753 for 2002, 115,000 in 2001, 115,700 in 2000, 115,900 for 1999, 117,300 for 1998, 120,679 for 1997, and 128,360 during 1996. Gross profit on the magazine of \$1,182,770, was \$31,000 greater than last year but \$18,000 less than budgeted. Other publishing income was \$45,000 greater than budgeted and \$153,000 higher than 2006 as well. Gross profit on magazine related items was approximately \$46,000 more than budgeted and \$117,000 greater than 2006. Total income, including interest earned, was \$1,740,200, \$153,000 greater than 2006 and \$34,000 greater than budgeted.

Costs and expenses for editorial, circulation and business, and administration were \$1,765,200. Costs and expenses were \$129,200 more than last year, but \$22,300 less than budget. Excluding *La Viña*, the Grapevine reported a loss from operations of \$25,047, which was approximately \$23,000 less than the 2006 loss of \$48,872.

The Grapevine's 2008 budget, excluding *La Viña*, anticipates magazine income of \$2,089,461, approximately \$139,000 greater than the \$1,950,233 realized in 2007, an increase in magazine direct costs of \$22,600, and a gross profit of \$1,299,380.

Gross profit on Other Publishing Income is anticipated to increase \$42,000, while interest income should be about even. A profit for 2008 of \$3,200 is anticipated, compared with the \$25,047 loss for 2007. The effect of the price increase of \$2.00 that went into effective July 1, 2007 is included in this budget.

La Viña — *La Viña* is the Spanish-language magazine approved by the 1995 General Service Conference. Since then, the magazine has grown from an idea to a full-fledged publication with a 2007 average circulation of 10,979. This compared with a 2006 average of 10,223, a 2005 average of 9,453, a 2004 average of 9,316, a 2003 average circulation of 9,222, and 2002 circulation of 9,000, 8,600 in 2001, 8,500 in 2000, 8,000 in 1999, and 8,400 in 1997. *La Viña* appears to be a first-rate product. Our hope is that it will increasingly fulfill the needs of our Spanish-speaking members and we will see a growth in circulation. To date, the project has incurred losses each of the past eleven and one-half years. During 2007, subscription income was \$102,152 and direct costs of publishing were \$66,917, resulting in a \$35,234 gross profit. During 2007, *La Viña* realized approximately \$32,547 from the sales of CDs, net of costs. Operating expenses directly associated with the publication were \$134,821. These include the editorial, circulation and administrative costs attributable to *La Viña*. Therefore, the overall loss on *La Viña* for the year was \$67,040, compared with a loss for 2006 of \$72,000.

The Grapevine Board and management have worked hard to put out a quality product that is responsive to the needs of the Spanish-speaking members of the Fellowship on a cost-effective basis. For 2008, the loss on the *La Viña* magazine is budgeted to be approximately \$67,371, essentially the same as 2007, with circulation being projected to decrease slightly to 11,000 copies. The Grapevine Board and the trustees' Finance Committee continue to monitor progress and report results to the Conference. Since inception of the magazine, approximately \$1,134,000 has been invested in *La Viña* in excess of revenues generated. In 2001, the General Service Board recommended that *La Viña* continue to be published and agreed to provide the necessary funding.

Other items — During the year, the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee accepted a report from the subcommittee that "reviewed the policies and practices related to investing the assets of the Reserve Fund and its managerial oversight by the trustee's Finance Committee." The subcommittee concluded that, overall, the General Service Board has been well served by the investments made in the fund and the decisions made by those charged with maintaining this fund.

The trustees' Finance Committee recommended to the General Service Board that the October 25, 2007 "Investment Policy Statement Objectives and Guidelines" for the Post Retirement Medical Benefits Fund be adopted.

As noted in last year's report, the A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine Corporate Boards, as well as the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee, continue to receive information and recommendations from the Retirement Plan's actuaries concerning funding requirements as a result of 2007 pension legislation enacted by the U.S. Congress. This legislation called for accelerated funding of pensions, which is a departure from the previously accepted method of long-term funding of pensions over the employee's working life.

In summary, while your trusted servants continue to monitor financial affairs, steps taken over the past several years to enhance the revenue side of the equation, reductions in the expense side and consideration of long-term obligations help insure that the Fellowship's finances remain in good condition. The outlook for this year appears to be favorable, and we continue to have the financial wherewithal to carry our message.

Vincent Keefe, treasurer

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: Since the 57th General Service Conference, the board has held three General Sharing Sessions. Following is a summary of each session.

July 2007—"A.A. and Controversy—Tradition Ten" — Julio Espallat, G.S.O. staff member, spoke on "A.A. and Controversy—Tradition Ten and G.S.O.'s Experience." He explained how comfortable A.A. has always been with controversy and how controversy was crucial to the development of the Fellowship. Controversies, "growing pains," as Bill W. called them, have become the root for our principles, the basic fabric of our growth and continuity. When Bill W. wrote about Tradition Ten in 1948 he said that "we have thus far avoided serious controversies," and added further, "And because we have thus far adhered to our sole aim, the whole world regards us favorably."

A difference of opinion or "growing pain" would only become a serious controversy if it is taken to the public level and A.A. were placed in the middle of a debate. Julio noted that as A.A. increases its global presence, the idea of a controversy affecting A.A. "as a whole" seems more and more improbable. In the cases where A.A. is brought into the public view, our role remains to provide information about A.A., not opinions or judgments, and to see these situations as "an opportunity for A.A. to reply with dignified silence."

Bob Mayer, East Central regional trustee and director of the A.A. Grapevine, shared on "A.A. and Controversy—Tradition Ten: Fellowship Experience." He began by reading Tradition Ten: "Alcoholics Anonymous has no opinion on outside issues; hence the A.A. name ought never be drawn into public controversy." Bob shared that it wasn't until he had about five years of sobriety that he first encountered both the use and controversy of this Tradition. It was when he started his A.A. service career, and it happened when he brought in ideas from outside his local community. This caused commotion and turmoil among his home group, other groups, and the folks considered the "pillars" of A.A. in his community.

Has controversy been good or bad for our Fellowship? Bob offered a quick review of several of the many periods in A.A. history when controversy played a pivotal role in the development of our Fellowship. He noted that our Steps, Traditions, and Concepts allow for us to exercise our freedom to speak, have opinions, listen carefully and perhaps even change our mind, thus aiding in the development of an informed group conscience.

When a member does not agree with the outcome of the group, we have the right of the minority opinion so that the principle of reconsideration can be exercised.

Jim Branscome, nontrustee director of the A.A. Grapevine, spoke on "A.A. and Controversy—Tradition Ten: What A.A. Principles Apply?" He noted that the Tenth Tradition ensures that we as an institution never waver from taking inventory of ourselves and not others. Many of us alcoholics came to A.A. searching for "absolutes," Jim observed. Ironically, once in recovery, we learn to become comfortable with "dualism." Our human tendencies make the Tenth Tradition necessary; our human capacity to spiritually transcend our nature and to be guided by the language of the heart makes the Tenth Tradition workable for A.A. as a Fellowship.

Jim explained how we are living and guiding ourselves and our Fellowship by spiritual principles, principles that are valid for all time and for all circumstances. Problem moments, he noted, are critical junctions for renewal of principles, not times to take exception to them. Therefore, we need not fear controversy because it may lead to our renewal and to new paths to tread with strangers who soon become our friends. After the presentations the following sharing ensued:

- A Class A trustee explained how differently controversy is dealt with in A.A., how it is brought to the surface, debated and discussed, always hearing the minority opinion; once the group consensus is reached, true common ground is reached.
- Issues that seem to be so important and pressing now, will, over time, come to resolution. We grow through anger and turbulence, especially if we can remember that we have weathered these sorts of storms in the past.
- Controversy brings up fear and reluctance to share; but much passion can be dissipated by openly talking about controversy and listening to others. We have the Steps and Concepts to help us through our fears, both inside and outside of A.A.
- In the section of the "A.A. Group" pamphlet called *About those group problems* it is noted that controversy is the sign of healthy diversity of opinion and that a good sense of humor and patience will get us through.
- There is an element of self-sacrifice in Tradition Ten when the press descends on A.A. and our response is dignified silence.
- Controversy is probably something we do not speak about enough in A.A. It is a good thing as long as it comes to a final solution brought about through love and service.



October 2007—"A.A. Grapevine, Inc.—Challenges and Opportunities of Fulfilling Our Mission in the Electronic Age" — Madeleine Parmley, Pacific regional trustee, spoke on the topic, "Misconceptions and Challenges for the A.A. Grapevine, Inc." She shared that among the challenges facing the A.A. Grapevine is the misconception regarding its "Conference approval" status. Some in the Fellowship believe the A.A. Grapevine is not Conference-approved literature. Of course, though individual issues don't undergo Conference approval, the A.A. Grapevine and its publications are recognized as approved by the General Service Conference. Another misconception that may hurt subscription numbers is the notion that the Grapevine and La Viña are mostly suited for beginners. Yet according to a recent survey, 44% of readers have been sober for 18 years or more. Also, most articles are about staying sober, growing in spirituality, and becoming involved in service.

One of the greatest challenges facing the magazine is its aging readership and narrow demographic. The survey found 73% of readers are over 50 years old, that 95% are white, and that 60% are male. The A.A. Grapevine must attract a younger and more diverse A.A. population. Some see electronic publishing as a threat to a printed publication like the Grapevine. However, emerging technologies are enabling the magazine and its related products to reach more people. With audio books, the Digital Archive, the A.A. Grapevine Web site, and AudioGrapevine subscriptions, the Fellowship has additional choices.

Probably the greatest mistake in analyzing the A.A. Grapevine is using the bottom line to measure its success. Since the magazine accepts no contributions and is supported solely by the sale of its products, it has considerable financial constraints. Can we better convey this to the Fellowship? Can we encourage discussion about its value as a recovery tool? Can we truly place a price tag on its value?

Ray Massey, general service trustee and chair, A.A. Grapevine Board of Directors, spoke on the topic, "Planning for the Future." Ray shared that the Grapevine distributes stories of recovery to more than 600,000 people a month in several different media, but we still have to ask ourselves whether the magazine is doing all it can. How can we maximize our strengths and meet the challenges of today so that the Grapevine will light the way for the next generation of alcoholics?

These questions are behind much of the strategic planning that the board and staff have been doing the last year and a half. One of the magazine's greatest strengths is its deep well of stories, which number about 12,000 from past Grapevines, plus another 720 stories from La Viña. Every year, A.A. Grapevine Inc., receives approximately 1,400 new manuscripts. Two other strengths are the credibility and authority that come from being the only "international journal of A.A.," and its rich human resource.

There are large numbers of people in the Fellowship who don't know about A.A. Grapevine publications, particularly younger A.A.s, newcomers, Spanish-speaking members abroad, and minorities. The development of the Internet and digital technology opens up opportunities to make Grapevine and La Viña stories available in new media, like the AudioGrapevine; to produce and distribute publications and deliver office communications at reduced costs; and to offer A.A. members the chance to share their experience in different ways. There is also opportunity for the A.A. Grapevine to build a stronger relationship with A.A. members in the general service structure. Following are highlights of subsequent sharing:

- A staff member shared how receiving and reading old GVs had helped her when sobriety was still very new and that just as in those early days, the stories seem to cross all racial and cultural

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 2008¹

	Groups	Members
United States	53,595	1,220,993
Canada	4,745	93,559
Sub-Total	58,340	1,314,552
Correctional facilities ²	2,359	60,912
Internationalists		37
Lone Members		97
Total	60,699	1,375,598
Outside U.S. & Canada ³	52,469	669,057
Grand Total	113,168	2,044,655

1. The General Service Office does not keep membership records. The information shown here is based on reports given by groups listed with G.S.O., and does not represent and actual count of those who consider themselves A.A. members.

2. U.S. and Canada only.

3. We are aware of A.A. activity in more than 180 countries, including 60 autonomous general service offices in other lands. Annually we attempt to contact those G.S.O.s and groups that request to be listed in our records. Where current data is lacking we use an earlier year's figure.

barriers and can still move her to tears.

- There are many indigent folks who are without computers and are unable to access the information provided by GV on the Internet. There is a population that cannot afford to buy the GV or have limited access to it because of incarceration.
- We should routinely encourage A.A.s and Class A trustees to send in their stories.
- It is important that the board understand their GV customers, as well as giving subscribers what they want, spend time and money to understand what the customer wants.
- G.S.O.'s archivist shared that the GV digital archive has been very valuable.

February 2008—"Special Needs—A New Frontier" — Valerie O'Neill, G.S.O. staff member, described how the G.S.O. has assisted those alcoholics who serve the hearing-impaired, blind, disabled, etc., since A.A.'s earliest days. Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees first started appearing in the 1980s, well before G.S.O. had a Special Needs Desk. The service pieces "Forming Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees" and "Serving Alcoholics With Special Needs" were completed in the mid-1990s. Then, in 1998 the first catalog of A.A. Literature and Audiovisual Material for Special Needs was published.

Some Special Needs committees help blind A.A. members, some help deaf or hard-of-hearing A.A. members, some help homebound A.A.s, A.A. members in wheelchairs, developmentally disabled A.A.s, and members with brain damage. There has been some discussion over the years that the term "Special Needs" is not appropriate in A.A. The answer that appears to be

accepted is that there are no "special" A.A. members, but there are A.A. members with special needs.

Valerie noted that with there being 40 Area Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees currently in existence, she can envision a future when all areas will be able to reach out to A.A. members with special needs in a systematic way as part of an ongoing local committee and group conscience process. Valerie ended with the observation that Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees offer a great opportunity for the U.S./Canada service structure. If we continue to gather and expand Special Needs Twelve Step service experience, we will be able to become a power of example of this service to trusted servants in countries with emerging A.A. structures. She is proud of the Special Needs trusted servants who are on the front lines providing this much-needed and invaluable A.A. service.

John Kane, general service trustee, addressed from personal experience the physical, emotional and spiritual impediments to getting to a meeting. Is A.A. responsible, he asked, for providing assistance to those who need it to get to a meeting? Is this a distraction from our primary purpose? He shared that he believes it is not a distraction but an enhancement. However, just as the General Service Board must pay attention to cost, so must every A.A. entity, particularly the group.

This responsibility to address the special needs of society as a whole is definitely the new frontier for Alcoholics Anonymous. There are physical, emotional, and spiritual barriers facing some of our members. These barriers prevent people who need and want what we have from getting it. If we are truly to practice these principles in all of our affairs, John offered, it is incumbent upon all of us to help those who have difficulty in helping themselves. "Let us resolve that we will approach this new frontier with a determination to find solutions for those with special needs that they may experience what we have and they want."

John concluded that Bill W. gives us the reasons why we should assist those with special needs in the chapter, "Working with Others," in the Big Book: "Practical experience shows that nothing will so much insure immunity from drinking as intensive work with other alcoholics." We should not be deterred if they have special needs. Highlights of the sharing that followed the presentations include:

- Several Conference delegate chairs shared that their A.A. groups worked with members with a variety of individual challenges. The groups asked themselves what they could do to make their meeting place more accessible, and solutions ranged from using the hospice van to bring the member to their A.A. meeting to actively welcoming those who needed to bring their children to the meetings. Each delegate noted that the individual A.A. member with special needs gave unselfishly to A.A., sometimes for years, and their "special needs" condition offers A.A. the opportunity to give to them.
- When an area addressed the needs of the brain damaged and those who required ASL translation of meetings, it discovered that the best approach by far was for special needs to be addressed on the local level. The area also found that alcoholism appears in large numbers among nursing home residents and this opened up whole new avenues for service.
- We have discovered through experience with those with mental and physical special needs that the most valuable gift we can give those with special needs is our time.

At the conclusion of all the General Sharing Sessions, the chair thanked the presenters and all who shared, and ended the meetings with the Serenity Prayer.

Dorothy Hurley, chairperson

A.A. GRAPEVINE, INC.

Office report: As its mission statement says, the A.A. Grapevine's "primary purpose is to carry the A.A. message to everyone interested in alcoholism, through its magazines, websites, and related items." To that end, this year the Grapevine published twelve issues of the Grapevine magazine, six issues of La Viña, and two books of selected stories from the magazines: *In Our Own Words: Stories of Young A.A.s* and *Lo mejor de La Viña (The Best of La Viña)*. The Grapevine also published a large-print edition of *The Language of the Heart*, and recorded *The Best of Bill* in Spanish and English on CD. It also produced four new CDs: *Old-Timers*, *Attitude Adjustment*, and *Powers of Example*, remastered from Grapevine audiocassettes, and *Historia de AA*, a Spanish-language translation of the English-language CD *The Story of A.A.* The A.A. Grapevine wall calendar and pocket planner came out in August.

The Grapevine's chief goals in 2007 were to expand the number of people it reaches and to balance its budget. It met both. Average monthly circulation of the A.A. Grapevine in print and audio combined was 107,042, which was 3.24% higher than last year; average bimonthly circulation of La Viña was 10,979, an increase of 7.4%. The AAGV distributed a total of 135,828 books, CDs, and other items, 13.5% more than last year. Response to the new books, *Emotional Sobriety* and *In Our Own Words*, was particularly strong. While netting a loss of \$25,047, the corporation finished the year \$56,286 ahead of its Grapevine budget. It also finished the year \$5,294 ahead of its La Viña budget, which netted a loss of \$67,040.

This growth was the result of a multidepartmental effort. Circulation developed and implemented an effective circulation program, which included publication of a new catalog, press releases, and post cards; stepped-up communication with readers, Grapevine/La Viña reps (GvR/RLVs), and intergroup/central offices; increased attendance at state and international young people's conferences (YPAAAs); conducted surveys of Grapevine area chairs, AudioGrapevine subscribers, and fifty-pack users; and the Keep It Simple campaign launched at last year's Conference. By the end of the year, there were approximately 2,800 GvRs and 350 RLVs. Workshops and presentations at conventions and assemblies proved to be an important means of increasing awareness of Spanish-language publications. The editorial and the Internet department continued to update the look of the website, electronic newsletter, and magazines; to explore the use of new media; and to publish more stories by and for young readers and newcomers. These departments also have made more of an effort to encourage the Fellowship to write stories about recovery, service, and their concerns about the program in a new department called "What's On Your Mind?" The new section, "Alcoholism at Large" has drawn a hearty response from readers, as has the issue on Dating Sober. The prices of Grapevine and La Viña subscriptions were raised this year to keep pace with rising fixed costs such as postage. We've been glad to see that, so far, this does not seem to have impacted circulation. There has been an effort to explain that the Grapevine strives to be self-supporting and does not receive group contributions to cover the cost of its operation.

Staff also took part in the planning that the Grapevine has engaged in this year, participating in two strategic planning sessions with the board and developing goals for each department. With two new members on the team—a freelance art director for the Grapevine and a full-time editor for La Viña and special projects—we are looking forward to the year ahead.

The Editorial Advisory Board, a group of A.A. members with substantial experience in publishing, played an important role in the work done at the Grapevine as well. It met five times since

the last Conference to discuss such issues as the redesign of the web-site's home page, the editorial content of "Alcoholism at Large," and proposed publications for the International Convention. The board met a fifth time in a joint session with the Corporate Board to consider ways the Grapevine might better convey the power of our program on the Grapevine website and demonstrate through the Fellowship's stories the help and hope that alcoholics around the world have found in Alcoholics Anonymous.

Robin Bromley, executive editor

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The group services coordinator responds to all inquiries and concerns of A.A. members and other individuals regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site, and manages G.S.O.'s Intra-Office Web site Committee. The responsibilities of the group services coordinator also include serving as G.S.O.'s liaison for Intergroups/Central Offices and supervising the updating of service material. Examples of service material include: Group Handbooks; G.S.R. and D.C.M. Kits; and A.A. Guidelines. Ongoing projects:

- The Group Services coordinator works closely with the digital media manager to continually update and improve G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
- The Group Services coordinator collaborates with the Support Services manager regarding A.A. Directories (Canada, Western U.S., and Eastern U.S.) and is a resource to the managing editor regarding the updating of *The A.A. Service Manual*.

The staff member on Group Services also serves as secretary of the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, as secretary to the Services Committee of the A.A.W.S. Board and as the regional correspondent for the southeast region of the United States.

Mary Clare Lynch

INTERNATIONAL

Trustees' report: This committee is responsible for suggesting policies and actions to assure that the A.A. message is available around the world, especially in areas where there is no established service structure. We provide shared experience, support translations of A.A. literature in other languages, and encourage the expansion of regional or zonal meetings. The committee is the primary link between the international A.A. community and the U.S./Canada General Service Board of Trustees.

World Service Meeting — The 20th World Service Meeting (WSM) will be held October 26-30 in New York City, with the theme "Service—Gratitude in Action." We are anticipating approximately 50 delegates representing over 30 countries or zones. Jo-Anne Lowenberger, trustee-at-large/Canada, will be the first-term delegate, and Dorothy Wilson, trustee-at-large/U.S., will be the second-term delegate representing the General Service Board. G.S.O. general manager, Greg Muth, will be presiding at the event and staff member Julio Espallat will serve as WSM coordinator. Other staff members who will serve as secretaries to WSM committees are Rick Walker, Irene Kontje and Warren Stafford. John Kirwin will be the logistical coordinator, in charge of the workroom and hotel facilities.

Literature Assistance — The 2008 Literature Assistance budget of \$150,000 will allow A.A. World Services to translate and publish a variety of foreign-language books, pamphlets and reprints. A portion of this expense will be drawn from the International Literature Fund, representing contribu-

tions from A.A. groups and structures around the world. A.A.W.S. holds the copyrights on all foreign-language versions of our Conference-approved material and issues licensing agreements for publication and distribution to those countries which have an established general service office, board, conference or structure. When necessary, we translate and publish the material, subject to scheduling by the Publications Department and approval of the A.A.W.S. Board. In 2007, 16 translations were completed.

Interim Zonal Meetings — The United States and Canada were represented at four zonal service meetings in 2007, which are held in the year when the World Service Meeting does not meet. In May 2007, Doug Richardson attended, as an observer, the 3rd Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meeting (SSASM) in Windhoek, Namibia. The new G.S.O. staff member on the International desk, Julio Espallat, attended, as an observer, the 7th Asia-Oceania Service Meeting in Tokyo, in July; the 14th European Service Meeting in Frankfurt, Germany in October; and the 1st West Central Africa Service Meeting (RACO) in Paris in December. Dorothy Wilson and the new trustee-at-large/Canada, Jo-Anne Lowenberger, attended as delegates the 15th Meeting of the Americas (REDELA) in São Paulo, Brazil in October.

International Trips — The General Service Board and G.S.O. responded to many invitations from other countries to attend events ranging from conventions, anniversary celebrations, conferences, board meetings, office visits, regional assemblies, and other events. Trustees and staff members visited many countries, including Kenya, Namibia, Sweden, Japan, Finland, Russia, Mongolia, Germany, Brazil, Malta, Italy, Oman, France, Poland, Cuba, Ukraine and Costa Rica.

We continue to be encouraged and inspired by the international A.A. community and General Service Boards and offices in other countries, who carry the A.A. message to countless thousands in new regions and across difficult linguistic, cultural and economic barriers.

Dorothy Wilson, chairperson

Staff report: The International desk receives correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information about A.A. in countries outside of the U.S. and Canada. Additionally, the staff member corresponds with 60 international general service offices and/or literature distribution centers. Additionally, the staff member is responsible for communication with structures, groups and members outside the United States/Canada. Correspondence arrives at the International desk in many languages and is answered in the appropriate language, often accompanied by A.A. literature. In order to accomplish this, the staff member on the assignment is assisted by a bilingual (English-Spanish) assistant and outside professional services. Where there is a nearby office, we provide the location, telephone number and e-mail or Web site address. We emphasize our faith in the fact that these members can maintain sobriety, help others and become independent in their own countries. The International staff member benefits by the experience of G.S.O.

staff, cooperation with the Publications Department and, most importantly, the complete support of the trustees' International Committee, which he or she serves as secretary. Other responsibilities on the assignment are:

- Serving as coordinator for the biennial World Service Meeting (WSM) and maintaining contact with WSM delegates and their offices throughout the year.
- Maintaining close communications with our Publications Department on requests for new translations of literature, and the beginnings of new general service or information offices that may be able to distribute literature to local members and groups.
- Translation of A.A. literature: Each year, the A.A. World Services Board receives offers to translate our literature into foreign languages. Primary in consideration of each request is the need to ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message. To that end, the Publications Department has the responsibility of having each translation checked against the English original. In countries where there is a general service board licensed to publish or distribute A.A. literature, an approved translation is often financed and published there. Where a stable A.A. structure is not yet present, the A.A.W.S. Board undertakes the new publication when funds are available. The Big Book has been translated into 57 languages, and additional translations are in progress.
- Communications related to overseas trips, including Interim Zonal Service Meetings, held biennially in the year between each World Service Meeting. In addition, our office sends one or two observers to the Asia-Oceania, European, Eastern European and Sub-Saharan Africa Service Meetings. Our trustees-at-large (U.S. and Canada) are our delegates to the Meeting of the Americas (REDELA).

Julio Espallat

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' report:

International Conventions — Much of the exciting activity for the 2010 International Convention lies in the next few years, but we are beginning to address some of the specifics of planning now. The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the "San Antonio—75 Years" design for the 2010 International Convention logo be approved. The logo will be trademarked for our use on International Convention letterhead and signage.

The committee also considered its policy regarding vendors of goods and services at previous International Conventions and recommended to the General Service Board that during the International Convention of A.A., July 1-4, 2010 in San Antonio, Texas, only those purveyors of goods and services that are part of or under contract to the Convention management will be permitted to operate on any of the facilities or grounds that are assigned to or under contract to the Convention management.

We reviewed and accepted the following program categories for the 2010 International Convention: Workshops, Panels, Regional Meetings, Topic Meetings, Marathons, Mini-Marathons, Special Interest Meetings, Special Needs Meetings, Special Language Meetings.

The participation of non-A.A. speakers was discussed and a request was forwarded to the 2008 Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums that up to 21 non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate in

the 2010 International Convention at A.A.'s expense.

The committee reviewed the site selection process and considered the Delegate and City Convention and Visitors' Bureau Bid Questionnaires submitted for site selection of the 2020 International Convention. We recommended to the General Service Board that the undernoted seven cities be forwarded to the Conference Committee on International Conventions/A.A. Regional Forums for consideration as possible sites for the Convention in 2020: Denver, Detroit, Indianapolis, Los Angeles, Minneapolis, New Orleans, Vancouver.

Regional Forums — Since the 2007 General Service Conference, Regional Forums have been held in the Northeast, West Central, Southwest, East Central, and Western Canada Regions. In addition, there were two Special Forums held in northern Canada, one in Yellowknife, Northwest Territories, and the other in the east in Rimouski, Québec. All were well attended by enthusiastic A.A. members interested in learning more about A.A.'s general service structure. Many in attendance were experiencing their first A.A. service event as well as their first Forum. Each Forum was viewed as an opportunity to present information about the three corporate boards, G.S.O. and the Grapevine. Equally important was the opportunity to hear sharing of experience, strength and hope, as well as challenges and successes of A.A. members on the front lines of service.

To encourage additional sharing at Forums, the committee asked that changes to the Regional Forums format and schedule be incorporated, and suggested a full-Forum presentation on A.A. around the world. The committee also recommended that the editor of *La Viña* attend Regional Forums as appropriate, the decision to be made on a case-by-case basis in consultation with the executive editor of the A.A. Grapevine and the Forums coordinator.

The committee recommended to the General Service Board that the request for a Local Forum, to be held at the International Conference of Young People in Alcoholics Anonymous (I.C.Y.P.A.A.) over the July 4th, 2008 weekend in Oklahoma City, be approved. This is the first Local Forum request received by this committee since the implementation of Local Forums in 2007.

We recommended to the General Service Board that a Special Forum be held February 14 and 15, 2009 in Moose Factory in Area 84 (Northeast Ontario). (They had previously approved then declined the application upon implementation of Local Forums.) We also discussed the request for a Special Forum to be held in Golden, B.C. (Area 79), May 9-10, 2009, and took no action. The committee encouraged Area 79 to apply for a Local Forum and asked the committee secretary to forward Local Forum information to the area delegate.

The committee discussed additional correspondence regarding an area's request that the 2007 General Service Conference consider making a Special Forum for Native Americans an annual event until no longer needed and took no action. The area request has been considered by this committee and not the General Service Conference as Forums are General Service Board events. The committee noted that a process has

begun with the Native American A.A. community coordinating Native

American A.A. Gatherings/Forums with support and assistance by the General Service Board and General Service Office. The committee noted that the concept of



an annual Forum coordinated by the General Service Office is outside the current Forum structure, and forwarded to the chairman of the General Service Board correspondence which included concerns about how to better carry A.A.'s message to the Native American alcoholic.

The following Regional Forums are scheduled prior to the 2009 General Service Conference:

2008		
June 20-22	Eastern Canada	Howard Johnson Hotel Truro, Nova Scotia
August 29-31	Pacific	Doubletree Hotel- Spokane City Center Spokane, Washington
November 21-23	Southeast	Crowne Plaza Knoxville Knoxville, Tennessee
2009		
February 14-15	Special "Remote"	Moose Factory, Ontario

Herb Goodman, chairperson

Staff reports:

The International Convention — This assignment entails coordinating the myriad details involved in producing the A.A. International Convention, held every five years. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for bringing the Convention to life and ensuring that thousands of A.A.s can share and celebrate A.A.'s Anniversary.

While still on the back burner, plans are under way for the next International Convention in San Antonio, Texas, July 1-4, 2010, with the theme "A Vision for You." Big meetings will be held in the Alamodome, and other meetings will take place in the San Antonio Convention Center and local hotels. Notifications about the Convention, including housing and registration information, will be made available as we get closer to the dates. General information is currently posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and updates will be published in *Box 4-5-9*, which is mailed throughout the Fellowship.

Rick Walker

Regional/Local Forums — The staff member handling Regional Forums is responsible for coordinating and following through on all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums and Local Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These sharing weekends help foster wider communication and understanding among A.A. members and service workers in a region, the General Service Board, A.A. World Services, Inc., the Grapevine Corporate Board, and the Grapevine and G.S.O. staffs. Regional Forums are organized by the General Service Board and held at the invitation of a particular region every two years; currently there are four Regional Forums annually. Prior planning and on-site work gets done with the help of a staff assistant.

The location and agenda for a Regional Forum are decided jointly by the regional trustee, area delegates and G.S.O. The Regional Forums coordinator at G.S.O. distributes invitations to participants and registration forms to groups and service workers throughout the region and, working with the host contact and regional trustee, coordinates Forum

details: hotel arrangements, program, hospitality and displays. The Regional Forums coordinator is also responsible for preparing and distributing an "Early Bird" newsletter at each Forum and forwarding a Forum Final Report to all who attend. The Final Report includes answers to questions dropped in the Ask-It Basket for which there was no time to respond over the weekend. Sometimes the sharing is so enthusiastic that there is not enough time to answer all questions from the Ask-It Basket at the Forum.

In October 2006, the concept of Local Forums (LF) was approved by the General Service Board. The purpose of Local Forums is to bring Forum information to A.A. members in remote, sparsely populated areas, urban neighborhoods or underserved A.A. communities. Any A.A. community or service entity may request a one-and-a-half or two-day Local Forum. Unlike Regional Forums, the responsibility for Forum expenses, such as meeting room rental and miscellaneous expenses, are assumed by the Local Forum Committee. The General Service Board will send two participants, one from the board and one from the General Service Office, as well as display literature at board expense.

The G.S.O. Forums coordinator would help with the following:

- Be available as a source of shared experience for LF Committees.
- Finalize LF agenda with LF Committee.
- Review the LF flyer and LF flyer distribution process; provide labels for LF flyer mailings if necessary.
- Coordinate LF attendance by two board representatives, one of whom will be a board trustee, preferably the regional trustee.
- Send literature and Forum displays.
- Review the Final Report prepared by the Local Forum Committee secretary for accuracy and provide answers to Ask-It Basket or other questions related to the board, G.S.O. and the Grapevine.

The staff member on the A.A. Regional Forums assignment also serves as secretary of the trustees' and Conference International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Rick Walker

LITERATURE

Trustees' report: This report offers a summary of the literature projects of the trustees' Literature Committee since the 2007 General Service Conference.

- "A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet — Seventy one stories were submitted for consideration for the revised pamphlet. In January, the trustees' Literature Committee reviewed a



manuscript that contained the revised introduction and fifteen selected stories for the revised "A.A. for the Native North American" pamphlet and forwarded it, with one change, to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature for their consideration.

- *"The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" pamphlet* — In July the committee agreed that the Publications Department begin the process of revising the "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" pamphlet and present a progress report to include a timeline, story solicitation and review process, and outline the process for revising the front matter in the pamphlet. The committee also discussed and took no action on a request to create a pamphlet specifically for the alcoholic who suffers from grave emotional and mental disorders such as serious depressive disorder, bipolar disorder and schizophrenia. In January, we reviewed a progress report prepared by the Publications director on the revision of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" and agreed to forward it to the 2008 Conference Committee on Literature.

- *Dissemination of background to Conference members* — In response to a request from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference for sharing, the trustees' Literature Committee discussed a proposal that had been submitted to the trustees' Conference Committee regarding the process for review and approval of Conference literature. The committee agreed that implementation of this proposal would not be practical, would impair the ability of the committee to decide how to handle items, would increase the workload, and has the potential to distract from other important matters.

Projects ongoing:

- The text "Financial Support: Current experience indicates that many groups provide financial support for their general service representatives to attend service functions," will be added to the "G.S.R." pamphlet at the next printing.

Projects Completed:

- *"The A.A. Group" pamphlet* — The text "Financial Support: Current experience indicates that many groups provide financial support for their general service representatives to attend service functions," has been added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet.

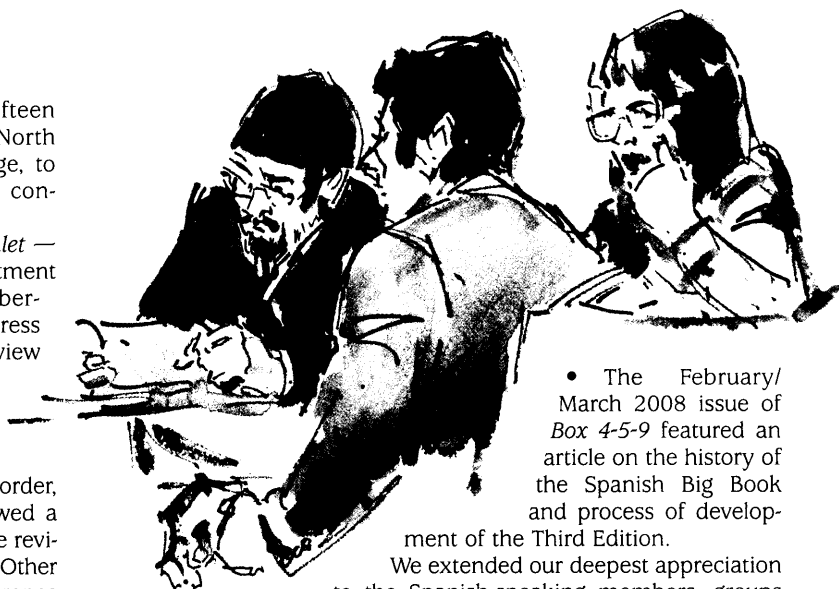
- *"Can A.A. Help Me Too?" pamphlet* — The title of the pamphlet "Can A.A. Help Me Too?" subtitled "Black/African Americans Share Their Stories" has been changed to "A.A. for the Black and African American Alcoholic" per the 2007 Conference Advisory Action.

- *Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book, Alcohólicos Anónimos* — Following Conference approval in 2007, the Spanish-language Third Edition Big Book was published in February, keeping in mind the 2004 Conference Advisory Action on contents, story selection, and process.

- In December 2007 a notice was sent to Spanish-speaking central/intergroup offices listed in the U.S. and Canada announcing that the Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, Third Edition, would be available February 2008. Spanish-speaking offices received a complimentary case of 20 books. All English and French local offices listed in U.S./Canada were notified.

- A letter of appreciation was sent to all authors who submitted stories for *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, thanking them for their generosity of A.A. spirit and participation in this historic event, and including a complimentary copy.

- A complimentary copy was sent to the G.S.R./or mail contact of Spanish-speaking groups listed in the U.S. and Canada.



- The February/March 2008 issue of Box 4-5-9 featured an article on the history of the Spanish Big Book and process of development of the Third Edition.

We extended our deepest appreciation to the Spanish-speaking members, groups and local offices for their direct and indirect participation in this process and historic event. We hope that this new edition will continue to help carry the A.A. message of hope and recovery to still-suffering alcoholics wherever they may be.

Projects forwarded to the 2008 Conference Literature Committee:

- Manuscript containing revised introduction and selected stories for the revised "A.A. For the Native North American" pamphlet.
- Progress on the "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" pamphlet.

Bill Clark, chairperson

Staff report: As secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees, the Literature coordinator works closely with the editors, writers and illustrators on reviewing all new recovery pamphlets, books and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. Along with the Publications Department, the coordinator follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all existing recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

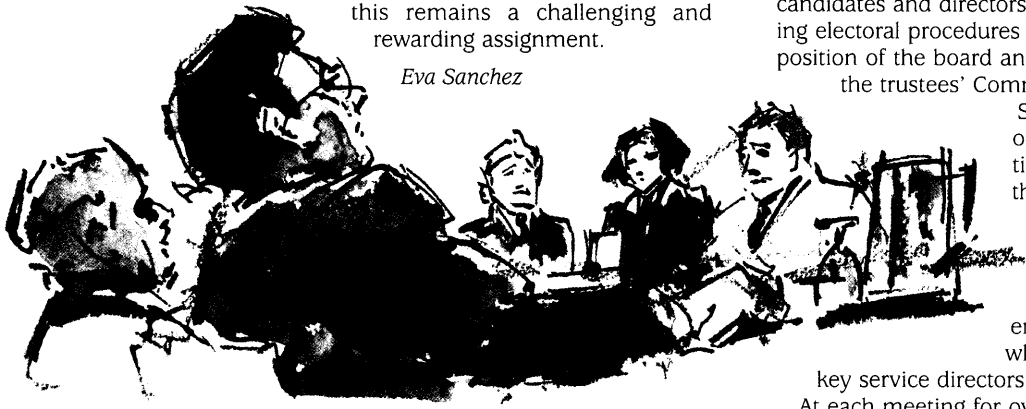
This year there was close collaboration and cooperation with the Publications Department on distribution of complimentary copies of the Third Edition Spanish-language Big Book, *Alcohólicos Anónimos*, to Spanish-speaking groups and intergroup/central offices, on responding to the many inquiries regarding the history of the Spanish Big Book, story selection and committee process.

The Literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about A.A. literature. Many of these inquiries are passed along to our Order Entry Department, our Customer Service representatives, our Publications staff and our Archives staff. Contact is also maintained with all current area, district, intergroup/central offices and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and guidelines to assist the chairperson in this vital responsibility. There are currently 75 area, 400 district and 320 other literature chairpersons listed with G.S.O. The Literature assistant is invaluable in supporting and helping facilitate the responsibilities of this aspect of the assignment.

The Literature staff member also gathers sharing for Box 4-5-9, published in English, French and Spanish with the following bimonthly distribution: 70,000 copies in English, 3,000 copies in French and 7,000 copies in Spanish. The staff member works closely with the Publications Department editor and the G.S.O.

editorial committee to continue to bring the Fellowship news and notes from G.S.O. in Box 4-5-9. The editorial committee welcomes ideas, suggestions and sharing on service from the Fellowship so that Box 4-5-9 can be an accurate reflection of both Fellowship and G.S.O. activities. As literature is essential in helping to carry our message of recovery, this remains a challenging and rewarding assignment.

Eva Sanchez



LONERS, INTERNATIONALIST, HOMERS

Staff report: The Loners/Internationalists Correspondence Service is a valuable method of sharing for about 97 Loners in 58 countries, plus 35 Internationalists, and 100 Homers. Loners are members who are unable to attend A.A. meetings because there are no A.A. groups within a reasonable distance. Internationalists are members working or serving on a seagoing vessel for lengthy periods, and Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to illness or physical incapacity. Each is a valuable part of a service coordinated by the General Service Office that enables the member to stay sober by sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters, tapes and/or e-mail, in addition to reading A.A. literature.

The correspondence service also includes 334 Loner Sponsors, who are not "Sponsors" or "Loners" in the traditional sense. Instead, these members share their A.A. group experience and activities with Loners, Homers and Internationalists through correspondence. We also list 36 Port Contacts who are valuable resources when Internationalists are briefly onshore. These members also share experience and hope via correspondence.

Complimentary literature is sent to each new member, including the *Loners, Internationalists & Homers Directory* and a subscription to Box 4-5-9. Each LIM member receives the *Loners/Internationalist Meeting-by-Mail (LIM)*, a bimonthly publication comprised of excerpts of letters from LIM members to the General Service Office. As with any directory or list distributed by G.S.O., LIM is confidential to insure the anonymity of LIM members.

In 2007, correspondence from around the world demonstrated that the A.A. program continued to be the basis of sobriety and our way of life. A single issue of LIM may include sharing from Australia, Belgium, Germany, England, India, Ireland, New Zealand, Peoples Republic of China, Slovenia, Taiwan, Vietnam, one or more countries in Africa, as well as Canada and the U.S. The letters are inspiring in their simplicity and straightforward sharing. It is a joy to be on the LIM assignment, to benefit by the sharing of members who encounter unique challenges to their sobriety and courageously share their A.A. experience, strength and hope with one another.

Warren Stafford

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Nominating of the General Service Board was first appointed by the chairman of the board on January 18, 1944. At that time primary responsibilities were to "establish criteria for and to review résumés of trustee candidates and directors and to make recommendations regarding electoral procedures and matters which may affect the composition of the board and election to it." (History and Actions of the trustees' Committee on Nominating)

Since that time the trustees' Committee on Nominating generally has met three times each year and, with the forming of the General Service Conference in 1951, the committee began to meet annually with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The responsibilities of the committee grew over time to encompass criteria for all vacancies—whether in the ranks of trustees, or among

key service directors and staff members.

At each meeting for over 60 years, the committee has worked to fulfill the task outlined for it. In *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, developed in 1962, that task included: "The recommendations of this committee to a large extent will determine the continuous success of our services. Its members will have the primary voice in choosing our future Trustees and non-Trustee workers. Careful deliberation, painstaking investigation and interviewing, refusal to accept casual recommendations, preparation well in advance of lists of suitable candidates—these will need to be the principal attitudes and activities of this committee. All temptation to haste or snap judgment will need to be faithfully and constantly resisted." (page 49)

Activities of this committee in the past year:

- Reviewed the résumés, curriculum vitae, and other background material from six applicants who have corporate and business experience as well as a sound financial background for the Class A (nonalcoholic) trustee vacancy to replace Vincent E. Keefe following the April 2008 General Service Conference. The committee chose three applicants to interview for the position in October of 2007 and February 2008. One applicant withdrew as he was not available for either interview date. The committee noted that the prior lengthy search process for the current consultant to the Finance Committee also involved contact with applicants with a sound financial background. Following the interviews, the committee unanimously recommended to the General Service Board that Terrance M. Bedient, FACHE be invited to serve as a Class A trustee treasurer, as of May 2008.
- Recommended to the General Service Board, as eligible for election in April 2008, all candidates submitted for Western Canada and West Central regional trustees.
- Accepted the October 2007 Final Report of the "General Service Board Unexpected Vacancy Scope and Procedures" Subcommittee and recommended to the General Service Board approval of adding language to the committee's procedures to clarify the process for filling unexpected vacancies for general service trustees, trustees-at-large and regional trustees.
- Formally notified the General Service Board that Tom Kraemer, committee chairperson, had contacted the delegates of the Eastern Canada Region to discuss the recent amendment to the Bylaws of the General Service Board regarding options for filling a Class B trustee vacancy. The group conscience decision of these delegates was that they wished to leave the position vacant as was previously determined in October 2006.
- Recommended to the General Service Board that Nominating

Procedure No. 3 be revised so that the First and Second vice-chairperson of the General Service Board can be chosen from currently-serving Class A or Class B trustees.

- Recommended to the General Service Board that Nominating Procedure No. 9 be revised to clarify the length of service of the general manager, G.S.O.

- Prepared a report on Nominating Procedure No. 9 and the length of service of the general manager, G.S.O. in response to an Additional Committee Consideration of the 2007 Conference Committee on Trustees.

- Recommended to the General Service Board that John J. Kane, Jr. serve as a trustee director on the A.A.W.S. Corporate Board, following the April 2008 General Service Conference, replacing Howard Lowery, and that Conley F. Byrd, Jr. serve as a trustee director on the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board, following the April 2008 General Service Conference, replacing Bob Mayer.

Tom Kraemer, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment's staff member is responsible to the trustees' Nominating Committee, as well as to the Conference Committee on Trustees, serving as secretary to these committees as well as to trustees' subcommittees. The staff member has prepared background, minutes and reports for four trustees' committee meetings as well as for thirteen conference calls. Since the July 9th rotation, the staff member has gathered background for a search subcommittee for a replacement for the rotating Class A treasurer; for a subcommittee dealing with procedures for unexpected vacancies on the General Service Board; for a subcommittee reviewing the composition of officers of the General Service Board; and, for the committee's discussion of Nominating Procedure No. 9 and the length of service of the general manager, G.S.O.

The staff member on this assignment also serves as a resource point for Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees within the Fellowship, sending out welcome letters, Special Needs Kits and shared experience to area and district committee chairs in addition to responding to Special Needs correspondence. Special Needs Kits include twelve *Box 4-5-9* articles sharing Special Needs Twelfth Step experience as well as lists of suggested activities for Special Needs/Accessibilities Committees and Cooperation With the Elder Community (CEC) Committees. This assignment acknowledges that there are no "special" A.A. members but there are A.A. members with special needs.

In a presentation at the February 2008 board weekend, the staff member shared her experience at an annual event organized by a local Special Needs Committee and attended by A.A. members in wheelchairs, deaf alcoholics, A.A. members with brain damage, blind A.A. members and A.A. members with other disabilities. Their presence at this event recognized their importance as part of their local A.A. community. Two A.A. members with brain damage shared how proud they were to be members of *Alcoholics Anonymous* as, in spite of their problems with reading aloud and problems with verbal communication, no one in A.A. has ever

laughed at them. Another A.A. member shared that, thanks to his sobriety, on most days the restrictions of his wheelchair and his disabilities do not dictate his attitude or his ability to be loving, kind and tolerant to his family, his fellow A.A.s and humanity in general.

A past delegate emphasized that she considers herself a "T.A.P.—a Temporarily Able-bodied Person." The staff member shared that it was truly humbling and inspiring to see first hand the magnificent courage that A.A. members with special needs bring to the smallest daily task and the triumph of A.A. in addressing their alcoholism and helping them to live and grow spiritually in spite of their disabilities.

Valerie O'Neill

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' report: The trustees' Committee on Public Information is charged with the responsibility of helping the membership carry the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers. We do this by recommending and coordinating activities which include: creating a greater public understanding of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; producing television and radio public service announcements (P.S.A.s); preparing and posting press releases on the AA.org Web site; coordinating health fairs and other community and school exhibits with local P.I. committees; conducting the triennial A.A. Membership Survey; and carrying A.A.'s message through electronic as well as print media. Projects over the past year have included:

Television P.S.A.s — In response to a request that a new P.S.A. be developed for review by the 2008 Conference, the committee considered several concepts that were submitted by outside producers. A subcommittee was formed to coordinate the selection of one concept for development of this P.S.A. In October 2007 the committee recommended that the concept "I Thought," submitted by Banyan Communications, Inc., be developed as the proposed 2008 TV P.S.A. After viewing rough cuts of the P.S.A. at their February 2008 meeting, the committee made several suggestions for changes, and agreed to forward to the 2008 General Service Conference a revised version of the P.S.A.

Communications with the Media — The committee reviewed the text and format of the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media and suggested that this year's letter be sent by e-mail only, and that requests for further information and feed back be evaluated and compared to previous years.

Membership Survey — The committee oversaw the development and implementation of the 2007 Alcoholics Anonymous Membership Survey, and reviewed a rough draft pamphlet of the results at their February 2008 meeting, which they forwarded to the 2008 Conference Committee on Public Information.

Young People's Videos — We requested video/digital submissions from the Fellowship; when more submissions have been received,

selected videos will be compiled into a DVD that can be used by local P.I. committees to help carry the A.A. message to



young people in high school and college settings. The committee spent considerable time discussing the project guidelines and copyright assignment form, and continues to consider the best option for assigning copyrights. A Progress Report was forwarded to the 2008 Conference P.I. Committee.

Oversight of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site — The committee reviewed quarterly reports from the A.A.W.S. Board regarding changes to the Web site, updates on Web site activity, a summary of requests from the Fellowship regarding the Web site, and a summary of actions taken by the A.A.W.S. Board in response to those requests. An annual report by the A.A.W.S. Board was forwarded to the 2008 Conference Public Information Committee.

Film projects — In the past, the committee has participated in film projects about A.A., other than TV P.S.A.s, but no current film projects are slated at this time.

The P.I. committee remains committed to doing all they can to assist the membership in their service of carrying the A.A. message of recovery through the general public to the alcoholic who still suffers, and welcomes suggestions from delegate areas as to what more can be done.

Ward Ewing, chairperson

Staff report: This assignment is charged with assisting the A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public-schools, health fairs, libraries, and all forms of the media. Following are some of the ways that this task is carried out:

- Communicate with over 800 P.I. committee chairpersons at the area, district and intergroup/central office or group level to provide them with Workbooks, Guidelines, and current shared information on Public Information activity.
- Provide literature to supplement the efforts of local Public Information committees that are serving as a resource about Alcoholics Anonymous at local health and community fairs.
- Provide P.I. committees with information regarding the production and distribution of television and radio Public Service Announcements (P.S.A.s), in order to enhance their efforts on the local level, and refer all media requests for P.S.A.s to local committees.
- Respond to all inquiries that come to the office from the media, providing them with accurate information about Alcoholics Anonymous.
- Read and process a number of newspaper, magazine and Internet feature stories that mention Alcoholics Anonymous, and receive information from members regarding anonymity breaks at the level of press, radio, films, television and the Internet.
- Pass along instances of anonymity breaks in the media to the delegate in the area in which the break occurred, and provide them with an opportunity to contact the member and share experience regarding our Eleventh Tradition.
- Send out the Annual Anonymity Letter to the Media. In March 2008 it was e-mailed to over 9,000 media outlets in the U.S. and Canada. This included daily and weekly newspapers, wire services, radio stations, and TV networks, stations and cable services.
- Coordinate the triennial A.A. Membership Survey. In 2007 the Survey was sent to approximately 750 groups in the United States and Canada, with instructions to delegates and to group representatives regarding timelines and instructions for responding. The results of triennial surveys are then published in pamphlet form and as a large format table display for visual

information about Alcoholics Anonymous at public events.

The goal of Public Information work at G.S.O. is to see that the A.A. message of recovery reaches the still-suffering alcoholic by informing the general public about the A.A. program.

Irene Kontje

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups are the heartbeat of the General Service Office. Eleven A.A. members comprise the "G.S.O. Staff" with each person responsible for a functional assignment in addition to responding to requests from a specific region in Canada and the U.S., or from other countries. In 2007 the staff received 37,993 such requests by mail, e-mail and fax, plus many phone calls daily. The staff coordinator helps to assure that letters are answered when staff members are involved in large projects or away from the office to attend A.A. events, or at times of illness or vacation. All mail, e-mail, faxes, etc. are responded to within ten business days.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of staff trips to area assemblies, conventions, Regional Forums, and other large A.A. events, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. To further assure that the work flow is smooth and adequately covered, assignments are divided into two units. Unit A consists of Cooperation With the Professional Community, Corrections, International Convention, Literature, Nominating, Public Information and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes Conference, Regional Forums, Group Services, International, and staff coordinator.

G.S.O. staff has the benefit of the experience of A.A. groups gathered over many years. These resources are passed on to members who seek guidance for their group, central office, district or area assembly. Requests for guidance received from the Fellowship are often brought to weekly staff meetings, so that all responses reflect either research from A.A. literature or service material or the collective experience of G.S.O. staff and archives. Our weekly staff meetings provide a forum for sharing ideas on how to improve services to A.A. groups and members or how to provide the most complete answers to Fellowship inquiries. The staff coordinator chairs these weekly meetings and prepares a report on this sharing session which is distributed to heads of various G.S.O. departments for their information. G.S.O. staff members serve as secretaries to trustees' and Conference Committees and also are voting members of the General Service Conference. The staff coordinator is secretary to the Conference Policy/Admissions Committee.

In 2007, G.S.O. welcomed a total of 1,477 individuals in addition to English and Spanish-speaking groups ranging in size from 10 to 50. Each visitor had an opportunity to see and hear "how G.S.O. works" during a tour of both G.S.O. and the Grapevine offices. Often visiting members and guests attend the "open" A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on Fridays. This is an opportunity for the G.S.O. staff to welcome A.A. members from all over the world or from around the corner.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance material, preparing the minutes of board meetings and gathering information on board activities that appears in the Quarterly Report. The staff coordinator has the privilege of serving as a director on A.A. World Services, Inc. in accordance with Concept IV, and also serves as liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. None of these activities would be possible without the dedication and skill of a very capable support staff.

Adriene Brown

Area Service Highlights — Panel 58 Delegates

(Only first-term delegates give Area Highlights)

Alaska: Area 02 is the entire state of Alaska. We have over 200 groups in 11 districts spread over 586,000 square miles. Geographic distances and financial constraints are factors in our area—meeting only five times in assembly per panel. However, the last two years we have tried a monthly Area teleconference to facilitate actions of the Area Committee and get updates of the service work being done by the standing committees. The consensus is that the area's communication and continuity have been greatly enhanced. This year, we hosted the Pacific Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly in Anchorage. Hundreds of members from the Alaska Area Fellowship put in countless hours to make PRAASA possible. Last September we celebrated 60 years of Alcoholics Anonymous in Alaska and in 2008 it will be 50 years since we became a delegate area. We owe a tremendous debt to those who came before us, and the only way to repay that will be the work we do to carry the A.A. message of recovery. — *Torvald Hansen*

Alberta/North West Territories: Area 78 comprises the province of Alberta, the Northwest Territories, a large portion of Nunavut Territory, the Peace River region, which extends into British Columbia, a slice from the southeast corner of British Columbia—and one group in the province of Saskatchewan. Geographically—Area 78 is HUGE—the largest area in North America. We have just over 500 groups in 48 districts carrying the A.A. message in this vast, sparsely populated landscape. In 2005 we introduced a Travel Assistance program to encourage participation of all districts at assemblies, particularly to the Pre-Conference Assembly in March, where they can be part of the process leading up to the Conference. A Special Forum was hosted in Yellowknife, NWT, last July. Yellowknife is about eleven hundred miles from my home group. Around 50 of us “southerners” made the trek north for this incredible event. In the past five years group contributions to the area have increased by 48% and most will agree that this has come about through communication with groups. — *David Bruha*

Arizona: We have an exceptional corrections conference that just completed its eighth year. We have strong emerging Hispanic districts that are producing some wonderful leaders. We are carrying the message to isolated Native American communities and there is considerable interest in carrying the message to the elder alcoholic in Arizona. Recently there has been some minority opinion that our area has become more concerned with administrative affairs than how we carry the message. Is it possible that we have become so self-absorbed in tinkering with our process that we have overlooked the primary reason for our existence? We're focusing our attention this rotation on our standing committee chairs, or “coordinators.” It is our goal for our coordinators to identify and maintain communication with their counterparts in the local districts and intergroups. This way the coordinators can function as a conduit for an exchange of ideas and information. We must always remember that while our administrative work is vital to the continuation of A.A. nothing is more important than our primary purpose. To carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. — *Dennis Wilson*

California (Mid-Southern): Area 09 has an estimated A.A. membership of more than 56,000—consisting of over 1,800 groups with 24 districts. Six of those are Spanish-speaking districts, one new one recently formed. We have been trying for some time to become a bilingual area. We have simultaneous translation at all area events—facilitated by profession-

al translators—and do our best to insure that every piece of information that is put out for the area is also available in Spanish. We have 15 standing committees; 11 committees are represented with English- and Spanish-speaking co-chairs, who share the duties of the committee equally. Our Cooperation with the Elder Community Committee is in their third year of existence and it is very active and doing an amazing job reaching out to those within our community. There are 14 central offices within our area, five Spanish-speaking and nine English-speaking. Our repository houses all of our area's archives and is open to anyone that is seeking knowledge of our area's past. — *Joe Barrett*

California (Northern Interior): Nestled in the middle of the northern half of the state, California Northern Interior embraces nearly 50,000 square miles. Area 7 has 28 districts, including 3 Spanish linguistic districts. Of the 906 groups, ten percent are Spanish-speaking. Providing translation continues to be a challenge for us. We now have at least one Russian-speaking meeting in Sacramento. One of our districts, which was dark at the beginning of the last panel, has returned, revitalized and participating in the activities of the area. Several new initiatives include the development of our area Web site and the inclusion of Bridging the Gap into the services supported by the area. Our Area Archives Committee makes our history more accessible to all. We have a number of active district and central office P.I./C.P.C. committees. Our E-Services Committee tries to anticipate our electronic needs. We continue to strive to fulfill our mission to inform and encourage the groups in our area to step up to our First Concept challenge. — *Lee Wilson*

California (San Diego/Imperial): Situated in the two southern-most counties of California, the San Diego-Imperial Area has nearly 1,500 groups in 23 districts—three Spanish-speaking and 20 English-speaking. In the past two years the assembly added Information Technology, Accessibilities, and Translation to our list of standing committees. Translation is especially important for maintaining unity in our bilingual Area. The area Web site has been improved to allow districts and committees their own space. Our Institutions Committees bring about 120 meetings per week into correctional and treatment facilities. The Archives Committee presented the annual R.O.O.T.S. meeting—an acronym for Remember Our Old Timers' Stories. The speakers for this event all have over 30 years sobriety and recount the early days of A.A. in San Diego. The Unity Day program and annual picnic is co-sponsored with the Spanish and English Intergroups and two H&I Committees to celebrate Founders Day. At the end of each quarter, we send any amount of money over 50% of our budget to G.S.O. — *Gail Nelson*

Delaware: Area 12 has approximately 270 registered groups offering about 400 meetings, of all types, weekly. Our various area committees are reaching out to the still sick and suffering who have yet to find our rooms. Both Literature and Grapevine sales remain healthy. The area also cooperates with our three Intergroups, carrying the message of hope and recovery, from the hills of New Castle County, to the farmland of Kent, to the sandy shores of Sussex. Our Area Web site also offers a wealth of information, and links to other entities within our state. Our D.C.M.s are busy, putting on workshops, publishing newsletters, and doing what they can to keep our G.S.R.s informed. Efforts are ongoing to “relight” several “dark” districts. We are also striving

to reach out to inmates in the state's corrections system, and to a growing Hispanic population, especially in Southern Delaware.
— *Joe Schranck*

Georgia: Area 16 has approximately 702 groups, 17 Districts and 19,500 members. District 17 includes Spanish-speaking groups throughout the entire area. Most of the districts are subdivided into zones. There are 50 D.C.M.s representing the districts and zones. Area officers are elected to two-year terms. The delegate rotates into a two-year term as state chairperson and then to a two-year term as chairman of the office committee. There are three area business assembly meetings each year. These meetings are held in Macon, a central location. The area office is also located in Macon and houses a state-of-the-art archives facility. Seven Forums are held each year in every section of the state, based on the Conference presentation/discussion topics. A Pre-paid Convention is held each October. — *David Morgan*

Idaho: Area 18 is composed of 12 districts, including one recently formed Spanish linguistic district, with over 200 registered groups and over 3,500 sober alcoholics. The area covers 138,600 square miles from the Grand Teton Mountains in the east to Hells Canyon in the west; from the Salmon River in the north to the Northern Nevada desert in the south. We hold three area committee meetings per year in the south-central part of the area. Full-bodied assemblies are held around the area and hosted by different district committees. We currently have area conventions during the same weekend as our area assemblies; while this divides the attention of our membership, many believe it to be a contributing factor in the unity we enjoy and the reason for having over 50% of our G.S.R.s in attendance. We are beginning to experience growing pains with the addition of the Spanish linguistic district, which has doubled in size since inception; we are looking into the need to restructure as we begin to outgrow many of the convention hotels in some parts of our area. — *David Fox*

Illinois (Northern): Area 20 is a gentle mix of urban and rural. Our borders are Iowa, Wisconsin and our neighbors are Southern Illinois Area 21, and the Chicago Area 19. There are 24 Districts in the Area, 23 that have drawn distinct markings and boundaries. We have a Spanish-linguistic district that communicates with all of the registered Hispanic Groups or meetings in our area. Area 20 has 1,175 registered meetings and/or groups, with approximately 24,000 members. For the past two years an ad-hoc committee has been looking at the service structure and how to attract more G.S.R.s to the assemblies and to service overall. We have recently started to conduct GSR and Service Orientation Workshops. Recent meetings between the three Areas of Illinois and the Illinois Department of Corrections have given rise to the "Spirit of Cooperation." In October 2007, the East Central Regional Forum, hosted by Area 19, was held in Area 20, Arlington Heights, IL and 563 A.A.s found their way there. — *John Conway*

Indiana (Southern): Area 23 has 923 groups in 26 districts and is served by five intergroups. We hold five assemblies and one budget committee meeting each year. The April Assembly is a pre-Conference assembly. At our February 17, 2008 Assembly, we added a Hispanic district, which represents 15 groups located throughout the state of Indiana and includes one group in Cincinnati. An Area 23 past delegate assisted the groups in forming a Hispanic Intergroup six years ago, which is in Indianapolis and is thriving. This past delegate is now the district's liaison to Area 23 and assists with translations of reports and other items

to bridge the linguistics gap. Our area committee chair has started traveling G.S.R. "schools" to introduce G.S.R.s to Area 23. I look forward to serving our districts and A.A. as a whole over the next two years. — *Michalene Reilly*

Kansas: Area 25 has an estimated 9,000 members, with 370 registered groups in 28 districts, in which two are linguistic districts. Our largest district has 43 groups and the smallest has four groups. We hold two assemblies and two committee meetings each year. We have 11 standing committee chairs that are present at each assembly and committee meeting along with several past delegates. We had 131 voting members at our January Assembly, along with 85% attendance of D.C.M.s. Area 25 Correction's Committee is hard at work taking meetings into all eight state prisons, numerous city/county jails and one Federal facility. They also host an Area Correction Conference each year. We have had a great success with our new Area web site (Kansas-aa.org). The site had over 205,000 hits in six months. We have a quarterly newsletter, the *Grape Free Press*, that includes letters from all area offices and chairs, upcoming events, agendas for the assemblies and committee meetings along with their minutes. — *Bruce Kesl*

Kentucky: Area 26 is made up of 35 districts, representing some 650 groups in Kentucky, Indiana, Illinois and Ohio. The groups are served by six central offices. At our first area committee meeting in October we hold concurrent workshops for new G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Discussions are ongoing with regard to what types of articles and announcements should be included in our quarterly publication, *The Kentuckiana Newsletter*. We have a newly revised and improved Web site and our webmaster has even set up email accounts for all area officers. We are struggling a bit with the role of the area at the annual state convention. The convention alternates between six cities, with each city having its own host committee. We are quite proud of the Area 26 archives located in Lexington. — *Barbara Frizzell*

Maine: Area 28 covers the state of Maine and parts of New Brunswick, Canada. We have over 440 registered groups and over 7,000 members. We meet as a committee five times a year. Our assemblies are held twice a year, spring and fall, and districts bid to host these assemblies, so we travel all over the state. At the spring assembly we try to stick to the Conference agendas and at the fall assembly we concentrate on state-wide agendas, with the odd year fall assembly including the area's elections. Area 28 has 26 districts and all but three are active and attend area meetings regularly. This may be due in part to Area 28 recently establishing a struggling district fund. Our newsletter, the *Boomerang*, has a very wide circulation and is printed in English and French for our friends in the north. The area also sponsors every third weekend in July, a Round-up, which is on Sugarloaf mountain. Last year's attendance was 1,100 people, and Al-Anon is always there putting on their workshops and meetings. — *Kathi Davis*

Manitoba: Area 80 has 14 districts and approximately 150 groups. We have four full assemblies a year. Usually one or two are held in Winnipeg, the most populated center in our province, where the greater percentage of our approximately 3,900 A.A. members reside; the other assemblies are held in rural or northern Manitoba. There are a couple of ongoing challenges which Area 80 has had for a number of years. One is to have, at our quarterly assemblies, all 14 districts represented by a D.C.M., and the other to have participation from all groups, particularly those from the north. Our province covers 251,000 square miles,

so travel is a definite factor. One item that we have put into our budget is called "Assembly Subsidization," which would provide financial support to groups and districts that cannot afford to send a representative to the assemblies. In February 2009 we will host the Western Region Alcoholics Anonymous Service Assembly (WRAASA). — *John Johnson*

Maryland: Area 29 consists of 21 of the 23 counties in Maryland, and serves 1,015 active registered groups in 47 districts. Maryland is served by 10 intergroups. Described as America in miniature, we hold five assemblies and four committee meetings a year, hosted by various districts all around Maryland. There are 19 committees serving Area 29, including our State Convention held in June in Hagerstown and our Fall Conference, which moved this past year to Ocean City. We enjoy continued cooperation and communication with our intergroups through our Intergroup Liaison Committee. Area 29 maintains an oft-read Web site, www.marylandaa.org, which includes district pages where workshops and other district events are posted. We become informed on Conference Agenda Items through six regional panels that meet in February and March each year, which prepares our delegate during a weekend Mini-Conference in April. — *Tom Revelle*

Massachusetts (Western): Geographically, we may be rather small but the message of hope is carried by over 4,800 members. More than 250 groups put on about 450 meetings each week. One of the benefits of our size is the ability of our area officers to visit the monthly meeting of each of our six districts, six standing committees, both Intergroups that serve our area, the Institutions committee and the Western Massachusetts Young People's Conference Committee. Our Spanish language community, while not yet organized as a linguistic district, has formed a service committee that meets regularly. With our neighbors to the east, Area 30, we host an annual state convention. New York's Hudson, Mohawk, Berkshire, Area 48, to the west, have worked diligently with our D.C.M.s, area registrar and immediate past delegate to move some Massachusetts meetings, formerly registered in HMB, to Area 31's rolls. While we may still be the "Golden West," our official name is now Western Massachusetts Area 31 General Service, Inc. — *Sally Spencer*

Michigan (Western): Area 34 meets as an assembly on a monthly basis, alternating between one of the 15 geographical districts. This gives all 549 active groups an opportunity to participate in the general service structure experience. We also have one Spanish-speaking linguistic district. We have ten standing committees. Our P.I./C.P.C. committee is placing special emphasis on the senior community, the retired community, and seminars for nursing home workers. Our assembly has established a committee to develop a handbook of Area guidelines. In 2009 we will be hosting the East Central Regional Forum in Kalamazoo. We participate, along with Area 32 (Central Michigan) and Area 33 (Southeastern Michigan), in a Statewide Service Committee which meets quarterly to discuss and communicate what is happening in each area. We rotate the Michigan State Convention between the three areas and participate in a three area Mock Conference in March. — *Gregg King*

Minnesota (Northern): Area 35 has 531 registered groups, 8,896 members and 18 districts. Annually, we have two assemblies and a service workshop, which is held the third weekend in January using the theme and presentation topics from the Conference. These meetings are rotated within the area's four

zones. There are four committee meetings a year which are not rotated. Conference agendas and background material are forwarded to the appropriate committees and discussed at the spring assembly prior to the Conference. Area 35 will be doing an area Inventory at the Fall Assembly. Additionally, we voted to have an online version of our area newsletter, the *Northern Light*. Many active service workers participate in the West Central Regional A.A. Service Conference and Forum. In 2009, Northern Minnesota looks forward to hosting the West Central Regional Forum in St. Cloud. We also enjoy collaborating with Area 36, Southern Minnesota, on the joint service workshops. — *JoAnne M. Nelson*

Mississippi: Area 37 has 24 districts servicing 235 groups. Our area assembly meets quarterly in Jackson. Our annual Area Convention is moved around the state on a scheduled rotation. Area workshops are held at various locations during the year. Every two years we have an area inventory. We have 11 standing committees and publish a quarterly newsletter. Through our Web committee, we continue to seek ways to improve our Web site. Attendance on the coast has increased since Katrina. Those groups that lost their meeting space now have permanent meeting places. We also now have several Spanish-speaking meetings. Part of the increase in attendance is due to the volunteers who came down to help after Katrina and were so charmed by our Southern Hospitality that they have become adopted Southerners. Area 37 was grateful for the opportunity to host the 63rd Southeast Conference along with our Area Convention. — *Helon Hill*

Nebraska: "Get it done now" is the attitude Area 41 carried into service in 2007. The C.P.C. committee spent two days at the Nebraska Academy of Family Physicians Conference in Omaha, where primary care physicians visited the A.A. booth and learned how to find *About AA* on the Web. A.A. volunteers organized to serve 3-hour time slots at the P.I. booth at the Nebraska State Fair. The event lasted 11 days during which 70 A.A. members logged 243 hours servicing the booth. Our members in 31 districts, including one linguistic district, work together to take several meetings a week into ten state correctional facilities. Each year we have four area assemblies and one State Reunion. For 2008 our Reunion Committee is using the theme of this year's General Service Conference, and instead of relying upon non-local speakers, this year's Reunion will offer opportunities for everyone to participate. — *Lori Geistlinger*

New Brunswick/PEI: Area 81 has 13 districts, 9 in New Brunswick, and 4 on Prince Edward Island. All functions are done in French and English and our Web site is bilingual. The area has 187 groups with 3,400 members. Meetings are held each week in both Federal and Provincial Penitentiaries. Though our two provinces are separated by a body of water (the Northumberland Strait) we are linked by the Confederation Bridge, by which you can get to P.E.I. Our two provinces are also linked by good communications, fellowship, friendship and love. For the past few years we have not had an archivist as the area has been digitizing our archives, and as of this past October we now have an Archivist chairperson, as well as a committee of three other members, and as of the 1st of April, the digitizing project is 90% completed. Throughout the year there are one, two, some three-day round-ups, as well as workshops being held by most of our districts. — *Hari Boggs*

New Hampshire: Area 43 had its beginning in 1947 when Mary W., who had learned how to stay sober with an A.A. group in New

Rochelle, New York, received the help of a nonalcoholic judge and a nonalcoholic clergy member to form the first official A.A. group, called the Manchester Original Group. Today there are 15 districts, serving 587 groups, comprising over 11,000 members. We have nine active standing committees. Our service office has three part-time paid staff members, acts as a focal point for activities, sells Conference-approved literature, and maintains a computerized database of meetings. We have an outstanding area Web site that continually updates meeting lists and other general A.A. information; it has been in service since November 1999 and has served 139,698 requests. We have four area assemblies. Two assemblies are Pre- and Post-Conference, hosted by our delegate; we typically see the greatest attendance at our Pre-Conference assembly. A third assembly is for elections in odd numbered years and an area inventory in even numbered years. — *Kevin Short*

New Jersey (Southern): Area 45 has 475 registered groups supporting 842 meetings. We have 21 active districts, structured within four sections, serving 7,401 members. A combined assembly and committee meeting rotates among the four sections quarterly. Our committees are composed of 15 standing committees and one ad-hoc committee, NERAAASA 08. Area 45 hosts its annual (44th) Convention in March, and the mini-Conference in April, to prepare the delegate for the Conference. In nonelection years the area takes its inventory. Our three intergroups join with the area for a Day of Sharing. Our Web site now posts our area newsletter, *The Fourth Dimension*. The area archives has become an awesome display of A.A. history. The C.P.C. committee frequently joins with Area 44, Northern New Jersey, to carry the message of recovery to the professionals statewide. The corrections and treatment committees host an Inter-Area Conference. Our public information committee works with their counterparts of the three intergroups. — *Fred Ellis*

New Mexico: Area 46 has 18 districts, including a state-wide bilingual district. We have about 400 registered groups across 122,000 square miles. Three area assemblies and one convention are held each year. Many of our districts are rural and we encourage all districts, large and small, to host these assemblies and conventions. The 2007 Assembly was held in Bayard, population 2,400. Our annual Area 46 convention was held this past June in Albuquerque, the state's largest city. Early in 2008, Area 46 held its first state-wide area orientation for incoming DCMs and area trusted servants. In 1880, New Mexico was still 32 years away from statehood, but our Territorial Governor concluded that we were unique. He said "every calculation based on experience elsewhere, fails in New Mexico." Fortunately, Bill and Dr. Bob were not students of Governor Wallace's philosophy. Today, about 6,000 members of the Fellowship living in Area 46 can gratefully report that the A.A. program of recovery works in New Mexico, and works well. — *Ralph Trigg*

New York (Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire): In 1999, when I moved from Area 49 to Area 48, I called the delegate to say I was moving to their area and that I had a love for service. During my first week in Area 48, the delegate came to my home, handed me an area event schedule, an area 48 meeting schedule and map of the city. This is an example of the service involvement in Area 48 and the collaboration with other state delegate areas. We are the largest geographical area of the four New York areas and have over 700 groups represented by 17 districts. As an area, we meet seven times a year and have eleven standing committees. Our Area Convention is held in the fall, except in the year we host the New York State

Convention. Over half of the New York state correctional facilities are located in Area 48. While it is a challenge to find volunteers to carry A.A.'s message inside the walls, we continue in our efforts to do so. The goal of Area 48 is to communicate with the G.S.R.s and districts to encourage members to participate in service. — *Joan Ramsey*

New York (Western): Area 50 has 400 groups, four active intergroups, 23 districts and just fewer than 6,000 members. The intergroups supply schedules and answering services within their regions. Our standing committees work together with intergroups. Archives and Grapevine travel to most area events. Committee members take part in both New York State events. This year and next Area 50 will be hosting the New York State Convention and the New York State Informational Workshop. We work with the three other delegate areas within the state on both events and take turns hosting them. This year we are also hosting the International Archives Convention/Workshop, September 11-14, 2008, in Niagara Falls, NY. We have just completed remapping our district area boundaries to better define these districts in hopes of attracting more D.C.M.s. Most of our 23 districts are dark and we are planning on incorporating more interest with workshops and days of sharing. Area 50 will also be hosting the 2010 NERAAASA in Niagara Falls. — *Cheryl Akin*

Ohio (Northwest)/Michigan (Southeast): Area 55 has over 4,500 members and 17 districts, plus 320 groups and 210 meetings. Members receive assistance from three intergroups in the area and two outside the area. We have six standing committees, a district committee chairman and an area chairman on corrections. We hold eight assemblies a year, which rotate throughout the area. The Area Archives is in its second year of a preservation project. A yearly mini-Conference is held on the first weekend of March so that the delegate can get an informed conscience of Area 55 for preparation of the upcoming General Service Conference. The other three areas in Ohio have a mini-Conference in which all areas participate. The Web site is another tool used by the area. The goal over the next two years is for the area to grow and change so we may work toward unity and understanding at all levels. Area 55 has eight living past delegates, so we are never wanting for guidance. — *John Zidarín*

Ohio (Southwest): Area 56 continues to undergo exciting development in its 30 district outlines, serving some 900+ meetings, including about 550 groups. Active districts can be found in our rural areas while our Intergroups serve the metro areas. Unity Day, in January, gathers Dayton and Cincinnati Intergroups with Area 56 members for a day of sharing on the Conference theme and presentation topics. Area 56 has close working relationships with the Intergroups, and with our past delegates. The Mac Daddy of committees this year is the group services committee, where a structure subcommittee was added to focus on our Area Blueprint. Two liaisons—one to the Hispanic community and one to Young People were added. Area 56 hosted the Ohio State Convention and our success was grounded in participation—we delegated, we relegated, we got as many people involved as possible. A mini-conference is held every March on Conference agenda items. — *Suzanne Welham*

Ontario (Western): Area 86 has over 530 groups and 24 districts with an approximate membership in the 10,000 range. We cover a large geographical area of hundreds of kilometers. Our area and district Web sites make communication accessi-

ble throughout the area. We meet at a central location for our assemblies twice a year but we rotate our Area Meetings throughout our area. Our most northern district, which used to be almost dark and forgotten, is where we held a full Area Committee workshop, akin to a Local Forum, in 2005. We now have this district fairly well represented at our Assembly and one of the members who live up there is an area officer with another chair of a subcommittee. Two of our centrally located districts held a "Unity Day" and invited our chairman of the Board, Leonard Blumenthal, as well as our neighbor to the east, Area 83. Western Ontario is a vibrant and an exciting area to be a part of. — *Martin Aire*

Oregon: Area 58 encompasses the whole state of Oregon, a small bit of Washington and a little piece of California. We have 37 districts, with two Spanish districts, and District 28 participates in Idaho Area 18 due to geographic reasons. There are 953 groups with over 18,000 members. We have just implemented a new process to get more group members involved with the Conference process. After reviewing the Conference agenda items at our February assembly, each district was assigned a Conference committee. The districts reviewed those agenda items pertinent to that committee back with their groups at the district level. Each district supplied the alternate delegate with a recap of their discussion on April 14th. The alternate delegate condensed the data and passed it along to the delegate, for something to read on the plane to New York. In January we held our 2nd annual area orientation for service committee members and D.C.M.s. Oregon hosted the Pacific Northwest Conference on June 27th - 30th. It is the oldest continuing conference in A.A., thriving since 1948. — *David Adelhart*

Puerto Rico: Area 77 has 122 groups within nine districts and over 1,600 active members. We hold monthly committee area meetings to share information from G.S.O., districts and committee chairpersons. Every year we have several activities: A.A. Convention, Pre- & Post-Conference Delegate Report Meetings, Service Seminar & Workshop, A.A. Anniversary, Organized Services Activity and our Christmas party. I am glad to announce our new book, *The History of A.A. in Puerto Rico (1950-2006)*. We have a first edition of 800 copies since the last week of January 2008. We have a Central Office with two paid employees, offering services Monday to Saturday. This office also receives all the contributions, has a permanent inventory of literature, provides follow up to Twelve Step calls and prepares all reports requested. We keep all members informed about articles related to the program, anniversaries and group meetings in a monthly bulletin called "El Despertar" (The Awakening). — *Antonio Rodríguez*

Québec (Northwest): We have a splendid area, which offers a multitude of service to the alcoholic who still suffers. Our area is made up of six service committees and four working groups. We are divided into 24 districts. During the year we have six meetings, which we call the regional committee, composed of the 24 D.C.M.s and six chairpersons of committee, as well as the six members of the office, the secretary, the treasurer, the alternate delegate and the delegate. We also have two general assemblies, where G.S.R.s are invited to take part, and an assembly of welcome, which is held for all the servants and those interested in the services. Our area is also made up of approximately 390 groups and approximately 6,000 members. Our contributions to the G.S.O. last year showed that the members of Area 90 care for the alcoholic who still suffers no matter where he is on the planet. Our common welfare comes first,

personal recovery depends on A.A. unity. On this Tradition the work of Area 90 members is based. — *Sylvain LeLièvre*

Québec (Southwest): There are four areas in the mostly French Province of Québec. Among them, Area 87 is the only one bilingual, offering a full range of A.A. services in English. There are approximately 550 registered groups within our 29 districts; 21 French, 7 English and 1 Hispanic. There is one French Sign Language group. The 50-mile radius of our geographical territory allows us to organize each year 4 area assemblies and 6 area committee meetings at which we provide simultaneous translation. Significant efforts have been put into our archives and into developing a structure based on the "group conscience principle" for our Web site work group. We participate in Québec's provincial activities, such as the provincial Web site committee (aa-quebec.org) and the provincial assembly. We also participate, with Québec's three other areas, in the French magazine *La Vigne A.A.* It would be vain to pretend that at Area 87 we have attained a level of Communication and Participation such that we have achieved perfect Unity and Self-support, but we certainly do our best. — *Ginette Williams*

Rhode Island: Area 61 has around 500 meetings, with approximately 5,300 members. They are represented by seven geographical and one linguistic district. Our area hosts three business assemblies and one pre-Conference assembly a year. We are beginning to see an increase in attendance at our district meetings and assemblies, which may be due to our Joy of Service meetings. On months that do not have an assembly, a district, picked by lot, hosts the area committee at a "regular" A.A. meeting in that district. Here the area committees get to present information to members who might not otherwise be exposed to service and its functions. We also have an ad hoc committee to improve relations between our area assembly, central office, and intergroup. We have been talking to groups about "the value of a dollar," and the members are slowly beginning to respond with more than a dollar in the basket, allowing the groups to increase their contributions to all the service entities. — *Al Davenport*

South Carolina: Area 62 has around 320 registered groups divided into 23 districts. Recent highlights include group contributions to G.S.O. in 2006 from over 55% of the groups registered; hits to www.area62.org in 2007 at over 1.8 million from at least 16 countries; and the creation of an area archivist as a rotating position. Our districts rotate hosting our two-day assemblies, held three times a year in Columbia, our capital. After meetings of our eleven service committees; sharing sessions for our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s; and a meeting of our Service Committee chairpersons to coordinate their work with each other, we all convene as an assembly that afternoon to hear committee reports and hold either a pre-Conference report or a workshop. All of our area assembly meetings are open to all A.A.s, and we encourage our service leaders to bring A.A. visitors to observe. We build plenty of free time into the agenda for fellowship. — *Robert Hill*

South Dakota: Area 63 has 181 registered groups in 15 districts. Ethnically, our groups are generally white and English-speaking, with a substantial Native American component. Area 63 conducts two conferences and two service workshops annually. Conferences are hosted by district committees; service workshops are centrally located. Area 63 uses a committee service structure composed of nine committees. Items of new business are recommended at our workshops, taken back to our groups

for their conscience and are submitted for a final vote at the following conference. Voting members include G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area officers and committee chairs, though all members are encouraged to participate. Area 63's biggest challenges are carrying our message to remote communities and maintaining an active district service structure in rural areas. We have a long-standing tradition of traveling long distances to support neighboring groups. Road trips of 200 miles or more are commonplace. — *John Teupel*

Tennessee: Area 64 consists of approximately 527 groups and 41 districts; two districts are Spanish-speaking. We meet from the mountains of East Tennessee to the deltas of the Mississippi river. We are mainly rural groups spread out through the countryside. We hold four assemblies and one convention per year. We rotate our assemblies and convention, except for our voting assembly, which is held in the center of our area. G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area officers, area standing committee chairs and past delegates make up our assemblies. The entire above mentioned have a voice and a vote. Most are reimbursed for their travel and lodging expenses, except for the past delegates. We have eleven past delegates who share their extensive experience, strength, and hope. We have six service standing committees which meet two times at every assembly. Area 64—Archives is extensive and has its own Web site, www.area64tnarchives.org. Our area will be hosting the Southeast Regional Forum in Knoxville, Tennessee, November 21-23. — *John Antol*

Texas (Northwest): Area 66, Northwest Texas, covers almost 500 miles from the most northern point to the most southern point; almost 170 miles from east to west, giving us over 95,000 square miles. We have 11 districts, with 8 of them very active. Out of these 8, 3 are Spanish-speaking. These districts currently serve 210 groups. Our area will be hosting the Texas State Convention this year in Odessa. We are now holding three assemblies and one or two workshops every year, hosted by different districts. As in a lot of areas, these great distances can make it tough on our 11 standing committees, but we continue to strive to make all of A.A.'s resources available to the groups. I am blessed by the fact that Area 66 has a strong passion and history of service. I hope to continue on this path. — *Leon Roberts*

Texas (Southwest): Area 68 has 34 districts, 7 of those being Spanish-speaking. Our area meets quarterly for a two-day weekend at locations rotated among districts. We provide translation equipment for our Spanish-speaking members and our area minutes, agendas, flyers, and area newsletter are translated into Spanish. An annual Correctional Facility Committee Conference is held to help promote understanding and cooperation. We held our first annual Public Information/Cooperation With Professional Community Conference in August 2007 with a great turnout. Our area formed ad-hoc committees to work with our dark districts to try to start them back into service and also with our Archives Committee to help develop a better system for Archives. We are blessed with participation from past delegates at our area meetings. We also look forward to welcoming everyone to San Antonio for the 2010 International. — *Steve Yocum*

Vermont: Area 70, the Green Mountain State, and the birthplace of Bill W. and Dr. Bob, has 11 districts, with approximately 260 groups and an estimated 4,784 members. Our area assemblies meet quarterly and are held throughout the state based on district bid submissions. The area committee meets seven times a year at a central location. We have a pre-Conference sharing meeting in April to review the Conference agenda. G.S.R.s and

D.C.M.s are encouraged to attend as part of their service commitment. Our goal is to get a good sense of the area conscience for the delegate to take to the Conference in April. Area 70 has recently added the position of registrar to its other standing committees. The archives committee, which was a nonrotating position, is now a five-year term. Our biggest challenge as an area is to increase communication and participation. Area 70 continues to seek better ways to increase enthusiasm, and participation at group, district, and area levels. — *Andrew Coyne*

Washington State East: Area 92 reaches from the Cascade Mountains to the Rockies, from British Columbia to Oregon. We have 488 groups in 24 districts, 3 of which are non-geographic Spanish-speaking linguistic districts. This year we hosted the Pacific Regional Forum and are bidding for the 2011 Extra Pacific Regional Forum. We share participation with Oregon Area 58 in the Pacific Northwest Conference, which first convened in 1948. Our Translation committee tries to provide support to our Spanish-speaking members with devoted but limited bilingual assistance. Our Corrections committee, through a local concern, has forwarded a request for consideration to this Conference. As an area that spans the U.S./Canada border we continue to be faced with issues involving active participation of our Washington State districts with our District 1 in South Eastern British Columbia. The difficulty in resolving Canadian border crossing issues remains a test to our commitment to area unity. — *Rad Miller*

Wisconsin (Northern)/Upper Peninsula Michigan: Area 74 has 24 districts—17 in Northern Wisconsin, 7 in the Upper Peninsula of Michigan—and over 600 groups. Area assemblies are in the spring and fall at a central location while our two area conferences rotate and are hosted by districts. Prior to our area assemblies we hold an orientation, led by a past delegate, for any new G.S.R. or D.C.M. or anyone else who would like a refresher. We also hold a rotating delegate's workshop in early March, to help us start to gather an informed group conscience, which then can be carried to our Conference. We are reevaluating our meeting structure. We have held many workshops. Reaching the still-suffering alcoholic is still at the center of all our efforts. Area 74 and Area 75, southern Wisconsin, hold an annual Corrections Conference. With all this effort there have been times of trouble; our area, just like our recovery, is always trudging. By God's grace and the nudge by our elder statesmen, we are encouraged to grow past personalities, egos, self-centeredness and pain to become a more unified area. — *Dodie Ash*

Wyoming: In Area 76 we worked diligently to get the correct names and addresses of all the trusted servants in Wyoming. We then concentrated on sharing as much information as anyone could stand. This included agenda items, flyers for Conventions, Conferences and Assembly, information of committees, service structures and self-support. Aggressively opening lines of communication seems to make a difference. We hope that the upcoming year will find the Area more involved in district functions. Inspired by others' experiences, I hope to visit all districts at least a couple of times. In an area of 97,000 square miles, nine months of potentially horrible weather and three months of construction, this will be quite a challenge! But the enthusiasm of gratitude in action is most contagious! Area 76 has two assemblies and two conventions each year, many camp-outs, pot-lucks, picnics, workshops, and meetings of Alcoholics Anonymous in every part of the state, from towns you've heard of like Cheyenne, to the towns I haven't heard of—like Lyman. We currently have no dark districts, and we're hoping we can keep it that way. — *Brooke Collins*

Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the *Final Report*." All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the General Service Conference Evaluation Form, and suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference consider adding a category evaluating the individual Conference members' committee experience and a category to allow Conference members to rate their overall Conference experience, to the Evaluation Form.

ARCHIVES¹

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Archives Workbook, and accepted the revisions and proposed format changes, including the new language intended to foster awareness of copyright issues, with minor edits.
- The committee requested that the G.S.O. Archives' "Statements of Policy" related to accessing the Archives, as well as the "Sound and Video Access Policies," be added to the next printing of the Archives Workbook.
- The committee discussed various ideas for creatively making A.A.'s archives and history more readily available to the Fellowship in the future; these included:
 - Exploring ways to convey the experience of visiting G.S.O. and the Archives, for those who have not yet visited New York.
 - Continuing the development (currently in progress) of an extensive, illustrated timeline of A.A.'s history, for the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - Placing the Archives' policies in a more prominent area of the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

- Clarifying those services and materials that the Archives Department makes available to A.A. members and others.

- Including frequently asked questions and answers about A.A.'s archives and history to the Archives portal of G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.

- Welcoming sharing and experience from Area and District Archives Committees for inclusion in the workbook and *Markings: Your Archives Interchange*.

- Submitting insightful articles to *Box 4-5-9*, or the A.A. Grapevine, that express the significance of archives and history to a wider audience.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the video segments directed to professionals in the employment/human relations field to be streamed on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site. The committee made suggestions to the Publications department for changes to the video segment and requested that a revised draft be brought back to the 2009 Conference Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community for review. (Changes not to exceed \$10,000.00)
- The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities discuss further possible projects directed toward legal/criminal justice system professionals.

CORRECTIONS

- The committee reviewed the contents of the Corrections Kit and Workbook and made the following suggestions:
 - That a copy of the annual corrections issue of the Grapevine and La Vina magazines be made available in the Kits, along with a brief list of suggestions about how the magazines may be useful for carrying the message behind the walls. The list of suggestions could include, but is not limited to: mention of the availability of boxes of back issues for a discounted



¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

price with the appropriate information about contacting the Grapevine for ordering; the fact that only the July issue is available in stitched version, and that many facilities may not accept issues with staples; and mention of the option for local service opportunities for "stitching parties" to increase the chance of the magazines being allowed into facilities.

- That the Grapevine and La Vina magazines be added to the list of Kit Contents, with a mention of the "timelessness" of issues.
- That in future reprints of the Corrections Workbook, add the above suggestions for use of the magazines to the section on "Ideas to Stimulate Corrections Twelfth Step Work Within A.A." (see pages 6 & 7 of the 2008 Workbook)
- That a copy of the D.V.D. "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" be included in the Corrections Kit.
- The committee reviewed the service piece "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" and made the following suggestions:
 - That when the service piece "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" (CF-36) is updated, the "A.A. Correctional Facility Group Information Change Form" and the "Suggestions for Leading Beginners Meetings" be added.
 - That the list of contents of the service material included in, "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook," (CF-36) along with the list of materials included in the package sent with the Handbook, and a cover page explaining the development, current use, and possible use of the handbook, be included in the section of the Corrections Kit called "Other."
- That the trustees' Committee on Corrections consider development of a CD which would contain the contents of "Corrections A.A. Group Handbook" (CF-36) in English, Spanish and French, along with other materials mentioned above—the list of materials included in the package sent with the Handbook and a cover page explaining the development, current use, and possible use of the handbook—to be sent to A.A. members upon request, for reproduction by correctional facilities A.A. meetings and groups.

FINANCE

- The committee discussed a request that a Finance Kit be developed to assist group, intergroup/central offices, district and area service workers in carrying the message of our shared responsibility for the Seventh Tradition. Recognizing the need for increased awareness, the committee suggested that A.A.W.S. consider:
 - Updating/reformatting the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to include the Finance Guidelines (MG-15).
 - Adding the information that is included in the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to the G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site.
 - That the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) be sent to incoming area treasurers.
 - Add the Self-Support Packet (FV-19) to the Conference-approved Literature Catalog.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee reviewed the contents of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook and agreed that no changes were needed at this time.

• The committee discussed the staff report addressing the 2007 Additional Consideration to "explore less expensive formats for the production of the A.A. Grapevine Workbook" and requested that the Grapevine:

- Produce a portable GvR (Grapevine Representative) Handbook similar to the recently revised RLV (La Viña Representative) Handbook in size and format for ease of use by the GvR network and for cost containment.
- Update and revise the A.A. Grapevine History booklet.
- Continue to offer the current A.A. Grapevine Workbook as a free download at the Grapevine Web site.
- The committee agreed to forward to the A.A. Grapevine Board the suggestion that the A.A. Grapevine produce in the year 2009, or later, two CDs of stories from La Viña on Traditions One—Twelve.
- The committee reconsidered the 2007 General Service Conference Committee Advisory Action recommending that "the Grapevine and La Viña include a section on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism, with an appropriate disclaimer" and took no action.
- The committee discussed the Grapevine's legacy of self-support and encouraged the A.A. Grapevine, Inc. to uphold that legacy.
- To increase use of the Grapevine and La Vina and awareness of their roles in A.A. today, the committee made several suggestions, including the following:
 - That delegates challenge each of their areas to increase circulation of the Grapevine by at least 100 subscriptions and circulation of La Viña by as much as possible.
 - That groups buy bulk subscriptions or 50-Packs of back issues for distribution in treatment facilities, correctional facilities, and other institutions.
 - That districts buy subscriptions for local libraries.
 - That GvR/RLVs use laptops to take subscriptions at A.A. events.
 - That delegates and Area Grapevine/La Viña chairs exchange information about successful efforts to increase awareness of A.A.'s magazines.
 - That groups put copies of the magazines in grocery stores, laundromats, and other public places where they might help alcoholics,
 - That groups hold Grapevine or La Viña meetings.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS¹

- The committee discussed ways to encourage interest in Regional and Local Forums and suggested:
 - That to increase local participation, areas where a Regional Forum is scheduled begin early in the year asking districts to consider not scheduling district functions that would conflict with the Forum dates.
 - That Local Forums be held in conjunction with State Conventions, and other nonservice A.A. events.
 - That information about Local Forums be mailed to all delegates again this year.

¹Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.



- That information about Local Forums be communicated to intergroups and central offices.
- That areas consider extending one day service events into two day events with the inclusion of a Local Forum.

LITERATURE

- The committee reviewed the selected unedited stories and the draft introduction for the revised pamphlet "A.A. for the Native North American," and suggested some changes. The committee looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised pamphlet—taking into consideration the committee's suggestions—at the 2009 Conference Literature Committee meeting.
- The committee accepted the progress report from the Publications Department on the revision of the pamphlet "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs," and looks forward to reviewing a draft of the revised "The A.A. Member—Medications and Other Drugs" at the 2009 Conference Literature Committee meeting.
- The committee considered a request to reinstate the pamphlet "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" and took no action.
- The committee reviewed the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Literature and made changes to clarify that the scope of the committee pertains to "recovery" literature.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee considered a proposal that the current secondary Conference Archives Committee be established as a standing Conference Committee and took no action.
- The committee noted that the General Service Board, in response to an additional consideration from the 2007 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions, will forward a summary of their discussion of the inventory questions which pertain to regional composition and structure to the 2009 Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee suggested that the proposed 2009 television public service announcement be at least partially directed to older alcoholics, and that previously shot P.S.A. footage be used wherever possible (**Note:** The recommendation to produce a television public service announcement in 2009 failed on the Conference floor).
- The committee reviewed the 2007 Annual Report from the trustees' Committee on Public Information regarding G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site and noted the detailed information provided and the thoughtful consideration given to all items involving the Web site.
- The committee reviewed information on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the 2007 television public service announcement "A Force of Nature."
- The committee reviewed the trustees' Public Information Committee's Progress Report on the A.A. Videos for Young People Project, and expressed continued enthusiasm for the project.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the new A.A. Guidelines on the Internet be included in the P.I. Kit.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered a suggestion to place a glossary of terms used in *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* after the text of *The A.A. Service Manual* and directly preceding the index and took no action.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed a proposal that the pamphlet, "Bridging the Gap" (BTG), be rewritten to reflect that the BTG program is used in both Treatment Facilities and Corrections service work and took no action.
- The committee discussed the possible development of Conference-approved literature and/or service material to stimulate A.A. members' interest in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work and took no action. The committee agreed that current

Conference-approved literature and service material serves the needs of those involved in Treatment Facilities Twelfth Step work.

- The committee reviewed the Treatment Facilities Kit and Workbook and requested that the following pamphlets be included in the Treatment Facilities Kit: "This is A.A." (P-1), "Message to Teenagers" (F-9), "The A.A. Group" (P-16), and "Question and Answers on Sponsorship" (P-15).

- In addition, the committee discussed the use of the tab labeled, "Local Experience" in the Treatment Facilities Kit. After lengthy sharing, the committee agreed that the appropriate use of the tab is best determined locally.

- The committee discussed the need for more input from the Fellowship in the area of carrying out our Twelfth Step responsibility and agreed that Treatment Facilities' Twelfth Step work is changing. Based on a lack of agenda items, the committee discussed the possibility of merging with another Conference committee, and concluded that the Conference Committee on Treatment Facilities is still viable.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes and approved, as eligible for election, all Class B trustee candidates for the West Central and Western Canada Regions.

- The committee discussed a request to revisit the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action to consider all eligible Class A and Class B trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board and took no action.

- The committee took no action on the recommendation from the General Service Board that the following language from paragraph three, page 4 of the Bylaws be amended so that it applies only to **Class B regional trustees**:

"...However, when the vacancy being filled is that of a Class B **regional** trustee, the maximum term of service of such successor member trustee shall be limited to that number of one-year terms which will result in the term of service of the successor member trustee ending at the same time as the term of the replaced member trustee would have ended if no vacancy had occurred and the replaced member trustee had served four consecutive one-year terms."

- The committee took no action on the recommendation from the General Service Board that the following language from paragraph two, page 4 of the General Service Bylaws be amended so that it applies to **Class B regional trustees**:

"In the event that any member trustee shall resign, die, retire, be removed, become disqualified, or shall be otherwise unable to serve, the trustees may, at any regular or special meeting of the Board of Trustees, elect a new member trustee to fill such vacancy, or, alternatively, permit such a vacancy to continue until the next annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board. A third alternative, with respect to Class B **regional** member trustee vacancies occasioned by resignation, death, retirement, removal or disqualification, is to permit the vacancy to remain unfilled for the remainder of the four-year commitment, and to allow regional coverage to be provided by the trustee-at-large or the regional trustee from an adjacent region, unless a region decides that a new regional member trustee should be elected."

- In response to a recommendation from an area steering committee, the committee asked the trustees' Committee on Nominating to:

- amend the General Service Board Bylaws so that a Class B regional trustee elected to a partial term as the result of a resignation, death, retirement, removal or disqualification of a Class B regional trustee may stand for an additional full term of service subsequent to filling the term of service of the replaced member trustee.

- consider comparable amendments to the General Service Board Bylaws regarding an unexpected vacancy of a Class B trustee-at-large.

- forward the amended General Service Board Bylaws to the 2009 Conference Committee on Trustees for approval.

RECOMMENDATIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

LITERATURE

- The committee recommended that the pamphlet "44 Questions" be retitled "Questions and Answers about the A.A. Program of Recovery from Alcoholism."

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee recommended that a new television public service announcement be developed for review by the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information, at a cost not to exceed \$45,000, and that no current television public service announcements be retired at this time.

- The committee recommended that the following section on posthumous anonymity be included in the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" on page 9, before the Anonymity at the media level section:

Posthumous anonymity

Q. In general, what is the feeling of the Fellowship in regards to posthumous anonymity?

A. In 1988 the General Service Conference recommended that: The 1971 Conference Advisory Action be reaffirmed: "A.A. members generally think it unwise to break the anonymity of a member even after his death, but in each situation the final decision must rest with the family."

Q. Why do obituaries sometimes state that the deceased was a member of Alcoholics Anonymous?

A. There are many reasons why this could occur. Family members and funeral directors sometimes write the obituaries and are not aware of A.A.'s Traditions. On the other hand, the deceased person's A.A. membership may have been revealed due to a conscious decision made beforehand by the A.A. member, or it may have been a conscious decision made by the family.

A.A. members may wish to make their personal wishes on this matter known to their families ahead of time.

Q. What about posthumous anonymity in regard to our co-founders?

A. Co-founder Bill W.'s obituary, with photography, appeared on the front page of the *New York Times* on January 26, 1971. Following are excerpts from the obituary:

Mr. Wilson gave permission to break his A.A. anonymity upon his death in a signed statement in 1966. The role of Dr. Robert Holbrook Smith as the other founder of the worldwide fellowship was disclosed publicly when the Akron, Ohio, surgeon died of cancer in 1950 after 15 years of uninterrupted sobriety.

In fathering the doctrine that members should not reveal their A.A. affiliation at the public level, Bill W. had explained that anonymity isn't just something to save us from alcoholic shame and stigma; its deeper purpose is to keep those fool egos of ours from running hog wild after money and fame at A.A.'s expense.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee recommended that an anonymity protected version of the *Final Report* of the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous be posted on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web site to begin with the 2008 *Final Report*. This version will not include names and also will not include the final three (3) sections; Conference Committees, Trustees Committees, and Conference members.

TRUSTEES

- The committee recommended that, in order to further clarify the language regarding the length of service of the general manager, G.S.O., the trustees' Committee on Nominating:

- a) Consider replacing paragraph three of Nominating Procedure No. 9 approved by the General Service Board on February 4, 2008 which reads:

"The general manager serves at the pleasure of the Board without an employment contract and as an at-will employee. While there is no term of office as such, most recently, applicants have been asked for a commitment of five to seven years. It has been generally recognized that it is in the best interest of the Board and the individual to agree on the probable length of service in this position."

with the following language:

"The general manager serves at the pleasure of the Board without an employment contract and as an at-will employee. While there is no term of office as such, it is in the best interest of the Board and the individual to agree on a maximum length of employment for this position at the time of hire."

- b) Forward a report on their deliberations to the 2009 Conference Committee on Trustees.

The 58th General Service Conference now holds the record as the longest Conference in its 58 years. Scheduled to adjourn at 5:00 p.m. Friday afternoon it did not end until 12:40 a.m. Saturday morning. A lot of theatre and baseball tickets were put on hold — permanently.

FLOOR ACTIONS THAT DID NOT RESULT IN A CONFERENCE ADVISORY ACTION

- To amend the 1959 Conference Advisory Action to display the Puerto Rican Flag along with the United States and Canadian Flags, to also include the British, Bahamian, and Dutch Flags, which are presented at the General Service Conference as part of Area 15. **(Not Approved)**
- That the trustees' Conference Committee develop policies and process for the selection of Conference agenda items, the selection of background material for these items, and present these to the 2009 Conference for review. **(Not Approved)**
- Request that the trustees' Committee on Nominating and the Conference Trustees Committee replace the word "good" with "geographical" preceding Cross Section in Nominating Procedure #9. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Background material for the Conference Agenda Committee shall include a list of proposed agenda items that were tabled or upon which no action was taken and an explanation of why each proposal was tabled or no action was taken. **(Not Approved)**
- To have the Conference revisit the 2007 General Service Conference Advisory Action to consider all eligible Class A and Class B trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- To consider only all eligible Class A trustees when selecting the chairperson of the General Service Board. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That the secondary Conference Committee on Archives be established as a standing Conference Committee. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That all pending and future Conference-approved audio visual projects, i.e. P.S.A.s, informational videos, etc., include the end line of: "Look us up. Check your phone book, newspaper or aa.org." **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That item F of the Public Information's Committee agenda, regarding a section on posthumous anonymity being added to "Understanding Anonymity," be returned to the trustees' Committee on Public Information for consideration at the General Service Conference in 2009. **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- Consider a request to change the title of the pamphlet "44 Questions" to "Frequently Asked Questions About A.A." **(Recommended to Committee)**
- Reinstate the pamphlet "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic." **(Conference voted not to consider)**
- That the trustees' Committee on Literature develop a pamphlet titled "A.A. for the First Nation" with first nation stories included. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- The Conference proposes that the trustees' Committee on Public Information conduct an assessment of how A.A. could best utilize new media platforms for Public Information purposes and report its findings to the 2009 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Recommended to Committee)**
- That the Grapevine and La Viña discontinue the Alcoholism at Large Pages on the medical, legal and social aspects of alcoholism. **(Not Approved)**

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL POSITION
December 31, 2007 (with comparative totals for 2006)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Consolidated 2007	Consolidated 2006
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund				
ASSETS								
Cash	\$ 1,381,846	\$ 878,542		\$ 839	\$ 823,560	\$ 287,771	\$ 3,372,558	\$ 4,264,108
Accounts and interest receivable		138,486			282,961	95,123	516,570	471,799
Intercompany balances	(1,564,506)	(1,647,400)			\$ 1,662,668	1,549,238	-	-
Inventories								
Books, pamphlets, etc.					1,608,707	264,257	1,872,964	2,129,200
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.					323,556	12,412	335,968	361,391
Investments - at fair value (Note 2)		11,540,222		499,535			12,039,757	9,453,464
Property and Equipment	26,018							
(net of accumulated depreciation - 2007 - \$3,8745,752; 2006 - \$3,537,039) (Note 2)	213,655		\$ 575,108		295,135	19,336	889,579	924,953
Deferred charges and deposits					62,298	47,766	136,092	166,393
Prepaid conventions - 2010/2015/2020							213,655	174,094
Total Assets	<u>57,013</u>	<u>10,909,850</u>	<u>575,108</u>	<u>500,374</u>	<u>5,058,885</u>	<u>2,275,913</u>	<u>19,377,143</u>	<u>17,945,402</u>
LIABILITIES								
Accounts payable					\$ 472,776	\$ 110,725	\$ 583,501	\$ 879,824
Accrued royalties					12,337		12,337	43,210
Deferred income - Orders and subscriptions					49,286	1,735,414	1,784,700	1,773,847
Accrued postretirement health benefits				\$ 4,122,317			4,122,317	4,028,210
Accrued pension benefits		\$ 4,548,581					4,548,581	1,692,402
Total Liabilities		<u>4,548,581</u>		<u>4,122,317</u>	<u>534,399</u>	<u>1,846,139</u>	<u>11,051,436</u>	<u>8,417,493</u>
Net Assets (Exhibit B)	<u>57,013</u>	<u>6,361,269</u>	<u>575,108</u>	<u>(3,621,943)</u>	<u>4,524,486</u>	<u>429,774</u>	<u>8,325,707</u>	<u>9,527,909</u>
Total Liabilities and Net Assets	<u>57,013</u>	<u>10,909,850</u>	<u>575,108</u>	<u>500,374</u>	<u>5,058,885</u>	<u>2,275,913</u>	<u>19,377,143</u>	<u>17,945,402</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.**

CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF ACTIVITY

Year Ended December 31, 2007 (with comparative totals for 2006)

	General Service Board of A.A.				A.A. Grapevine, Inc.			
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund	Postretirement Medical Fund	A.A. World Services, Inc.	English	Spanish Magazine	Consolidated 2007
INCOME AND COST OF LITERATURE								
Gross Sales					\$ 12,730,033	\$ 2,831,802	\$ 146,672	\$ 15,708,507
Less: Discounts					336,197	111,327	-	447,524
Net Sales					12,393,836	2,720,475	146,672	15,260,983
Cost of Literature Distributed					(3,662,533)	(427,642)	(42,369)	(4,132,544)
Printing					(67,898)	-	-	(67,898)
Royalties on books					(1,616,741)	(625,438)	(36,522)	(2,278,701)
Direct shipping and warehousing					7,046,664	1,667,395	67,781	8,781,840
Gross Profit from Literature					5,045	72,779	-	853,330
CONTRIBUTIONS	\$ 6,526,002	\$ 769,281		\$ 1,379	7,051,709	1,740,174	67,781	14,959,829
INVESTMENT INCOME (Note 2)	4,846							
Total Income	6,530,848	769,281		1,379				
FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES (Exhibit C)								
Program	5,363,327				2,217,369	1,127,035	134,821	8,842,552
Supporting services	3,164,753	(270,788)	\$ 189,508	(176,796)	1,818,531	638,186	-	5,363,394
Total Expenses	8,528,080	(270,788)	189,508	(176,796)	4,035,900	1,765,221	134,221	14,205,946
EXCESS OF INCOME (EXPENSE) FOR YEAR	(1,997,232)	1,040,069	(189,508)	178,175	3,015,809	(25,047)	(67,040)	1,955,226
Recognition of pension liability under SFAS 158 (Note 3)	-	(3,157,428)	-	-	-	-	-	(3,157,428)
INTERCOMPANY AND INTERFUND TRANSFERS								
GSB La Viña support	(67,040)	-	-	-	-	-	67,040	-
Other Transfer	2,064,272	133,500	81,655	-	(2,279,427)	-	-	-
CHANGE IN NET ASSETS FOR YEAR	-	(1,983,859)	(107,853)	178,175	736,382	(25,047)	-	(1,202,202)
NET ASSETS								
Beginning of year	57,013	8,345,128	682,961	(3,800,118)	3,788,104	454,821	-	9,527,909
NET ASSETS								
End of year (Exhibit A)	57,013	6,361,269	575,108	(3,621,943)	4,524,486	429,774	-	8,325,707

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
CONSOLIDATED STATEMENT OF FUNCTIONAL EXPENSES

Year Ended December 31, 2007 (with comparative totals for 2006)

	Group Services	Fellowship Services	General Service Conference	World Service Meeting	Regional Forums	Publishing	Grapevine	La Viña	Supporting Services	2007 Total	2006 Total
OPERATING EXPENSES											
Salaries	\$ 751,141	\$ 888,859	\$ 159,671		\$ 159,197	\$ 1,129,574	\$ 442,744	\$ 85,403	\$ 2,299,781	\$ 5,916,370	\$ 5,719,188
Payroll taxes	57,552	62,926	10,148		11,602	80,473	39,397	3,264	168,840	434,202	426,882
Health and group insurance	129,072	117,048	15,633		15,633	201,284	77,737		433,309	989,716	905,153
Retirement expense - funding	200,156	218,166	35,399		40,474	284,616	59,434		519,110	1,357,355	984,557
Other program printing	289,786	57,541	65,821		34,363	2,591			5,914	456,016	411,852
Mailing labor	117,941	7,048	1,646		1,439					128,074	133,215
Postage and express	204,135	104,107	45,687		22,312	12,918	6,583	496	39,280	435,518	473,045
Writers fees	18,782	108,022	12,273		775	63,488			650	203,990	208,460
Foreign literature assistance		124,454								124,454	271,594
Selling expenses	526					123,905	135,593	11,446	20,548	292,018	330,514
Professional fees		12,180						1,819	272,089	286,088	344,863
Contracted services	27,849	217,697	8,513		21,888	75,169	171,198	10,190	517,111	1,049,615	1,059,032
Occupancy	96,659	125,158	9,707		10,609	172,913	77,121		343,606	835,773	831,674
Telephone	15,740	18,574	2,875		1,793	15,558	18,518		49,076	122,134	112,378
Equipment maintenance	736	690	92		93	6,199			115,567	123,377	113,213
Furniture and equipment depreciation	20,365	19,071	2,546		2,731	30,092		980	62,004	137,789	96,283
Stationery and office supplies	81,472	7,269	6,780		1,959	989	49,355		74,074	221,898	235,258
Office service and expense	9,105	15,729	21,968		2,945	12,214	49,355	333	186,279	297,928	333,356
Travel, meals and accommodations	2,769	99,283	516,294		87,567	5,386		20,519	484,742	1,216,560	1,328,582
Bad debts			(194,714)					371	29,490	(29,861)	(31,134)
Delegate fees										(194,714)	(306,644)
Total Operating Expenses	2,023,786	2,203,822	720,339		415,380	2,217,369	1,127,035	134,821	5,621,470	14,464,022	14,043,589
Postretirement health benefits									(176,796)	(176,796)	(90,422)
Retirement expense adjustment									(270,788)	(270,788)	(757,287)
Capital projects depreciation									189,508	189,508	149,456
Total Expenses	2,023,786	2,203,822	720,339		415,380	2,217,369	1,127,035	134,821	5,363,394	14,205,946	13,345,336
Allocation of supporting services to activities	1,096,799	1,194,370	390,391		225,117	1,818,531	638,186	-	(5,363,394)	-	-
Total Allocated Expenses	3,120,585	3,398,192	1,110,730		640,497	4,035,900	1,765,221	134,821	-	14,205,946	13,345,336
Services	\$3,120,585	\$3,398,192	\$1,110,730	\$ -	\$640,497	\$4,035,900	\$1,765,221	\$134,821		\$8,270,004	\$7,573,759
Publishing	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-		4,035,900	4,022,277
Grapevine	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-		1,900,042	1,749,300
COMPARATIVE TOTALS - 2006	\$2,706,370	\$3,171,395	\$998,776	\$127,451	\$569,767	\$4,022,277	\$1,636,049	\$113,251	\$13,345,336	\$13,345,336	\$13,345,336

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

**The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
 Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
 Consolidated Statement of Cash Flows
 Year Ended December 31, 2007
 (with comparative totals for 2006)**

CASH FLOWS PROVIDED (USED)

	<u>2007</u>	<u>2006</u>
FROM OPERATING ACTIVITIES:		
Change in net assets for year (Exhibit B)	\$ (1,202,202)	\$ 1,614,493
Realized and change in unrealized gains on investments	(336,874)	9,174
Amortization of bond premiums	4,470	1,310
Depreciation	327,297	245,739
Changes in assets and liabilities:		
Accounts receivable	(44,771)	157,435
Inventories	281,659	(122,368)
Deferred charges and other assets	(9,260)	(59,255)
Accounts and accruals payable	(327,196)	(222,037)
Deferred income	10,853	161,219
Postretirement health benefits obligation	94,107	135,570
Accrued pension benefits	2,856,179	(726,826)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided</u> <u>By Operating Activities</u>	<u>1,654,262</u>	<u>1,194,454</u>
FROM INVESTING ACTIVITIES:		
Purchases of property and equipment	(291,923)	(520,527)
Proceeds from sales of investments	3,481,342	4,957,811
Purchases of investments	(5,735,231)	(4,438,902)
<u>Net Cash Flows Provided (used)</u> <u>By Investing Activities</u>	<u>(2,545,812)</u>	<u>(1,618)</u>
Net Increase (Decrease) in Cash	(891,550)	1,192,836
Cash, beginning of year	<u>4,264,108</u>	<u>3,071,272</u>
Cash, end of year	<u><u>3,372,558</u></u>	<u><u>4,264,108</u></u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITORS' OPINION

April 7, 2008

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10015
Members of the Board:

We have audited the accompanying consolidated statement of financial position of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC., ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC., and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. as of December 31, 2007 and the related consolidated statements of activities, functional expenses and cash flows for the year then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the Organizations' management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audit.

We conducted our audit in accordance with auditing standards generally accepted in the United States of America. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audit provides a reasonable basis for our opinion. The prior year summarized comparative information has been derived from the Organization's December 31, 2006 consolidated financial statements, and in our report dated April 5, 2007, we expressed an unqualified opinion on those financial statements.

In our opinion, the consolidated financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the financial position of the three Corporations named above as of December 31, 2007 and the changes in their net assets and their cash flows for the year then ended in conformity with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America.

Respectfully submitted,
Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants
New York, N.Y.

THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC. NOTES TO CONSOLIDATED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS DECEMBER 31, 2007

Note 1 Organization: The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., ("G.S.B.") and its affiliates A.A. World Services, Inc. ("A.A.W.S.") and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. ("A.A.G.V.") are not-for-profit corporations organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. Groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world, and publishing books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to that purpose. The trustees of G.S.B. are members ex officio of A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V., and as such, elect their boards of directors. As members, they also have the sole right to amend the A.A.W.S. and A.A.G.V. by-laws, and approve their budgets.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in five separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND - This fund was established in 1954 for the purpose of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which

during 1977, was re-defined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the A.A. General Service Board. The committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That advisory action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held for unfulfilled subscriptions reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees upon recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND - This fund accounts for the cost of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects, and records annual depreciation on such assets.

The CONVENTION FUND - A separate fund established to record the direct income and expenses of international A.A. conventions held every five years. These events are separate from the regular operations of the General Service Office, but the General Fund receives any excess of income, or pays any excess of expense, resulting from the activity.

From a historical perspective, the net direct result of all conventions held to date is approximately an excess of income of \$716,000, and presently resides with all other income not required for working capital in the Reserve Fund.

The POSTRETIREMENT MEDICAL FUND - A fund established in 2006 with the goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the liability for postretirement health benefits by the end of ten years.

The Postretirement health benefits plan is described in more detail in Note 5.

The GENERAL FUND - This fund is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purpose for which the Corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

All net assets of the Corporations are free of donor restrictions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies: The Corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. The Organizations do not receive or solicit pledges, so contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Contributions received from A.A. groups and members are for the general activities of the General Service Office, and are recorded as unrestricted. Donations received from foreign A.A. entities for the international literature fund are also treated as unrestricted, as A.A.'s ongoing foreign literature assistance program satisfies the donor's condition on a current basis.

Intercompany balances and transfers are eliminated in the consolidated totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Operating expenses of the General Service Office are shared between the General Service Board of A.A. and A.A. World Services. Expenses related to service activities are charged to the General Service Board, while expenses in connection with publishing activities are allocated to A.A. World Services. Administrative and overhead costs are apportioned between the program activities they support.

Occupancy costs related to A.A. Grapevine's share of office space at the General Service Office have been allocated based on

its proportionate square footage; substantially all other expenses related to magazine activities are paid and recorded directly by A.A. Grapevine under its separate accounting system.

Cash: For purposes of the consolidated statement of cash flows, cash is defined as cash on hand, checking and money market accounts and short term cash investments.

Cash in excess of federally insured limits are potentially exposed to concentrations of credit risk. However, the Organization only maintains accounts with quality financial institutions with high credit standings, so as a consequence, such risks are limited.

Inventories: Inventories held are recorded at lower of cost or market under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Property and Equipment: The costs of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions are capitalized and depreciated on a straight line basis over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equipment, in the Capital Projects Fund.

Normal recurring expenditures for furniture and equipment are capitalized and depreciated over estimated useful lives of three to eight years by the operating entities.

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 2007 and the accumulated depreciation at that date:

	Life	Cost	Current Year	Accumulated Depreciation
Leasehold improvements	Terms of			
475 Riverside Drive	Leases	\$2,586,495	\$ 88,093	\$2,097,881
Furniture	8 Years	727,560	3,871	695,559
Computers - hardware	3 to 5 Years	703,342	109,843	607,656
Software	5 Years	717,934	125,490	444,656
		<u>4,735,331</u>	<u>327,297</u>	<u>3,845,742</u>

Investments: Investments are recorded at fair value. Gains and losses on sales or redemptions are recorded by comparison of proceeds to amortized cost on a specific identification basis.

As described above, all funds of the operating entities not required for working capital are consolidated in the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board. In accordance with established policy, the Fund invests in short or medium term U.S. Treasury Notes or Bills normally held to maturity.

The Postretirement Medical Fund holds investments designed to reach the stated goal of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the accrued postretirement health benefits by December 31, 2015. The fund invests in bond and equity mutual funds.

At December 31, 2007, investments were comprised as follows:

	Cost	Fair Value
Reserve Fund		
U.S. Treasury Bills/Notes	\$11,144,348	\$11,540,222
Postretirement Medical Fund		
Bond funds	190,027	189,053
Equity funds	323,851	310,482
	<u>513,878</u>	<u>499,535</u>
Totals	<u>11,658,226</u>	<u>12,039,757</u>

Investment income for 2007 and 2006 is comprised of the following:

	2007	2006
Interest	\$ 527,623	\$ 474,814
Realized gains on redemptions	25,082	17,441
Change in unrealized appreciation	311,792	(26,615)
Investment expenses	(11,167)	(9,471)
	<u>853,330</u>	<u>456,169</u>

Functional Expenses: The consolidated statement of Functional Expenses (Exhibit C) provides detail as to program costs by major activity and supporting services. In addition to the program costs reflected on that Exhibit, amounts shown on the consolidated statement of activities (Exhibit B) as cost of literature distributed also relate to the publishing and magazine programs.

Two of the major program activities described on Exhibit C are for "Group Services" and "Fellowship Services". Group Services includes those activities most closely associated with serving A.A. groups, including the group services staff assignment, the Box 459 newsletter, directories, group records and files, the contributions department and services to French and Spanish speaking groups in North America. Fellowship Services include activities outside of the group, such as public information, co-operation with the professional community, treatment and correctional facilities, archives and loners and overseas services.

Supporting services include costs of the General Service Office which can not be attributed to any specific program activity. These include administrative management, data processing and information systems, editorial and clerical support, trustee and director activities, copy center, accounting, human resources and miscellaneous administrative functions.

The allocation of supporting services to program activities on Exhibit C is done on a pro rata basis to program expenses by entity, and is provided for informational purposes only.

Fundraising costs are immaterial.

Operating Expenses: For purposes of the Statement of Functional Expenses, operating expenses are defined as recurring items requiring the current outlay of cash.

Management Estimates: The management of the Corporations uses estimates and assumptions in preparing financial statements in accordance with accounting principles generally accepted in the United States of America. These estimates and assumptions affect the reported amounts of assets, liabilities, revenues and expenses. Actual results could vary from the estimates that management uses.

As described in Note 5 of this report, management made certain significant estimates in the calculation of liabilities for postretirement health benefits. These estimates include employee retention, health care cost trends and the actuarial lives of present and projected retirees eligible for benefits. It is reasonably possible that a change in these estimates will occur in the near term. The effect of changes in these estimates can not be determined.

Note 3 Retirement Plan: The Organizations adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible U.S. employees who have completed one year of service.

The plan provides an annual benefit equal to 2% of final average compensation multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 35 years), less 0.65% of average social security earnings multiplied by years of service (not to exceed 30 years). The social security offset can not reduce the gross benefit by more than 50%.

Pension expense has been recorded in accordance with SFAS 87 and 132 in which costs are accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon factors which are not necessarily the same as those used to calculate the annual funding requirements. In addition, SFAS 87 required, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the Organization's balance sheet depending upon a comparison of the Plan's assets to its benefit obligations.

The contributions made to fund pension benefits are recorded by the operating companies as an expense. The difference between the amounts actually paid and the net periodic pension cost under SFAS 87 is recorded by the Reserve Fund as an adjustment to retirement expense as a non-cash item that does not affect current operations.

The following tables set forth the Plan's funded status,

assumptions, benefit cost and payments and employer contributions for 2007:

Fair value of plan assets (at December 31)	\$ 14,001,184
Benefit obligation (at December 31)	18,549,765
Funded status	<u>(4,548,581)</u>
Accrued pension cost recognized in consolidated statement of financial position	<u>\$ 4,548,581</u>
Weighted-average assumptions (at December 31)	
Discount rate	6.0%
Expected return on plan assets (based on historical returns)	9.0%
Rate of compensation increase	5.0%
Accumulated benefit obligation	\$15,143,817
Benefit cost	\$ 789,212
Employers' contributions	\$ 1,060,608
Benefits paid	\$ 849,566
Classification of benefit costs:	
Operating expense (cash funding)	\$ 1,060,000
Non-operating expense (non-cash adjustment to pension cost)	<u>(270,788)</u>
	<u>(789,212)</u>

The expected benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2008	\$ 959,000
2009	961,000
2010	970,000
2011	986,000
2012	1,069,000
2013 - 2017	6,351,000

The employers' contributions for 2008 are expected to be comparable to 2007.

Plan assets at December 31, 2007 were composed as follows:

Domestic Equity Mutual Funds	50.1%
International Equity Mutual Funds	13.2%
Bond Mutual Funds	34.7%
Cash and equivalents	2.0%
	<u>100.0%</u>

The mutual funds in the plan are primarily index funds designed to achieve diversification between fixed income and equity investments among asset classes including S&P 500, small capitalization companies and international stocks.

The Financial Accounting Standards Board issued Statement #158 in September 2006. This statement revised financial reporting by requiring an employer to recognize the overfunded or underfunded status of a defined benefit plan as an asset or liability in its statement of financial position. The statement became effective for 2007. As a result, an additional pension liability of \$3,157,428 was recognized on the consolidated statement of activity for 2007.

Note 4 Lease Commitments: At December 31, 2007, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$471,128 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

\$97,915 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective January 1, 1999 through December 31, 2008 and extended on August 10, 2006 through December 31, 2018.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 2007 is \$6,259,000 as follows:

2008	\$ 569,000
2009	569,000
2010	569,000
2011	569,000
2012	569,000
2013 to 2018	<u>3,414,000</u>
	<u>6,259,000</u>

Note 5 Postretirement Health Benefits: The Corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they attain retirement age while working at the General Service Office. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the Corporations, 25% of the cost of which is borne by the retirees.

For employees hired after January 1, 2004 there is a three-tier structure in the level of group medical insurance premiums paid for on behalf of employees who retire directly from GSO. For employees with 5-9 years of service the corporations will pay 25%, 10-15 years 50% and more than 15 years 75%.

The assumed health care cost trend rate used to measure the expected cost of benefits covered by the plan is 6.0%. A discount rate of 6.0% has been used to measure the accrued postretirement health benefit obligation shown on Exhibit B.

In prior years the Plan was unfunded. However, as described in Note 1, a Postretirement Medical Fund was created by the Board in 2006 with the purpose of accumulating assets equal to 50% of the postretirement health benefits liability after ten years.

The following table sets forth the information regarding the Plan for 2007:

Benefit obligation (at December 31)	\$4,122,317
Benefits paid	<u>\$ 178,937</u>
Benefit cost	<u>\$ 74,196</u>
Benefit cost reported by:	
Operating entities as funded	\$ 250,992
Postretirement Medical Fund	<u>(176,796)</u>
	<u>74,196</u>

The Plan provides a drug benefit to retirees which qualifies under the Federal Retiree Drug Subsidy. The calculation of the Plan's benefit obligation has been determined net of the anticipated reimbursements. The amount of the subsidy estimated for 2007 is \$20,000, and is expected to be received in 2008. In 2007, a drug subsidy of \$19,911 was received for 2006. In 2008, the effect of the subsidy is already included in the premiums, so no further subsidies are anticipated.

The expected postretirement benefits to be paid for the next ten years are as follows:

2008	\$ 189,673
2009	201,053
2010	213,116
2011	225,903
2012	239,457
2013 - 2017	<u>1,430,827</u>

Note 6 Tax Status: The Corporations are exempt from Federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code, and are classified as public charities. They are also exempt from New York State franchise and sales taxes.

The Budget Highlights

2008 G.S.O. Budget

These budget highlights describe the "OPERATIONS" of the General Service Office — A.A. World Services (the Publishing operation) and the General Fund (Service activities) and the Grapevine Operations. It excludes any activities reported separately in the Reserve Fund, Convention Fund, Post Retirement Fund or the Capital Projects Fund.

Income: The 2008 budget projects gross sales of \$12,700,000, approximately flat when compared with the 2007 actual results of \$12,730,000, which were \$730,000 greater than the \$12,000,000 estimated for the 2007 budget. While reviewing and recommending the 2008 budget, the A.A.W.S. Board considered that revenue and expense assumptions made for the G.S.O. budget ultimately affect the long-term health of the General Service Boards Reserve Fund.

Manufacturing costs are budgeted approximately 3.8% higher than 2007, because we are anticipating higher paper and manufacturing component costs. Royalties are budgeted at \$52,000 this year. There are only two remaining recipients.

Shipping and warehousing costs are budgeted approximately 3.6% higher than the 2007 results.

After subtracting manufacturing costs, royalties, and shipping expense, gross profit is budgeted at \$6,822,500, or 55.2% of net sales. Gross profit has been budgeted about \$225,000 less than 2007. The 55.2% gross profit percentage anticipated for 2008 compares with 56.8% for 2007. It should be remembered that as we strive to have literature available in Spanish and French as well as English for our Service Conference, lower print runs in those languages usually result in higher production costs. Because we strive to have similar selling prices regardless of our manufacturing cost, lower gross profits for individual items may occur that affect the overall gross profit. Thus price increases may become necessary as things progress.

Gross Profit Percentage has fallen from 58.8% in 2006, to 56.8% in 2007, and to 55.2% for the 2008 budget.

Even though contribution revenue has seen favorable upward movement over the last several years, Prudence dictates that actions have been necessary to control costs and reinforce the revenue stream to provide sufficient funds to continue providing services. Trusted Servants continue to explore methods to reduce the costs of operations as well as assess the services supplied.

Contributions: Contributions for 2007 were over budget by \$326,000 (5.2%). Total contributions for 2008 have been budgeted at \$6,675,000, an increase of approximately 2.3%. During 2007, contributions from groups and individuals of \$6,381,600 were \$330,700 (5.5%) greater than budget and \$459,200 (7.8%) greater than 2006. Contributions received from World Service Meeting countries toward the World Service Meeting International literature fund amounted to \$144,400, approximately \$1,400 less than 2006. In total, contributions received for 2007 were just over \$6,526,000. In addition to the work trusted servants are doing to carry the message of the necessity for voluntary contributions, historical evidence suggests that usually in the year following an International Convention we enjoy a healthy increase in contributions. Afterward the rate of growth declines somewhat.

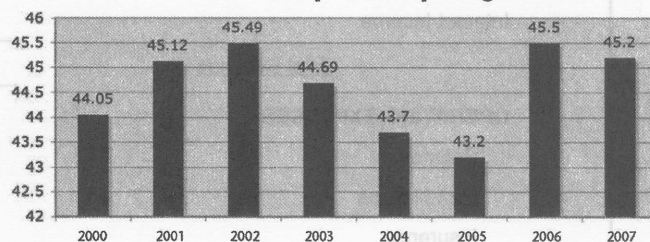
The chart to the right reflects the approximate percentage of the A.A. groups listed with the General Service Office that have participated in the 7th Tradition by contributing to the General Service Office.

Total Operating Revenue for 2008 is anticipated at \$13,507,500, just slightly less than the 2007 results of \$13,582,000.

Total Operating Expenses for 2008 have been budgeted at \$13,266,700, approximately \$703,000 or 5.6% more than 2007 and \$593,200 or 4.7% more than the 2007 budget as well. The 2008 budget includes expenses for the G.S.O. U.S.A. net expense for the World Service Meeting. Absent the W.S.M. costs, the increase in the 2008 budget over the 2007 budget would be approximately 3.7%.

The 2008 G.S.O. budget anticipates an excess of revenue over expense of \$240,796. This compares with an actual income of \$1,018,600 for 2007 and the \$89,450 net income budgeted for 2007 (including midyear adjustments). The large variance from budget to actual results is due to higher than anticipated revenue from both sales and contributions. The expected 2008 operating income, the 2007 actual income, as well as other transfers, assist in maintaining the Reserve Fund. However, during 2008, the A.A.W.S. Board will be carefully considering future actions.

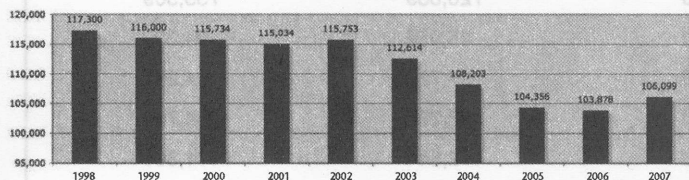
% of Groups Participating



2008 Grapevine Budget

The 2008 Grapevine Budget calls for an average circulation of 107,000, approximately 4,000 greater than the 2007 budget and approximately 900 greater than the 2007 paid circulation of 106,099. Circulation for the last several years is depicted in the chart below.

AA Grapevine Circulation 1998-2007



Income: Magazine income of \$2,089,461 is expected, \$139,000 greater than 2007. Other Publishing Income from books, cassette tapes, and miscellaneous items is budgeted at \$812,700, \$42,500 higher than 2007.

Total Gross Profit: Combining the magazine and other publishing items, a gross profit of \$1,825,966 is budgeted for 2008. This compares with \$1,667,395 for 2007 and the 2007 budget of \$1,639,059.

Total Operating Expenses: Total Operating Expenses for 2008 are budgeted at \$1,895,500, \$130,300 more than the 2007 expenses of \$1,765,200.

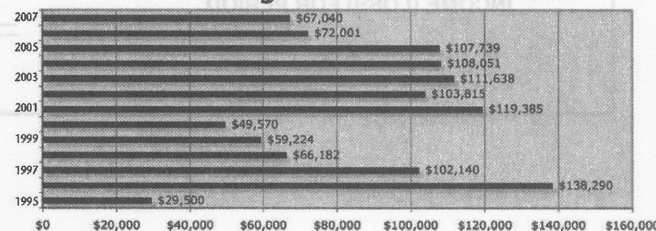
Net Income: For 2008 the Grapevine anticipates a profit of \$3,200. This compares with a 2007 budgeted loss of \$81,300 and an actual loss from operations of \$25,000.

2008 La Viña Budget

For 2008 La Viña expects a gross profit on the magazine of \$34,858, compared with \$35,234 in 2007. Circulation for 2008 is estimated at 11,000, about equal to the 10,979 average for 2007. Other Publishing income is estimated at \$40,800, which after deducting cost of product of \$10,500, expects to contribute \$30,300 to revenue. Total costs and expenses are estimated at \$132,529 for 2008, just \$2,300 less than 2007. The 2008 budget projects a net loss of \$67,371, even with the 2007 loss of \$67,040.

The chart to the right reflects the La Viña magazine losses since inception (1995). To date losses of approximately \$1,134,000 have been incurred.

La Viña Magazine losses 1995-2007



The General Service Office 2008 OPERATING BUDGET

INCOME	2007 Budget	2007 Actual	2008 Budget
GROSS SALES	\$12,000,000	\$12,730,033	\$12,700,000
Discounts allowed	350,000	336,197	350,000
<u>Net Sales</u>	11,650,000	12,393,836	12,350,000
Cost of Literature Distributed			
Manufacturing	3,360,000	3,662,533	3,800,000
Royalties	170,000	67,898	52,000
<u>Gross Margin</u>	8,120,000	8,663,405	8,498,000
DIRECT SHIPPING AND WAREHOUSING	1,560,000	1,616,741	1,675,500
<u>Gross Profit from Literature</u>	6,560,000	7,046,664	6,822,500
Contributions Received	6,200,000	6,526,002	6,675,000
Interest Income	3,000	9,891	10,000
<u>Total Revenue</u>	12,763,000	13,582,557	13,507,500
OPERATING EXPENSES			
Salaries	\$5,271,000	\$5,078,949	\$5,414,250
Payroll taxes	374,000	363,716	374,000
Insurance	865,200	864,732	952,800
Retirement expense	1,275,200	1,268,779	1,313,500
Other program printing	406,000	456,016	475,200
Mailing, labor, etc.	115,300	128,075	130,700
Postage & express	400,750	428,439	440,000
Writers' fees	220,500	203,990	183,300
Other literature assist	117,700	124,454	150,000
Selling expenses	162,750	144,980	173,050
Professional fees	171,100	239,304	208,500
Contracted services	851,600	868,227	846,000
Occupancy	727,100	720,839	755,509
Telephone	91,100	96,952	94,300
Equipment maintenance	86,400	87,728	94,200
Furniture & equipment	126,000	128,282	164,740
Stationery & office expense	180,150	172,544	171,300
Office service & expense	258,600	236,240	270,555
Travel, meals, & accommodations	963,100	938,655	1,044,800
Bad debts	10,000	13,079	10,000
TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES	\$12,673,550	\$12,563,980	\$13,266,704
INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD	89,450	1,018,577	240,796

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

2008 BUDGET

	ENGLISH			SPANISH		
	2007 Budget	2007 Actual	2008 Budget	2007 Budget	2007 Actual	2007 Budget
PAID CIRCULATION —						
AVERAGE # OF COPIES	<u>103,000</u>	<u>106,099</u>	<u>107,000</u>	<u>10,100</u>	<u>10,979</u>	<u>11,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE						
Subscription income	\$1,820,564	\$1,797,418	\$1,927,418	\$79,140	84,286	84,286
Single copies and back issues	87,566	84,705	84,617	16,132	17,865	17,865
Digital Archives Project subs	40,467	47,426	47,426			
Audio Grapevine	15,600	20,684	30,000			
<u>Total magazine income</u>	<u>1,964,197</u>	<u>1,950,233</u>	<u>2,089,461</u>	<u>95,272</u>	<u>102,151</u>	<u>102,151</u>
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>763,622</u>	<u>767,463</u>	<u>790,081</u>	<u>70,014</u>	<u>66,917</u>	<u>67,293</u>
Gross Profit on Magazine	<u>1,200,575</u>	<u>1,182,770</u>	<u>1,299,380</u>	<u>25,258</u>	<u>35,234</u>	<u>34,858</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	724,674	770,242	812,716	37,940	44,521	40,800
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>286,190</u>	<u>285,617</u>	<u>286,130</u>	<u>9,353</u>	<u>11,974</u>	<u>10,500</u>
Gross Profit on Special Items	<u>438,484</u>	<u>484,625</u>	<u>526,586</u>	<u>28,587</u>	<u>32,547</u>	<u>30,300</u>
Total Gross Profit	<u>1,639,059</u>	<u>1,667,395</u>	<u>1,825,966</u>	<u>53,845</u>	<u>67,781</u>	<u>65,158</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES						
EDITORIAL COSTS						
Salaries, including temporary help	276,337	282,205	318,641	73,343	63,874	58,300
Payroll taxes and benefits	117,591	122,402	126,053			19,481
Occupancy costs	65,057	72,522	80,408	0		
Office supplies and expenses	25,000	32,173	25,248	295	333	343
Product development & Web	50,465	34,602	70,909	0	0	0
<u>Total Editorial</u>	<u>534,450</u>	<u>543,904</u>	<u>621,259</u>	<u>73,638</u>	<u>64,207</u>	<u>78,124</u>
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS						
Salaries, including temporary help	460,168	469,812	483,552	21,600	21,529	23,400
Payroll taxes and benefits	179,097	158,380	172,544	2,802	3,264	2,332
Kable fulfillment	138,668	136,596	143,424	8,861	10,190	10,496
Occupancy costs	61,619	67,594	75,234	0		
Office supplies and expenses	50,000	66,537	55,331	0		
Selling expense-regular	156,500	122,097	128,000	13,725	11,446	10,775
-GvR program	22,200	13,496	24,700	0		
Postage	11,109	6,583	6,780	475	496	511
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>	<u>1,079,361</u>	<u>1,041,095</u>	<u>1,089,565</u>	<u>47,463</u>	<u>46,925</u>	<u>47,514</u>
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE						
Employee's Severance						
Computer Consulting	39,589	35,650	32,096			
Leasehold Improvements						
Insurance	8,093	6,724	6,926	437		
Professional fees	37,438	44,965	45,456		1,819	2,000
Meetings and conferences	55,000	62,672	64,552	3,500	20,520	3,500
Furniture and equipment	6,134	8,527	8,783	530	980	1,009
Canadian exchange and other	2,552	-3,466	1,000	250		
Bank service charges	9,905	8,738	9,000			
Bad debts	15,000	16,412	16,904	360	370	382
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>	<u>173,711</u>	<u>180,222</u>	<u>184,717</u>	<u>5,077</u>	<u>23,689</u>	<u>6,891</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES	<u>1,787,522</u>	<u>1,765,221</u>	<u>1,895,541</u>	<u>126,178</u>	<u>134,821</u>	<u>132,529</u>
Interest earned	67,135	72,779	72,779			
NET INCOME (Loss) FOR PERIOD	<u>-81,328</u>	<u>-25,047</u>	<u>3,204</u>	<u>-72,333</u>	<u>-67,040</u>	<u>-67,371</u>

2007 Contributions From Groups, Individuals, Specials, Special Meetings — by Delegate Area (in U.S. Dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS REPORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBERSHIP	CONTRIBUTION PER CAPITA	INDIVIDUAL MEMBERS	MEMORIAL	SPECIALS ⁽¹⁾	SPECIAL MEETINGS ⁽²⁾	TOTAL AREA CONTRIBUTIONS	PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	415	211	50.8%	45,207	8,605	\$5.24	750	99	496	200	\$46,751.45	\$5.43
2.	Alaska	183	88	48.1	16,897	3,280	5.15	939		584	80	\$18,499.61	\$5.64
3.	Arizona	923	438	47.4	121,185	22,036	5.50	12,532	300	10,507	275	\$144,353.45	\$6.55
4.	Arkansas	257	147	57.1	21,443	4,643	4.61	1,186		2,493	120	\$25,237.41	\$5.44
5.	California	1,175	398	33.8	119,858	43,845	2.72	10,363	320	3,916	501	\$134,957.80	\$3.08
6.	N. Coastal	1,801	1,092	60.5	269,485	56,201	4.80	19,077	3,000	4,132	592	\$296,285.32	\$5.27
7.	N. Interior	847	425	50.1	90,256	24,075	3.75	4,803	30	3,091	23	\$98,203.53	\$4.08
8.	San Diego/Imp.	882	385	43.6	78,764	26,446	2.98	7,905	1,738	3,507	583	\$92,496.39	\$3.50
9.	Mid-South.	1,523	779	51.1	183,928	47,471	3.87	7,918		2,979	474	\$195,298.66	\$4.11
10.	Colorado	704	383	54.4	16,995	16,995	6.83	12,201	170	27,656	141	\$156,373.79	\$9.20
11.	Connecticut	1,514	600	39.5	121,415	38,265	3.17	5,322	850	12,668	480	\$140,733.06	\$3.68
12.	Delaware	220	122	55.4	34,736	3,475	10.00	285		3,417		\$38,437.67	\$11.06
13.	D.C.	456	208	45.5	53,398	14,439	3.70	753	20			\$54,170.89	\$3.75
14.	Florida	816	388	47.4	90,911	17,794	5.10	4,283	50	28,631		\$123,875.29	\$6.96
15.	South/	1,727	878	50.8	229,791	37,702	6.09	12,343	1,000	95,065	244	\$338,443.78	\$8.98
16.	Georgia	703	440	62.6	108,483	16,862	6.43	8,045		3,171		\$119,699.06	\$7.10
17.	Hawaii	312	166	53.1	38,039	5,349	7.10	847		657		\$39,542.39	\$7.39
18.	Idaho	220	103	46.8	19,688	4,037	4.87	667				\$21,027.72	\$5.21
19.	Illinois	1,191	296	24.9	86,191	28,632	3.00	3,389	125	6,412	35	\$96,151.66	\$3.36
20.	Chicago	1,103	453	41.1	65,328	22,465	2.90	5,210	100	13,885	396	\$84,918.96	\$3.78
21.	North	462	151	32.5	26,214	8,475	3.08	607	25	480	9	\$27,335.14	\$3.23
22.	Indiana	620	238	38.4	35,408	9,092	3.89	1,196	600	1,979	95	\$39,278.19	\$4.32
23.	North	626	261	41.7	35,123	11,094	3.17	1,306		1,250	148	\$37,826.90	\$3.91
24.	South	643	276	42.9	50,762	13,385	3.78	1,782		550	100	\$52,348.34	\$3.41
25.	Iowa	373	182	48.8	33,559	9,761	3.43	3,265	300	6,965		\$44,088.99	\$4.52
26.	Kansas	655	281	42.8	69,078	10,524	6.56	3,605		2,680		\$75,362.42	\$7.16
27.	Kentucky	420	180	42.8	38,362	9,019	4.24	886		341		\$39,589.49	\$4.39
28.	Louisiana	484	177	36.5	8,016	8,016	2.61	351		2,995		\$24,330.14	\$3.04
29.	Maine	971	420	43.2	83,971	15,373	5.45	5,340	1,000	554		\$90,864.98	\$5.91
30.	Maryland												
31.	Massachusetts	1,390	514	36.9	122,541	47,277	2.58	8,228		3,100	546	\$134,414.82	\$2.84
32.	East	284	159	55.9	19,285	5,251	3.66	509			20	\$19,813.89	\$3.77
33.	West												
34.	Michigan	591	248	41.9	39,705	13,075	3.04	2,715	50	1,080	10	\$43,560.10	\$3.33
35.	Central	867	293	33.7	20,027	5,854	3.29	3,101	150	353	25	\$69,483.06	\$3.47
36.	Southeast	543	200	36.7	37,870	11,629	3.25	596		2,079		\$40,543.98	\$3.49
37.	West												
38.	Minnesota	527	245	46.5	25,822	8,895	2.89	766	545	1,200	341	\$28,332.96	\$3.19
39.	North	1,030	423	41.1	86,222	25,524	3.38	867	100	1,774		\$89,303.68	\$3.50
40.	South	258	107	41.5	24,327	4,951	4.91	1,131		1,080		\$26,538.36	\$5.36
41.	Mississippi												
42.	Missouri	518	248	47.8	51,903	10,366	5.01	6,844	100	320	50	\$59,215.50	\$5.71
43.	East	229	101	44.0	18,983	6,583	2.88	142		359		\$19,483.52	\$2.96
44.	West	270	124	45.8	23,145	4,825	4.80	522		50		\$23,717.51	\$4.92
45.	Montana	734	325	44.2	55,045	16,461	3.33	693	1,025	250	46	\$57,059.09	\$3.47
46.	Nebraska	496	205	41.3	41,965	12,377	3.38	7,171	66	4,124	9	\$53,334.44	\$4.31
47.	Nevada	564	253	44.9	34,345	11,135	3.08	351	100	2,883		\$37,679.08	\$3.38
48.	New Hampshire												
49.	New Jersey	1,242	512	41.2	105,378	30,759	3.42	8,968	344	2,884	405	\$117,979.28	\$3.84
50.	North	509	260	51.1	63,806	8,732	7.31	796	538	115	1,012	\$66,266.79	\$7.59
51.	South	368	176	47.7	38,515	6,550	5.87	2,283		6,606		\$47,404.50	\$7.24
52.	New Mexico												
53.	New York	715	250	34.9	40,939	12,424	3.29	3,459	25	611	20	\$45,054.22	\$3.63
54.	Central	741	291	39.3	31,292	11,051	2.83	478		1,919	150	\$33,839.01	\$3.06
55.	H./M./B.	1,751	708	40.3	222,220	56,435	3.94	16,149	4,655	7,060	1,276	\$251,359.67	\$4.45
56.	Southeast	339	84	24.7	12,744	5,750	2.21	59	106			\$12,908.58	\$2.24
57.	West	960	493	51.3	106,567	15,856	6.71	5,272	500	3,830		\$116,169.80	\$7.33
58.	N. Carolina	139	75	53.9	10,813	3,180	3.39	165		678		\$11,655.23	\$3.67
59.	North Dakota												
60.	Ohio	725	201	27.7	30,832	10,523	2.93	1,726		252	63	\$32,873.07	\$3.12
61.	Cent. & S.E.	1,456	354	24.3	43,524	20,939	2.07	2,030		2,347		\$47,901.55	\$2.29
62.	Northeast	305	106	34.7	12,257	4,374	2.79	692	326			\$13,510.96	\$3.09
63.	N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.	532	232	43.5	41,198	10,216	4.02	4,168		25		\$45,390.47	\$4.44
64.	S.W. Ohio	380	204	53.6	34,481	7,384	4.66	350	51	548	60	\$35,490.23	\$4.81
65.	Oklahoma	960	430	44.8	85,029	18,940	4.48	7,407	2,000	4,950	56	\$99,442.18	\$5.25
66.	Oregon												

2008 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

Martin Aire
¹Tim Donaldson
²Bill Fifield
 Torvald Hansen
 Maurice Holman
 Debbie Johnson
 Joan Ramsey
 John Teupel
Secretary: Doug Richardson

Cooperation With the Professional Community

¹Nora Bromley
 Al Davenport
 Mike Doheny
 Barbara Frizzell
 John Johnson
 Murdo MacKay
²Mike Maynard
 John Wighton
 John Zidarín
Secretary: Mary Dargan

Corrections

Dodie Ash
 Joe Barrett
²Gail Harris
 Patricia McDonald
 Perry Marquis
¹Bill Neal
 Bill Ouchie
 Kevin Short
Secretary: Gayle Solheim Riese

Finance

Dave Bruha
 Fred Ellis
²Francis Gilroy
 Gail Nelson
 George Possley
 Linda Seamon
¹Andrew Ware
 Suzanne Welham
Secretary: Donald Meurer

Grapevine

David Fox
 Lori Geistlinger
¹Fred Heyne
 Ron Hubbard
 Gregg King
²Liz Olmstead
 Joe Schranck
 Ginette Williams
Secretary: Robin Bromley

Literature

David Adelhart
 Hari Boggs
 Andy Coyne
²Sheila Dunne
 Sharon Farnsworth
¹Vernon Gosney
 Helon Hill
 Ted Kroll
 Leon Roberts
Secretary: Eva Sanchez

Policy/Admissions

Cheryl Akin
 Sharon Buckley
¹Gus Henry
 Robert Hill
 France Jolicoeur
 Bruce Kesl
 Rad Miller
²Phil Momerak
 Hugh Neavill
Secretary: Adrienne Brown

Public Information

John Antol
 John Conway
²Janet Hollabaugh
¹Trish La Nauze
 Claude Matteau
 Larry Sanford
 Sara Spencer
 Ralph Trigg
 Gustavo Trujillo
Secretary: Irene Kontje

Report and Charter

Paul Alexander
 Brooke Collins
 Kathi Davis
 John Fraser
 David Morgan
²Julie Simiskey
¹Leo Smith
 Jim Withrow
Secretary: Mary Clare Lynch

Treatment Facilities

¹Pat Basinger
 Moe Bradley
 Bob Conley
 Sylvain LeLièvre
 JoAnne Nelson
 Antonio Rodriguez
²Kiki Roddy
 Dennis Wilson
Secretary: Warren Stafford

Trustees

Scott Alhlgren
 Dot Dykstra
¹John Mastrull
²Newton Pritchett
 Michalene Reilly
 Tom Revelle
 Lee Wilson
 Steve Yocum
 Jeff Your
Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

³Archives

Nora Bromley
 Dave Bruha
 Dot Dykstra
¹Francis Gilroy
 Torvald Hansen
 Michalene Reilly
 Ralph Trigg
 Andrew Ware
²Jim Withrow
Secretary: Amy Filiatreau

³International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

¹Moe Bradley
 John Johnson
 Bruce Kesl
 John Mastrull
 David Morgan
 Larry Sanford
²Julie Simiskey
 Suzanne Welham
Secretary: Rick Walker

2009 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS⁴

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Joan Ramsey, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, NY	Martin Aire, Western Ontario
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Al Davenport, Rhode Island	Barbara Frizzell, Kentucky
Corrections	Kevin Short, New Hampshire	Dodie Ash, No. Wisc./Up. Pen. Michigan
Finance	Suzanne Welham, SW Ohio	Gail Nelson, San Diego/Imperial Calif.
Grapevine	David Fox, Idaho	Joe Schranck, Delaware
Literature	Leon Roberts, NW Texas	Hari Boggs, New Brunswick/Prince Edward Island
Policy/Admissions	Bruce Kesl, Kansas	Rad Miller, Washington State East
Public Information	Sally Spencer, Western Massachusetts	John Conway, Northern Illinois
Report and Charter	Kathi Davis, Maine	David Morgan, Georgia
Treatment	Sylvain LeLièvre, NW Quebec	Dennis Wilson, Arizona
Trustees	Joan Ramsey, Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire, NY	Martin Aire, Western Ontario
³ Archives	Ralph Trigg, New Mexico	Dave Bruha, Alberta/NWT
³ International Conv./Regional Forums	David Morgan, Georgia	John Johnson, Manitoba

¹Chairperson

²Alternate Chairperson

³Members of this committee serve on this as a secondary committee assignment.

⁴The 2008 committee chairs rotated at the end of the 58th General Service Conference.

2008 Trustees' Committees**

Archives

Chuck Barta, *chairperson*
Conley Byrd
Vince Keefe
Roberta Lindeman
George Martin
Madeleine Parmley
Andy Talbert
Jane Tolar
Amy Filiatreau, *secretary*

Audit

Herb Goodman, *chairperson*
Paul Cleary
Ward Ewing
Vince Keefe
Madeleine Parmley
Don Meurer, *secretary*

Conference

John Skilton, *chairperson*
Chuck Barta
Conley Byrd
Bill Clark
Tom Kramer
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
George Martin
Andy Talbert
Jane Tolar
Doug Richardson, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community/ Treatment Facilities

Bob Mayer, *chairperson*
Bill Clark
Ward Ewing
Rogelio Flores
John Kane
Roberta Lindeman
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
*Andy Talbert
Jeannne Woodford

Mary Dargan, *secretary — C.P.C.*
Warren Stafford, *secretary — Treatment Facilities*

Corrections

Madeleine Parmley, *chairperson*
James Branscome
Paul Cleary
Roberta Lindeman
Howard Lowery
*Bill Noonan
*Bill Thomson
Jeanne Woodford
Gayle Solheim Riese, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

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Terrance Bedient
Ginger Bell
Herb Goodman
Dorothy Hurley
Howard Lowery
Ray Massey
George Martin
John Skilton
Kevin Sunkel,
consultant/independent auditor
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

Dorothy Wilson, *chairperson*
James Branscome
Bill Clarke
Paul Cleary
Rogelio Flores
Herb Goodman
Jo-Anne Lowenberger
Bob Mayer
Julio Espallat, *secretary*

International Conventions/ A.A. Regional Forums

Herb Goodman, *chairperson*
Ginger Rhoades Bell
Conley Byrd
Rogelio Flores
Dorothy Hurley
John Kane
Tom Kramer
Dorothy Wilson
Rick Walker, *secretary*

Literature

Bill Clark, *chairperson*
Ginger Bell
James Branscome
*Lizz Hudson
Dorothy Hurley
John Kane
George Martin
John Skilton
Jane Tolar
Christopher Cavanaugh, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
Eva Sanchez, *secretary*

Nominating

Tom Kraemer, *chairperson*
Paul Cleary
Ward Ewing
Bob Mayer
Madeleine Parmley
Dorothy Wilson
Jeannne Woodford
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Public Information

Ward Ewing, *chairperson*,
James Branscome
Paul Cleary
*Larry Fennelly
Tina Hornsby
*Paul Hutchinson
Vince Keefe
Roberta Lindeman
Jeanne Woodford
Irene Kontje, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Dorothy Hurley, *chairperson*
Adrienne Brown, *secretary*



Officers of the General Service Board

Chair
Leonard Blumenthal
First vice-chairperson
Herb Goodman
Second vice-chairperson
Bill Clark
Secretary
Chuck Barta
Treasurer
Vincent Keefe
Assistant secretary
Adrienne Brown
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

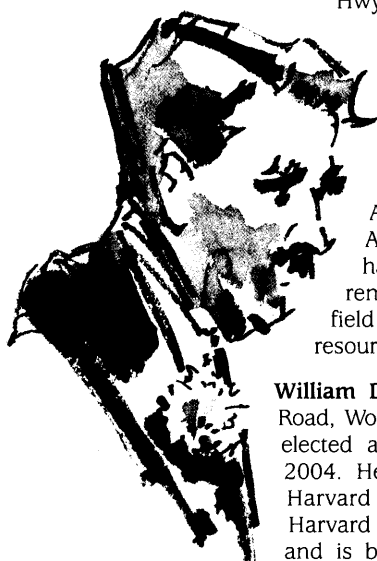
The new slate of officers
is given on page 12.

* Denotes appointed committee members

** Leonard Blumenthal and Greg Muth are ex officio members of all committees.

2008 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES



Leonard M. Blumenthal, LL.D. (23205 Hwy 623, Rolly View, Alberta TOC 2KA, Canada) was elected chairman of the board in April 2005, and has served as a Class A trustee since 2000. In 1998 Len retired as chief executive officer of the Alberta Alcohol and Drug Abuse Commission, where he had worked for 30 years. He remains active in the alcoholism field as speaker, consultant and a resource person.

William D. Clark, M.D. (143 Temple Road, Woolwich, ME 04579) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. He is a graduate of Harvard University and Harvard Medical School, and is board certified in internal medicine. Bill

was medical director of the Addiction Resource Center (Brunswick, ME) and an attending physician at Mid Coast Hospital in Brunswick until he retired from patient care activities in 2004. He has taught in medical schools and post-graduate programs (residency), as well as presenting seminars and programs on alcoholism. He chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and International Committees.

Ward B. Ewing, D.D. (The General Theological Seminary, 175 Ninth Avenue, New York, NY 10011) was elected a Class A trustee in 2004. Ward is a graduate of the General Theological Seminary, where he is now dean and president. For over 30 years he served as pastor of Episcopal congregations in his native Tennessee, and in Florida, Kentucky and Buffalo, New York. He is involved in community ministries and is the author of several books and articles. Ward chairs the Public Information Committee and serves on the Nominating, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, and Audit Committees.

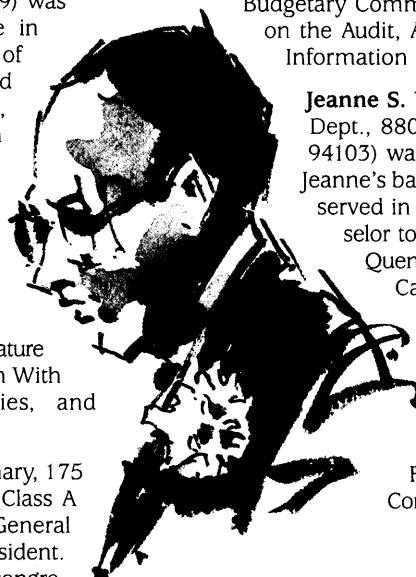
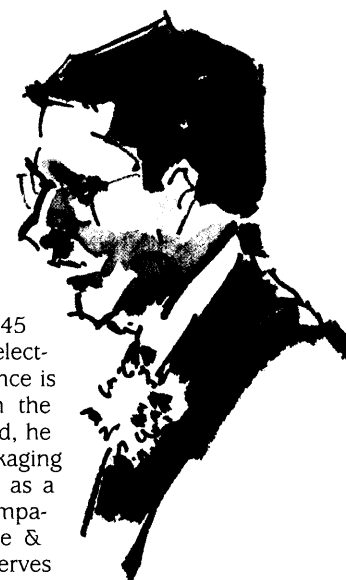
The Hon. Rogelio R. Flores (Superior Court of the State of California, Santa Maria Div., 312-M East Cook St., Santa Maria, CA 93456-5165) was elected Class A trustee in April 2007. A graduate of the UCLA School of Law, Judge Flores now serves on the Superior Court of Santa Barbara. He is assigned to various specialty courts, including the Substance Abuse Treatment Court, and is on the faculty of the National Drug Court Institute. Rogelio serves on the International, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Herbert I. Goodman (5710 Tecumseh Circle, Houston, TX 77057) was elected a Class A trustee in 2003. Herbert holds degrees in chemistry, international economics and business from the University of Pittsburgh, Harvard, and the University of Besancon in France. Herbert is CEO of an international cor-

poration involved with petroleum products and energy conservation. He chairs both the Audit and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and International Committees. Herb is also a member of the Grapevine Board.

***Vincent E. Keefe** (9889 West 145 St., Orland Park, IL 60462) was elected to the board in April 2002. Vince is a CPA and holds an MBA from the University of Chicago. Now retired, he has been the CEO of a large packaging corporation and currently serves as a director on the boards of five companies. Vince chairs the Finance & Budgetary Committee and serves on the Audit, Archives, and Public Information Committees.

Jeanne S. Woodford (San Francisco Adult Probation Dept., 880 Bryant St., Rm. 200, San Francisco, CA 94103) was elected a Class A trustee in April 2005. Jeanne's background is in criminal justice and she has served in various positions, from correctional counselor to warden at the California State Prison, San Quentin. She was the former undersecretary, California Department of Corrections and Rehabilitation, Sacramento. She is currently the Adult Chief Probation Officer for the city and county of San Francisco. Jeanne serves on the Corrections, Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Nominating and Public Information Committees.



ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

***Charles Barta** (1320 43rd St. SE, Cedar Rapids, IA 52403) was elected West Central regional trustee in April 2004. A former Panel 51 delegate, Chuck is active in his region and area and in district correctional and treatment facilities meetings. He currently works in the construction industry as an electrician. Chuck chairs the Archives Committee and serves on the Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees.

Conley F. Byrd, Jr. (Box 3, 1506 S. Hwy. 365, Redfield, AR 72132) was elected Southwest regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 43 delegate, Conley is active in his group, district and area. A graduate of LSU School of Veterinary Medicine, he is owner and sole practitioner of a Veterinary Hospital. Conley serves on the Archives, Conference, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Paul E. Cleary (2963 Butler Street, Oceanside, CA 92054) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. Paul started in

* Rotating at the close of the 2008 Conference meeting.

service work in young people's groups. As a Panel 42 delegate he chaired the 1993 Conference Literature Committee, and was a nontrustee director on the A.A.W.S. Board from 2002– 2005. A clinical social worker, Paul is currently an account executive for a behavioral healthcare firm. He is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Audit, Corrections, International, Nominating and Public Information Committees.

Dorothy L. Hurley (304 Donna Dr., Plymouth Meeting, PA 19462) was elected general service trustee in April 2007. Dorothy served as a nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board (2004-2007) and has been active in her group and intergroup. With a professional background in organization development, administration, and education, she is now a university professor. Dorothy chairs the General Sharing Session and serves on Finance and Budgetary, Literature, and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees. She is a member of the Grapevine Board.

John J. Kane, Jr. (549 Grant Ave., Collingswood, NJ 08107-1926) was elected Northeast regional trustee in April 2007. A Panel 46 delegate, he served on committees in Area 45 and is an active sponsor. A mechanical engineer by profession, John is currently Community Development Director of his town. John serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Literature, and International Conventions/ Regional Forums Committees.

***Tom Kraemer** (Box 121, Vibank, Saskatchewan S0G 4Y0, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in April 2004. A Panel 48 delegate, Tom's service background includes longtime involvement in general service in Area 91, Saskatchewan. He has served on a number of other A.A. service committees as well, including Regina Intergroup. He has been employed by Canada Post Corp. for over 34 years. Tom chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Conference and International Conventions/Regional Forums Committees.

Jo-Anne Lowenberger (303 Regal Ave., Winnipeg, MB R2M 0P4, Canada) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 2007. A Panel 52 delegate, Jo-Anne spearheaded the Canadian Archives Display for the 2005 Spiritual Homecoming. Active throughout her area, Archives is a special interest. She has been the head of File Maintenance (pricing) in a major store, since 1979. Jo-Anne serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities, Conference and International Committees.

Howard Lowery (P.O. Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 42 delegate, Howard is actively involved in his home group, sponsorship, and district and area A.A. activities. He owns and manages a local retail store. Howard chairs the A.A.W.S. Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Corrections Committees.

Raymond Massey (79 Edenvold Place NW, Calgary, AB T3A 3T8, Canada) was elected general service trustee in April 2005. A former Panel 44 delegate, Ray has been involved in Canadian Remote Communities and Young Offenders meetings. He has served as nontrustee director on the Grapevine Board. He owns and operates a Painting and Decorating Contracting business and is a member of the Alberta Apprenticeship & Industry Training Board. Ray chairs the Grapevine Board and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees.

Robert Mayer (Box 405, Oak Creek, WI 53154-0405) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 2005. A Panel 50 delegate, Bob has been treasurer of the East Central region, actively spon-

sors, and remains active in area, district and group activities. A Forester by profession, he has worked for the eastern region of the U.S. Forest Service for over 25 years. Currently Bob is a resource specialist, working as the regional fire planner for the eastern region of the United States Forest Service, focusing on out year planning of wildfire fighting resources and fire program management budgeting. Bob chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community/Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. He is also a director on the Grapevine Board.

Madeleine Parmley (9242 N. Sunset Dr., Pocatello, ID 83201) was elected Pacific regional trustee in April 2006. She served as a Panel 52 delegate and has long been active in carrying the message into jails and prisons, and has volunteered as a camp counselor for incarcerated mothers and their children. Madeleine is a trauma care nurse. She chairs the Corrections Committee and also serves on the Archives, Audit, and Nominating Committees. She is a member of the Grapevine Board.

John C. Skilton (201 Kerby Hill Rd., Fort Washington, MD 20744), a Panel 47 delegate, was elected general service trustee in April 2007. From 2003 to 2007 he was a nontrustee director of the A.A. Grapevine Board. Now retired, John has been a researcher and professor at several universities. He chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Finance and Budgetary and Literature Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Dorothy Wilson (2602 Walker Avenue, Indianapolis, IN 46203) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 2005. A Panel 44 delegate, Dorothy had remained active in her group, district, area and region. She has worked with children in a variety of educational programs. Dorothy chairs the International Committee and serves on the International Conventions/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees. She is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Trustees elected by the General Service Board following 2008 Conference

Terrance M. Bedient (99 Washington Ave., Suite 410, Albany, NY 12210) was elected a Class A trustee in May 2008. Terry holds a graduate degree in Healthcare Administration from George Washington University and is a fellow of the American College of Healthcare Executives. He is currently vice president of the Medical Society of New York. He has recently served as consultant on the trustees' Finance & Budgetary Committee.

Kenneth Brueggemann (6111 Belvedere Blvd., Omaha, NE 68111-1274) was elected West Central Regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 48 delegate, Ken remains active in his area. When he served as area remote communities chair he was instrumental in having A.A. literature translated into Nuer for the Sudanese population, and for 25 years has worked with groups in prisons and jails. Having taught high school for 32 years, Ken continues to substitute teach.

Victor Phillips (Suite 204, 516 Cedar Crescent SW, Calgary, AB T3C 2Y8, Canada) was elected Western Canada regional trustee in May 2008. A Panel 54 delegate, Vic facilitates workshops and sharing sessions and is an active member in his area's work with remote communities. Vic's professional background is in finance and management.

A.A. World Services Directors

Howard Lowery, *chairperson, regional trustee*
 Chuck Barta, *regional trustee*
 Roberta Lindeman, *director*
 George Martin, *director*

Greg Muth, *G.S.O. general manager*
 John Skilton, *general service trustee*
 Jane Tolar, *director*
 Dorothy Wilson, *trustee-at-large/Canada*
 Adrienne Brown, *G.S.O. staff member*

A.A. Grapevine Directors

Ray Massey, *chairperson, general service trustee*
 Ginger Bell, *director*
 James Branscome, *director*
 Robin Bromley, *executive editor*

Herbert Goodman, *Class A trustee*
 Dorothy Hurley, *general service trustee*
 Robert Mayer, *regional trustee*
 Madeleine Parmley, *regional trustee*
 Andrew Talbert, Jr., *director*

General Service Office Staff

Greg Muth, *general manager*
 Tom Jasper, *senior adviser to general manager*
 Adrienne Brown
 Mary Dargan
 Julio Espallat
 Irene Kontje

Mary Clare Lynch
 Valerie O'Neill
 Doug Richardson
 Gayle Solheim Riese
 Eva Sanchez
 Warren Stafford
 Rick Walker

Grapevine Staff

Robin Bromley, *executive editor*
 Maggie Keogh, *GV, director of Internet operations*

Jorge Carbajosa, *La Viña editor*

Others Assisting the Conference (nonvoting)

Militza Alma-Noyola, *staff assistant*
 Ellie Biscuti, *support services*
 Daniel O. Brown, *digital media manager*
 Janet Bryan, *GV office mgr./executive asst.*
 Shawn Bunkley, *office coordinator*
 Angel Calvillo, *Spanish translator*
 Christopher Cavanaugh, *publications director*
 Sheila Coppin-Thorn, *staff assistant*
 Cathalina Davis, *copy room coordinator*
 Daniel DeFilippis, *asst. controller/business admin.*
 Joseph Dennon, *executive assistant to general manager*
 John DeStefano, *Spanish-language editor*
 Amy Filiatreau, *archivist*
 John Hackett, *executive editor*
 Karen Hale, *manager, support services*
 Al Herr, *artist, Conference Report*
 John Kirwin, Jr., *A.A. events consultant*
 Elsa Lathan, *staff assistant*
 Fern Leclerc, *French translator*
 Marsha Levine, *GV assoc. editor*
 Pamela Lewis, *staff assistant*
 Ayleen Martinez, *staff assistant*
 Donald Meurer, *C.F.O., G.S.O.*
 Michelle Mirza, *asst. archivist*
 Eugene O'Brien, *GV controller*
 Lise Payette, *French-language editor*
 Ivelisse Rivera, *asst. to Regional Forums coordinator*
 Linda Samuels, *staff assistant*
 Sharrisse Seabury, *staff assistant*
 Frank Segui, *financial secretary*
 Charlie Shell, *consultant, project management office*
 Robert Slotterback, *accounting department manager*
 Kevin Sunkel, *independent auditor*
 Yee Tully, *Conference staff assistant*
 Andre Washington, *office manager*
 Eleanor Widdoes, *writer/editor, Early Bird Box 4-5-9, Conference Report*
 Nannie Williams, *staff assistant*

Trustees emeriti

Michael Alexander
 W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.
 Gary Glynn
 Elaine McDowell, Phd.

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 58th Conference includes Panel 57 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 58 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	57	Tim Donaldson 18193 Alabama Hwy 52 Opp, AL 36467
Alaska	2	58	Torvald Hansen Box 1386 Anchor Point, AK 99556
Arizona	3	58	Dennis Wilson 3222 N. Cottontail Circle Tucson, AZ 85749
Arkansas	4	57	Nora Bromley 5523 N. Maple St. North Little Rock, AR 72118
California Southern	5	57	Gustavo Trujillo 137 N. Rosemont Ave., #9 Los Angeles, CA 90026
Central	93	57	Debbie Johnson 8214 Kentland Ave. West Hills, CA 91304
Northern Coastal	6	57	Sharon Buckley 2660 Melendy Dr., #1 San Carlos, CA 94070-3661
Northern Interior	7	58	Lee Dennis (lee) Wilson 2844 Seine Ave. Davis, CA 95616
San Diego/Imperial	8	58	Gail Nelson 192 Elm Ave. Imperial Beach, CA 91932
Mid-Southern	9	58	Joe Barrett 120 S. Lakeview Ave. Anaheim, CA 92807
Colorado	10	57	Bill Fifield Box 366 Conifer, CO 80433
Connecticut	11	57	Patricia (Pat) McDonald 848 Long Hill Ave. Shelton, CT 06484
Delaware	12	58	Joseph (Joe) Schranck 209 N. Broad, #4 Middletown, DE 19709
District of Columbia	13	57	Carroll (Kiki) Roddy 9880 Hollow Glen Place Silver Spring, MD 20910
Florida North	14	57	Fred Heyne 3833 Millpoint Dr. Jacksonville, FL 32257
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I./ Antigua	15	57	Bill Ouchie 5306 Rosecrest Circle Tampa, FL 33617
Georgia	16	58	David Morgan Box 355 Abbeville, GA 31001
Hawaii	17	57	Vernon Gosney 55 Mahalani St. Wailuku, HI 96793
Idaho	18	58	David Fox Box 1975 Sun Valley, ID 83353-1975

State	Area no.	Panel		State	Area no.	Panel	
Illinois				Montana	40	57	Andrew Ware 3214 Cummins Way Missoula, MT 59802
Chicago	19	57	Maurice Holman 1309 East Ave. Berwyn, IL 60402	Nebraska	41	58	Lori Geistlinger Box 265 Hallam, NE 68368
Northern	20	58	John Conway 5107 Patton Dr. Wonder Lake, IL 60097	Nevada	42	57	Michael (Mike) Doheny Box 384 Gabbs, NV 89409
Southern	21	57	Hugh Neavill Box 225 Fairfield, IL 62837	New Hampshire	43	58	Kevin Short 18 Sunridge Rd. Windham, NH 03087
Indiana				New Jersey			
Northern	22	57	Leonard (Leo) Smith 1303½ Clay St., #2 Laporte, IN 46350	Northern	44	57	John (J.J.) Mastrull 10 Lund Court Piscataway, NJ 08854
Southern	23	58	Michalene Reilly 912 W. Countryside Lane Bloomington, IN 47403	Southern	45	58	Frederick (Fred) Ellis 19 W. Linden Ave. Lindenwold, NJ 08021
Iowa	24	57	Mike Maynard 820 14th St. SE Cedar Rapids, IA 52403	New Mexico	46	58	Ralph Trigg 1513 Plaza Encantada NW Albuquerque, NM 87107
Kansas	25	58	Bruce Kesl 333 Tallgrass Dr. Lawrence, KS 66049	New York			
Kentucky	26	58	Barbara Frizzell 415 Tincher Dr. Versailles, KY 40383	Central	47	57	Elisabeth (Liz) Olmstead 17 Wren St. Johnson City, NY 13790
Louisiana	27	57	Linda Seamon 340 Kimbro Dr. Baton Rouge, LA 70808	Hudson/Mohawk/ Berkshire	48	58	Joan Ramsey 2 Wendell Dr. Albany, NY 12205
Maine	28	58	Kathi Davis 2629 H Rd. Acton, ME 04001	Southeast	49	57	John Wighton 210 Lakeshore Dr. East Carmel, NY 10512
Maryland	29	58	Thomas (Tom) Revelle 763 Match Point Dr. Arnold, MD 21012	Western	50	58	Cheryl Akin 10 Juliet St. Jamestown, NY 14701
Massachusetts				North Carolina	51	57	Newton Pritchett Box 3794 Cary, NC 27519-3794
Eastern	30	57	Francis Gilroy 181 Littleton Rd., #215 Chelmsford, MA 01824	North Dakota	52	57	Phillip (Phil) Momerak 7700 58th Ave. NW Minot, ND 58703
Western	31	58	Sara (Sally) Spencer 182 N. Washington St. Belchertown, MA 01007	Ohio			
Michigan				Central Southeast	53	57	Sharon Farnsworth 716 5th St. Marietta, OH 45750
Central	32	57	Larry Sanford 6775 S. Adrian Hwy. Adrian, MI 49221	Northeast	54	57	Jeff Your 1076 Woodview Rd. Cleveland Heights, OH 44121
Southeast	33	57	Robert (Bob) Conley 27855 Barkley Livonia, MI 48154	NW Ohio/SE Mich.	55	58	John Zidarín 3774 Hill Ave., #100 Toledo, OH 43607
Western	34	58	Gregg King 526 Third St. Manistee, MI 49660	Southwest	56	58	Suzanne Welham 8025 Kimbee Dr. Cincinnati, OH 45244
Minnesota				Oklahoma	57	57	Paul Alexander 402 E. Jefferson Tecumseh, OK 74873
Northern	35	58	JoAnne Nelson 816 Fir St. Brainerd, MN 56401	Oregon	58	58	David (Dave) Adelhart Box 2974 Oregon City, OR 97045
Southern	36	57	*Scott Ahlgren 10970 43rd Ave. North Plymouth, MN 55442	Pennsylvania			
Mississippi	37	58	Helon Hill 6237 Browning Dr. Ocean Springs, MS 39564	Eastern	59	57	Sheila Dunne 61 Regents Court Bensalem, PA 19020
Missouri				Western	60	57	Janet Hollabaugh 199 Wilson Rd. Worthington, PA 16262
Eastern	38	57	Patricia (Pat) Basinger 106 W. School St. Bonne Terre, MO 63628				
Western	39	57	Ronald (Ron) Hubbard 2009 Sandlewood Republic, MO 65738				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Rhode Island	61	58	Al Davenport 1300 Wallum Lake Rd. Pascoag, RI 02859
South Carolina	62	58	Robert Hill Box 51 Newberry, SC 29108
South Dakota	63	58	John Teupel Box 916 Spearfish, SD 57783
Tennessee	64	58	John Antol 921 S. Chilhowee Dr. Knoxville, TN 37914
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	57	Bill Neal 326 Faircrest Drive Arlington, TX 76018
<i>Northwest</i>	66	58	Leon Roberts 103 Loma Linda Borger, TX 79007
<i>Southeast</i>	67	57	E. A. (Gus) Henry 108 Brookwood Dr. Silsbee, TX 77656
<i>Southwest</i>	68	58	Steve Yocum 903 N. West Burnet, TX 78611
Utah	69	57	Julie Simiskey 260 W. 530 North La Verkin, UT 84745
Vermont	70	58	Andrew (Andy) Coyne Box 167 Jamaica, VT 05343
Virginia	71	57	Theodore (Ted) Kroll 5731 N. 6th St. Arlington, VA 22205
Washington <i>State East</i>	92	58	Rad Miller 1320 Terrace Court East Wenatchee, WA 98802-4348
<i>Western</i>	72	57	Gail Harris Box 909 Preston, WA 98050
West Virginia	73	57	Jim Withrow 4111 Staunton SE Charleston, WV 25304
Wisconsin <i>No. WI/ Up. Pen. MI</i>	74	58	Dorothy (Dodie) Ash Box 661 Chetek, WI 54728
<i>Southern</i>	75	57	George Possley Box 165 Hingham, WI 53031
Wyoming	76	58	Brooke Collins 38 Monarch Rd. Ranchester, WY 82839
Puerto Rico	77	58	Juan Andonio (Antonio) Rodriguez Box 175 Portales de San Juan San Juan, PR 00924-4582

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta/N.W.T.	78	58	Dane Bruha Box 551 Consort, AB T0C 1B0
B.C./Yukon	79	57	Patricia (Trish) La Nauze 3534 Cambridge St. Vancouver, BC V5K 1M4
Manitoba	80	58	John Johnson #4-388 McKay Ave. Winnipeg, MB R2G 094
New Brunswick/P.E.I.	81	58	Hari Boggs 304-22 Mutch Dr. Stratford, PEI C1B 1S2
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labr.	82	57	Murdo MacKay 33 Beech Hill Dr. Falls River, NS B2T 1H7
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	57	Dot Dykstra 15 Heron Lane Belleville, ON K8N 4Z3
<i>Northeast</i>	84	57	Maurice (Moe) Bradley 1188 Marcel St. Sudbury, ON P3E 4G1
<i>Northwest</i>	85	57	Perry Marquis Box 361 Sioux Narrows, ON P0X 1N0
<i>Western</i>	86	58	Martin Aire 14 Gibson Ave. Hamilton, ON L8L 6J5
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	58	Ginette Williams 43, Rue Dupont St-Antoine-Sur-Richelieu, PQ J06 1R0
<i>Southeast</i>	88	57	Claude Matteau 2525, De La Laurentie, #10 Sherbrooke, PQ J1J 1L3
<i>Northeast</i>	89	57	France Jolicoeur 82 Ave. du Plateau Beauport, PQ G1E 2M9
<i>Northwest</i>	90	58	Sylvain LeLièvre 925 Jean-Casavan Lavaltrie, PQ J5T 2V4
Saskatchewan	91	57	John Fraser Box 171 Colonsay, SK S0K 0Z0

